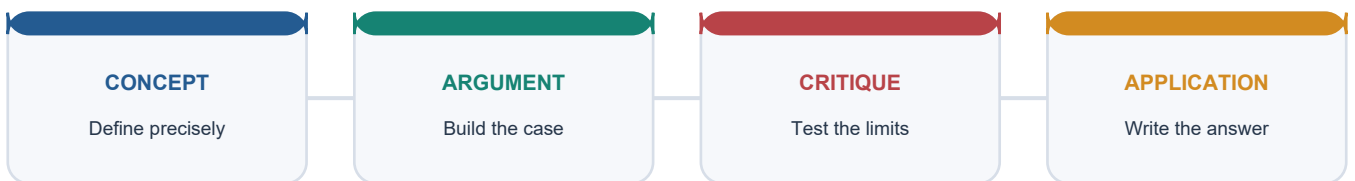


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Cārvāka (Lokāyata) - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section B | Complete learning session, practice and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

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Cārvāka (Lokāyata) - Complete Learning Session

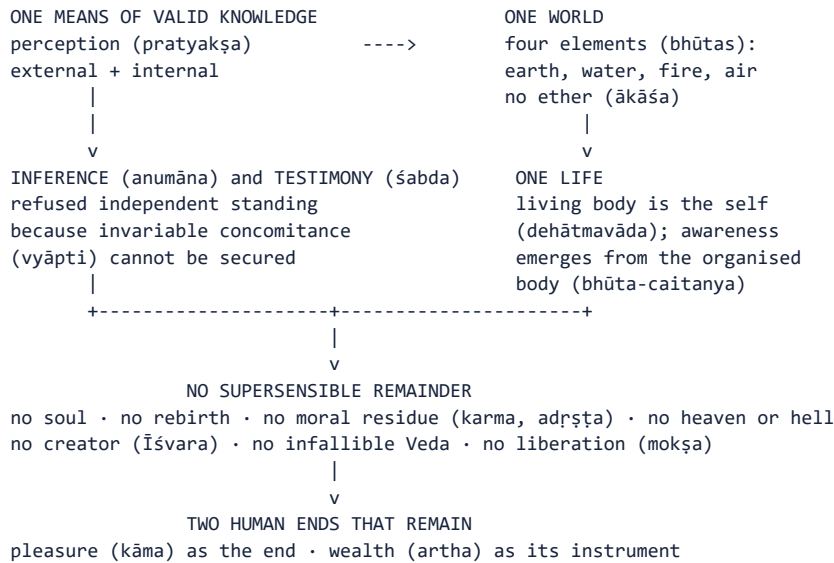
Syllabus, verbatim: *Carvaka : Theory of Knowledge; Rejection of Transcendent Entities* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section B, item 12. **Evidence discipline:** the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the school survives mainly in the words of its opponents, so doctrine is stated as the standard doxographical reconstruction. **FACT:** marks convergent doctrine, **ANALYSIS:** marks analytical reconstruction and **CAUTION:** marks a contested attribution. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads; the accurate Sanskrit term in IAST follows immediately in parentheses.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	9
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full	9
Supporting routed PYQ solved in full	1
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts, plus the detailed nine-subtopic register	12 (A-L)

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SANSKRIT IMMEDIATELY AFTER



Concept spine: the English concept leads and the Sanskrit term in IAST follows immediately. Read it downward - the epistemic rule at the top generates every denial below it.

Answer-worthiness. Perception-only epistemology, the critique of inference, four-element materialism, the body-self, emergent consciousness and the rejection of transcendent entities are **core syllabus**. Source historiography, strong versus softened readings, Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa and controlled modern comparisons are **core supporting depth**. Crude hedonist caricature and invented primary-text certainty are excluded.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

ANALYSIS: Reconstruction discipline. Contemporary labels such as empiricism, naturalism, secularism or dissent may aid comparison only when qualified; they can never replace historically controlled reconstruction from the surviving witnesses.

Complete the Basic block first. Optional interpretive depth is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections, so that the core doctrine stays easy to learn and immediately usable in a competent answer.

ONE-SCREEN MAP

SOURCE PROBLEM

- > PERCEPTION AS SOLE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa)
- > INFERENCE CRITIQUE
- > NYAYA DEFENCE
- > FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
- > BODY-SELF AND EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS
- > REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
- > THIS-WORLDLY ETHICS AND SOCIAL MEANING
- > COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS

This is a route map, not a substitute for the nine complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 - HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Because Cārvāka primary texts are lost, the school must be reconstructed from quotations and opponents while separating convergent doctrine from polemical caricature.

Technical definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- hostile doxography
- lost Bṛhaspati-sūtra
- Lokāyata
- Bārhaspatya
- Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa
- source convergence

How to use them: Use the lost primary text and hostile doxography to qualify attribution, then invoke convergent reports to defend a recoverable Cārvāka doctrinal core.

Plain-language visual - learning through an opponent's notes

ORIGINAL CARVAKA BOOK

|
X lost

|
What opponents quoted ---> our main evidence

|
One surviving sceptical work (Jayarasi)

|
CAREFUL RECONSTRUCTION, not blind certainty

In simple words: imagine trying to understand a debater when their own notebook is lost and only the rival team's rebuttal survives. We can still recover the main position because several opponents repeat the same core claims, but we must distinguish secure doctrine from hostile caricature.

Remember first	Meaning
Cārvāka / Lokāyata / Bāṛhaspatya	Three names associated with the materialist tradition
Lost primary text	The <i>Bṛhaspati-sūtra</i> does not survive
Main caution	Write "on the standard doxographical reconstruction"
Why <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> ?	Rejection of Vedic authority, not simply disbelief in God

One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so reconstruct firmly but quote cautiously.

CORE DEFINITION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly doctrine), is a non-Vedic and this-worldly philosophy that accepts perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) and rejects unverifiable transcendent entities; because its primary texts are lost, its doctrines must be stated as a cautious doxographical reconstruction.

VISUAL: VISUAL - How we know what we know about Cārvāka

WHAT WOULD BE IDEAL
=====

BRHASPATI-SUTRA (primary)

|
| direct transmission
v
Carvaka commentaries
|
v
Living school with pupils

WHAT WE ACTUALLY HAVE
=====

(LOST)

|
| about a dozen sutras and
| verses quoted by OTHERS
v

+-----+
| HOSTILE DOXOGRAPHY |
| Sarva-darsana-sangraha |
| Sad-darsana-samuccaya |
| Prabodhacandrodaya (play)|
| Tattvasangraha (Buddhist)|
| Vedantasara (Advaita) |
+-----+

|
refutation-first framing:
strongest points omitted,
weakest points magnified
|

v
+ ONE surviving sceptical text
TATTVOPAPLAVASIMHA
(Jayarasi Bhatta, c. 8th c. CE)
-- but it is MORE sceptical
than the standard Carvaka

ANALYSIS: Caption. Every claim in this topic passes through a filter of refutation. That does not make reconstruction impossible; it makes *epistemic honesty about the reconstruction* itself a mark-earning move. The examiner rewards a candidate who writes "on the standard doxographical reconstruction" rather than one who quotes a lost text as though it were open on the desk.

1. The three names, and what each one tells you

Name	Literal sense	What it signals	Evidence status
Cārvāka	Possibly from <i>carv</i> , "to chew, to eat" - the doctrine of "eat, drink and be merry"; or from <i>cāru-vāk</i> , "sweet-worded / pleasant of speech"	Either a hostile nickname or a note that the doctrine is superficially attractive	FACT: Both etymologies are given in Chatterjee and Datta; C. D. Sharma adds a third gloss - one who "chews up" merit and demerit
Lokāyata	<i>Lokāyata-mata</i> , "the view of the common people"; a <i>lokāyatika</i> is its holder	The school is popular, worldly, this-worldly; by implication in hostile sources, unrefined	FACT: Chatterjee and Datta; Sharma adds that "commoner" carries a pejorative implication of low taste in the sources
Bārhaspatya	"Of Bṛhaspati"	Traces the school to Bṛhaspati as its traditional founder	FACT: Sharma: "Bṛhaspati, a heretical teacher, is regarded as the traditional founder of this school. His <i>Sūtra</i> ... has unfortunately perished."

FACT: There is a further doxographical curiosity, reported in both Chatterjee and Datta and Sharma: some accounts identify this Bṛhaspati with the *teacher of the gods*, who is said to have propagated materialism among the *asuras* precisely so that, following these attractive teachings, they would come to ruin. CAUTION: That story is polemical theology, not history; quote it only to illustrate how the tradition was framed by its enemies.

ANALYSIS: **Exam use.** The highlighted answer-grabbing line above is the preferred full opening. For a very short answer, write: "Cārvāka, also called Lokāyata and Bārhaspatya, is the materialist and *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* (non-Vedic) school of Indian philosophy."

2. The source problem, stated precisely

FACT: **The facts, as the standard textbooks state them.**

1. No systematic primary work of the school survives. Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not find any systematic work on materialism, nor any organised school of followers as the other philosophical schools possess."
2. The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost. Sharma: about **a dozen sūtras** and verses are found quoted or referred to by other authors as the materialistic teachings of Bṛhaspati.
3. "Almost every work of the other schools states, for refutation, the materialistic views. Our knowledge of Indian materialism is chiefly based on these" (Chatterjee and Datta).
4. Sharma is blunter about the consequence: "the weak points in this school are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture."
5. Sharma adds the decisive historiographical warning: even the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* summary "seems to be based on such accounts", so it does not give independent access to the school.

ANALYSIS: **What follows philosophically.** Three consequences, each usable as a line in an answer:

- (a) MODAL CAUTION : write "on the standard reconstruction", not "Carvaka says in his text".
- (b) CHARITY : where a doctrine has a crude and a defensible version, the crude one is the one an enemy would preserve. Reconstruct the strongest available reading and SAY that you are doing so.
- (c) NON-PARALYSIS : convergence across independent hostile sources on the same doctrinal core (perceptualism, anti-inferentialism, four elements, no soul, no afterlife) is itself evidence.

3. The surviving fragments - what is actually quoted

FACT: Sharma gleans the following from the *Bṛhaspati* material quoted across philosophical writings. These are the closest thing to primary text that exists, and they are quoted *by others*:

#	Sūtra (as transmitted)	Doctrine
1	<i>prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni</i>	Earth, water, fire and air are the elements
2	<i>tatsamudāye śarīrendriyaviśaya-saṃjñā</i>	Bodies, senses and objects are results of different combinations of the elements
3	<i>kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam</i>	Consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents

#	Sūtra (as transmitted)	Doctrine
4	<i>caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ</i>	The person is the body qualified by consciousness
5	<i>pleasure (kāma) evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ</i>	Enjoyment is the only end of human life
6	<i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	Death alone is liberation

FACT: Alongside these, the second act of Kṛṣṇamiśra's allegorical play *Prabodhacandrodaya* summarises the doctrine in a single sweep: "Lokāyata is the only *śāstra*; perception is the only authority; earth, water, fire and air are the only elements; enjoyment is the only end of human existence; mind is only a product of matter. There is no other world; death means liberation."

CAUTION: **Caution to carry through the whole session.** A play written by an opponent, staged as allegory, is a *representation* of the doctrine. It is legitimate evidence of how the school was understood; it is not the school's own voice.

4. Why Cārvāka is Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) - and the exact sense of the word

FACT: This is a precision point that separates strong scripts from weak ones. Chatterjee and Datta set it out exactly:

Sense of āstika	Meaning in Sanskrit philosophical literature	Is Cārvāka Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) in this sense?
Primary, classificatory sense	One who accepts the authority of the Vedas	FACT: Yes - this is the sense that generates the six- <i>āstika</i> / three- <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> division
Secondary sense	One who believes in life after death	FACT: Yes
Modern vernacular sense	"Theist" versus "atheist"	ANALYSIS: Misleading. Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā and early Yoga-adjacent readings are non-theistic yet <i>āstika</i>

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta state the consequence directly: the six orthodox schools are *āstika*, "and the Cārvāka is *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* in both the senses". Jaina and Bauddha schools are *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* on the first criterion but would count as *āstika* on the second, since they accept life after death.

MEMORY: Trap, and it is examined: *Cārvāka is Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) primarily because it rejects Vedic authority, not merely because it denies God.* If denial of God were the criterion, Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā would also be *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* - and they are not.

5. Why materialism arose - the historical setting

FACT: Sharma gives the standard account: the school "seems to be very old", with references in the epics and in early Buddhist literature; Garbe is quoted to the effect that "even in the pre-Buddhistic India proclaimers of purely materialistic doctrines appeared." Sharma locates its rise in the post-Upaniṣadic and pre-Buddhistic age and attributes it to:

1. protest against the excessive monkdom of the Brāhmaṇa priests;
2. the externals of ritualism, "which ignored the substance and emphasized the shadow";
3. an Upaniṣadic idealism "unsuited to the commoners";
4. political and social crises, exploitation of the masses by petty rulers, monks and the wealthy class.

FACT: Early Buddhist scripture confirms an environment of such thinkers. The *Sāmaññaphala-sutta* names four contemporaries of the Buddha whom Chatterjee and Datta group as "cunning (*dhūrta*) Cārvākas":

Thinker	Position as reported
Pūraṇa Kassapa	Denies moral responsibility, virtue and vice
Makkhali Gosāla	Denies free will and the possibility of moral effort

Thinker	Position as reported
Ajita Kesakambalī	Teaches the material origin and destructibility of man, the futility of good action, the impossibility of knowledge
Sañjaya Belaṭṭhiputta	Will neither affirm, nor deny, nor both, nor even admit that he neither affirms nor denies

FACT: Sharma independently notes Ajita Kesakambalin in the *Majjhima Nikāya* as "a materialist ... who believed only in perception and in four elements", and records that Śāntarakṣita refers to him as *Kambalāśvatara*.

ANALYSIS: **Exam use.** Naming Ajita Kesakambalī gives you a *pre-systematic historical anchor* for four-element materialism that is independent of the hostile Brahmanical doxography - a genuinely strong evidential move in a 15- or 20-marker on sources.

6. Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa - the one surviving text, and why it must be handled carefully

FACT: **The facts.** Chatterjee and Datta: the *Tattvopaplavasīmha*, by **Jayarāśi**, "probably of the eighth century A.D.", is a "recently discovered manuscript" and "an interesting specimen of Indian absolute scepticism"; its author "is believed to be a Cārvāka (or Lokāyatika) of an **extreme type**." Sharma records the publication data: it is the "single exception" to the absence of extant works, published by the Oriental Institute of Baroda in 1940.

FACT: **What Jayarāśi actually does.** He "carries the scepticism of the ordinary Cārvāka to its logical conclusion by challenging the validity of **perceptual** knowledge and refusing to accept the existence of even the physical elements. With a relentless destructive dialectic he exposes the defects of all the usually accepted sources of knowledge." His conclusion, Chatterjee and Datta note, is that of "an anti-intellectualist pragmatist": even on the denial of all theoretical principles and doctrines, practical life will go on as ever with unreflective ease.

ANALYSIS: **The distinction that must be preserved.**

STANDARD CARVAKA	JAYARASI'S SCEPTICISM
-----	-----
Perception is VALID	Perception is ALSO attacked
Four elements are REAL	Even the elements are not admitted
Positive materialist ontology	NO positive ontology at all
Rejects inference and testimony	Rejects EVERY means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
= dogmatic empiricism	= universal scepticism (tattva-upaplava, "the upsetting of all principles")

ANALYSIS: **Why this matters for the exam.** It is tempting, and wrong, to use Jayarāśi as evidence for what "the Cārvākas" held about perception. If Jayarāśi is used to establish the school's epistemology, the school's *defining* thesis - that perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* - disappears. Use him for exactly two things: (i) as the sole surviving text-witness of the tradition, and (ii) as the internal limit-case showing where consistent Cārvāka scepticism, pressed hard, ends up.

Exam link

Source qualification improves every answer: the lost *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*, hostile doxography and contested attributions must be stated without allowing source caution to erase the convergent doctrinal core.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. CAUTION: Do not write that "Cārvāka wrote the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra*". The text is lost; about a dozen *sūtras* survive only as quotations in other authors' works.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not treat the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* as an independent primary source. Sharma explicitly says its summary "seems to be based on" the same refutational accounts.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not use Jayarāśi's *Tattvopaplavasīmha* to state the Cārvāka theory of knowledge. He attacks perception too, which no standard Cārvāka does.
4. FACT: Do not say Cārvāka is *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* "because it is atheist". It is *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)* because it rejects the authority of the Veda - and, in the second textbook sense, because it denies life after death.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not present the "*asura*-deception" story about Bṛhaspati as history.

6. ANALYSIS: Do not conclude from the source problem that "nothing can be known". Convergent hostile testimony still fixes a doctrinal core.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not confuse *Lokāyata* ("view of the common people") with "folk religion". It names a philosophical position, not a devotional practice.

Revision notes

- FACT: Three names: **Cārvāka** (*carv*, to chew / *cāru-vāk*, sweet-worded), **Lokāyata** (*lokāyata-mata*, the view of common people), **Bārhaspatya** (of Bṛhaspati).
- FACT: Bṛhaspati is the traditional founder; his *Sūtra* is lost; about a dozen *sūtras* survive as quotations.
- FACT: Knowledge of the school comes chiefly from works that state its views **in order to refute them**.
- FACT: Sharma's verdict on transmission: strong points omitted, weak points exaggerated - "a faint caricature and not a true picture".
- FACT: Six transmitted *sūtras* to memorise: four elements · bodies-senses-objects from combination · consciousness like intoxicating power · person = body qualified by consciousness · *pleasure (kāma)* the only end · death alone is liberation.
- FACT: *Prabodhacandrodaya* Act II gives the classic one-sentence summary of the school.
- FACT: **Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) in both senses**: rejects Vedic authority; denies life after death. Vedic authority is the primary classificatory criterion.
- FACT: *Sāmaññaphala-sutta* names Pūraṇa Kassapa, Makkhali Gosāla, Ajita Kesakambalī and Sañjaya Belaṭṭhiputta as the environment of early scepticism and materialism.
- FACT: Ajita Kesakambalī - "believed only in perception and in four elements" - is the best independent historical anchor for the doctrine.
- FACT: **Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa**, *Tattvopaplavasīmha*, c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940 - the single surviving text, but an extreme sceptic who attacks perception itself.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka was the **touchstone** every school had to answer; its historical value is critical rather than constructive.
- ANALYSIS: Two-sided verdict to carry: philosophically fertile as critique (Chatterjee-Datta), unsuccessful as a system (Sharma).

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW HISTORICAL RECONSTRUCTION AND THE SOURCE PROBLEM			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS hostile doxography · lost Bṛhaspati-sūtra · Lokāyata · Bārhaspatya ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT That does not make reconstruction impossible; it makes epistemic honesty	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST One-line memory: Cārvāka is known mostly through its critics, so	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE It is Veda-rejecting school (nāstika) because it rejects the authority
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school), also called Lokāyata (worldly			

SESSION 2 - EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

Technical definition: Perception-only epistemology (pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda) treats perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge and reduces inference and testimony to fallible practical reliance.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- perception (pratyakṣa)
- means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)
- perception-only doctrine (pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda)
- practical inference
- verbal testimony (śabda)
- certainty

How to use them: State perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), then distinguish corrigible everyday expectation from the universally certain inference that Cārvāka contests.

CORE DEFINITION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception (pratyakṣa) as the only independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), while accepting inference only as fallible practical expectation rather than certain knowledge.

Plain-language visual - the knowledge gate

Can I directly experience it?

YES v NO
accept inference/testimony may guide action,
as known but cannot guarantee philosophical certainty

In simple words: Cārvāka treats perception as the only secure entrance to knowledge. Inference and testimony may be useful in daily life, but their conclusions can fail; therefore they do not independently certify unseen realities.

Everyday case	Cārvāka reading
Seeing fire	Directly known through perception
Seeing smoke and expecting fire	A useful expectation, not infallible knowledge
Hearing a trustworthy person	The words are heard; their truth still needs checking
Feeling pain or pleasure	Internally experienced and therefore perceptible

One-line memory: perception gives certainty; other routes may give practical probability.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) ledger of Indian philosophy, and where Cārvāka stands

Legend: P = perception (*pratyakṣa*); A = inference (*anumāna*); U = comparison (*upamāna*); S = verbal testimony (*śabda*); Ar = postulation (*arthāpatti*); An = non-cognition (*anupalabdhi*).

School	P	A	U	S	Ar	An	Total
Cārvāka	Yes	No	No	No	No	No	1
Vaiśeṣika	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	2
Mainstream Buddhist epistemology*	Yes	Yes	No	No	No	No	2
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	Yes	Yes	No	Yes	No	No	3
Nyāya	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	No	4
Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	No	5
Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	6
Advaita Vedānta*	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	Yes	6

Takeaway: Cārvāka alone recognises perception as the sole independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* in this standard comparison.

This is the standard pedagogical ledger. Buddhist classifications vary by school and period; Advaita's standard later account admits six. Cārvāka may use inference as fallible practical expectation while denying it independent status as a means of valid knowledge.

ANALYSIS: Caption. This ledger is worth reproducing from memory in any *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* question in Paper I. It shows at a glance that the Cārvāka position is not an eccentric outlier but the **lower bound** of a shared Indian debate about how many independent sources of knowledge there are. Nyāya sits at four; Cārvāka drives the number down to one and forces every other school to justify its additions.

1. The core thesis, stated exactly

FACT: Thesis (pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda). Perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* - an independent, dependable source of valid knowledge (*pramā*).

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta frame the architecture of the whole system on this thesis: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend **logically** on their epistemology." Every later denial - of soul, God, *action and moral consequence (karma)*, rebirth, heaven and liberation - is a consequence drawn from this one epistemic restriction, not a separate act of unbelief.

FACT: The vocabulary must be precise:

Term	Meaning	Why the exam cares
Valid cognition (pramā)	Valid cognition; knowledge of reality	The thing to be explained
Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	The <i>means</i> by which <i>valid cognition (pramā)</i> arises	The disputed list
Perception (pratyakṣa)	Perception	The only item Cārvāka admits
Inference (anumāna)	Inference	Rejected as uncertain
Verbal testimony (śabda)	Verbal testimony, including scripture	Rejected as derivative
Comparison (upamāna)	Comparison / analogy	Rejected with the rest

ANALYSIS: The condition Cārvāka imposes. Chatterjee and Datta state it as a conditional test: "If inference is to be regarded as a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, it must yield knowledge **about which we can have no doubt** and **which must be true to reality**." Note the strength of the demand. This is not "usually reliable"; it is indubitability plus correspondence. Every subsequent Cārvāka argument is an application of this standard.

2. Two kinds of perception, and why the Cārvāka needs both

FACT: Cārvāka accepts perception in both its classical forms, and the second is often forgotten by candidates:

```

PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa)
|
+--- BAHYA (external) : through the five external senses --
|   sight, hearing, touch, taste, smell                       |
|                                                               | > both admitted
+--- ANTARA / MANASA (internal) : the mind's immediate        |
|   awareness of pleasure, pain, desire, and                  |
|   consciousness itself                                     -----

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FACT: This is not a decorative detail. Chatterjee and Datta present the strongest objection to Cārvāka materialism precisely through internal perception: "do we not have a kind of perception, called internal, which gives an immediate knowledge of our mental states? And do we not perceive in these consciousness which is nowhere to be perceived in the external material objects?" The objector's aim is to force the admission of an immaterial substrate.

FACT: **The Cārvāka answer, and it is subtle.** "The Cārvākas admit that the existence of consciousness is proved by perception. But they deny that consciousness is the quality of any unperceived non-material or spiritual entity." Consciousness is *given*; a soul is *not* given. What internal perception delivers is a state of the living body, not evidence of a separate substance.

ANALYSIS: **Exam-critical inference.** Cārvāka is therefore **not** a denier of consciousness. It is a denier of the *inference* from consciousness to an immaterial bearer of consciousness. A script that writes "Cārvāka denies consciousness" has confused materialism with eliminativism and has thrown away the 2024 twenty-marker.

3. Certainty versus practical belief - the distinction that saves the position

ANALYSIS: The most common failure in this topic is to write that "Cārvāka says nobody ever infers anything." That is not the doctrine, and the texts themselves block it.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta record the Cārvāka's own concession: "It is true that in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference. But that only shows that we act **uncritically** on the wrong belief that our inference is true. It is a fact that sometimes our inference comes true and leads to successful results. But it is also a fact that sometimes inference leads to error as well. **Truth is not then an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a separable one**, that we find only in some inferences."

ANALYSIS: **Unpack that last sentence, because it is the philosophical hinge of the whole topic.**

For inference to be a MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa), truth would have to be an ESSENTIAL and INSEPARABLE character of the inferential process.

But truth attaches to SOME inferences and not to others.

=> truth is ACCIDENTAL (agantuka) to inference, and SEPARABLE from it.

=> inference is not a truth-GUARANTEEING instrument.

...and yet people go on inferring, and often succeed.
The Carvaka does not deny THAT. He denies that success confers PRAMANA-STATUS.

FACT: The authored knowledge file records the same distinction under the heading *lokasiddha* or *laukika* inference: practical, corrigible, worldly inference tied to future perceptual confirmation is tolerated; **transcendental** inference - from ritual to unseen merit, from world to God, from body to soul - is the real target, because nothing could ever check it perceptually.

Axis	Everyday (laukika / vyāvahārika) inference	Transcendental (alaukika / pāramārthika) inference
Example	Smoke on a hill, so probably fire; dark clouds, so probably rain	Ritual now, so heaven later; world exists, so God made it
Corrigibility	FACT: Can be checked by later perception	ANALYSIS: In principle uncheckable
Cārvāka attitude	ANALYSIS: Tolerated as practical habit; denied <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> -status	FACT: Rejected outright

Axis	Everyday (laukika / vyāvahārika) inference	Transcendental (alaukika / pāramārthika) inference
What the exam wants	The distinction stated in one sentence	The target of the critique identified correctly

4. Why verbal testimony (śabda) falls - the argument in five steps

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta give a compact and precise argument, worth reproducing as numbered steps:

1. Testimony consists of **words** (śabda). Insofar as words are heard through our ears, they are **perceived** - and knowledge of words is therefore perceptual and quite valid.
2. But insofar as those words *suggest or mean* things not within our perception, and aim at giving knowledge of unperceived objects, "they are not free from error and doubt."
3. Reliance on an authority always proceeds through a suppressed inference. The believer's mind runs: "This authority should be accepted because it is reliable, and all reliable authority should be accepted."
4. That is an inference. "Being based on inference, knowledge derived from verbal testimony or authority is **as precarious as inference**."
5. Therefore testimony is not an *independent* source of knowledge.

FACT: **The special case of the Veda.** Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka verdict without softening: "The authority of the Vedas ... is held in high esteem by many. But in reality the Vedas are the works of some cunning priests who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous. With false hopes and promises the Vedas persuade men to perform Vedic rites, the only tangible benefit of which goes to the priests who officiate and enjoy the emoluments."

ANALYSIS: **Two distinctions to keep clean.**

- (1) WORDS AS SOUNDS : perceived, and therefore fine.
 WORDS AS EVIDENCE : not perceived, and therefore suspect.
- (2) REJECTING TESTIMONY $\neq$ REJECTING COMMUNICATION.
 Language can guide action; it cannot CERTIFY what it reports until perception catches up with it.

FACT: Sharma adds the reinforcing point that testimony cannot be used to rescue inference either: "if testimony proves *invariable concomitance* (vyāpti), inference would become dependent on testimony, and then **none would be able to infer anything by himself**." That reductio is worth a line in any answer on the rejection of inference.

5. Why comparison (upamāna), postulation (arthāpatti) and non-cognition (anupalabdhi) fall too

ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's argument is a single template applied repeatedly, and stating the template is more impressive than listing the *means of valid knowledge* (pramāṇas).

Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	Its claim	The Cārvāka template applied
Comparison (upamāna) (Nyāya)	From "the <i>gavaya</i> resembles the cow" plus later sight of the animal, one knows the word's referent	ANALYSIS: The similarity is perceived; the <i>linkage of name to kind</i> is a generalisation reaching beyond what is perceived, hence inferential and insecure
Postulation (arthāpatti) (Mīmāṃsā)	Devadatta is fat, yet does not eat by day; therefore he eats by night	ANALYSIS: A postulation to remove an inconsistency - but the postulated fact is unperceived, and the necessity of the postulation is itself a generalisation
Non-cognition (anupalabdhi) (Bhāṭṭa, Advaita)	Non-apprehension of the jar yields knowledge of its absence	ANALYSIS: Requires the rule "if it existed here it would have been perceived", which is a universal not given in any single perception

ANALYSIS: **The template in one line, for the answer script:** *every candidate means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) other than perception depends on a universal proposition, and no universal proposition is perceived.* That single sentence disposes of the whole list and shows the examiner you understand the structure rather than the catalogue.

6. What the position buys, and what it costs

	Strength FACT:	Cost ANALYSIS:
Epistemic	An austere, honest criterion; no unfalsifiable postulates	Knowledge shrinks to the present-and-perceived; science and history become impossible as <i>knowledge</i>
Ontological	No inflated metaphysics; explanatory economy	Cannot account for micro-entities, other minds or the past
Religious	Immunity to priestly manipulation and unverifiable promises	Loses any account of moral order beyond prudence
Dialectical	Forces every rival to justify each additional <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i>	Invites the self-refutation charge (Subtopic 3)

Exam link

Route this foundation into 2019 Q5(c), 2021 Q5(e) and 2025 Q5(a): define *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*, distinguish certainty from practical expectation, and derive the rejection of testimony and transcendence.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not write "Cārvāka accepts only perception **and** ordinary experience" as if these were two things. Ordinary experience is admitted as perception.
2. FACT: Do not forget internal perception. Its admission is what makes Cārvāka a materialist about consciousness rather than a denier of consciousness.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka rejects language or communication. It rejects testimony's claim to *independent pramāṇa-status*.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not list the rejected *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* without giving the single template that rejects them all: each rests on an unperceived universal.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not attribute the *vyāvahārika / pāramārthika* level-distinction to Cārvāka as a historical doctrine. Sharma's point is precisely that Cārvāka lacks it; offering it is a philosophical *repair*, and it must be labelled as such.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not confuse the Cārvāka's demand ("no doubt whatever, and true to reality") with modern fallibilist standards. The strength of the demand is what drives the entire critique.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not say the Vedas are rejected "because they are old" or "because they are religious". They are rejected because their authority cannot be perceptually certified and their content promises the unperceivable.

Revision notes

- FACT: *Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*: perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*; everything else in the system follows logically from this.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend logically on their epistemology."
- FACT: The Cārvāka's test for *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-hood: knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality".
- FACT: Both **external** and **internal** perception are admitted; consciousness is perceived, an immaterial soul is not.
- FACT: Cārvāka denies the *inference* from consciousness to a soul, not consciousness itself.
- FACT: "Truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an accident, and a **separable** one."
- ANALYSIS: Distinguish *laukika* (corrigible, practical) from *pāramārthika* (uncheckable, transcendental) inference; the second is the real target.
- FACT: *Verbal testimony (śabda)* in five steps: words heard are perceived -> what they *mean* is unperceived -> acceptance runs through a reliability inference -> inference is precarious -> testimony is not independent.
- FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, "none would be able to infer anything by himself".

- **FACT:** The Veda is rejected as the work of "cunning priests" whose promises benefit only the officiants - an epistemic charge with a sociological edge.
- **ANALYSIS:** The single template that kills *comparison* (*upamāna*), *postulation* (*arthāpatti*) and *non-cognition* (*anupalabdhi*): each needs an unperceived universal.
- **ANALYSIS:** Sharma's charge: Cārvāka accepts perception and rejects inference **from the same standpoint**, lacking the *saṃvṛti/paramārtha* or *vyāvahārika/pāramārthika* distinction that saves Śūnyavāda and Advaita.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW EPISTEMOLOGY - PERCEPTION AS THE SOLE MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE (pramāṇa)			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS perception (pratyakṣa) · means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda: perception alone is a means of valid knowledge	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Chatterjee and Datta frame the architecture of the whole system on	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Chatterjee and Datta present the strongest objection to Cārvāka
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) epistemology treats perception			

SESSION 3 - THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti), HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (upādhi), THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka challenges inference by asking how a universal relation between reason and conclusion can be known from only finitely observed cases.

Technical definition: Against the uncompromising formulation the self-refutation charge is decisive; against the softened formulation it loses its force but so does the doctrine, which becomes a fallibilist warning rather than a denial of a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered hidden limiting condition (upādhi).

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **invariable concomitance (vyāpti)**
- **hidden limiting condition (upādhi)**
- **induction**
- **circularity**
- **Socrates syllogism**
- **self-refutation**

How to use them: Reconstruct the attack on invariable concomitance (vyāpti) through finite observation and hidden conditions, illustrate it with the Socrates syllogism, and finish with the self-refutation objection.

CORE DEFINITION: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that inference cannot establish certainty because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be universally known without circular inference and may always be defeated by an undiscovered hidden limiting condition (upādhi).

Plain-language visual - why smoke may mislead

Observed many times: SMOKE → FIRE

|
v

Hidden condition may exist: wet fuel / special cause

|
v

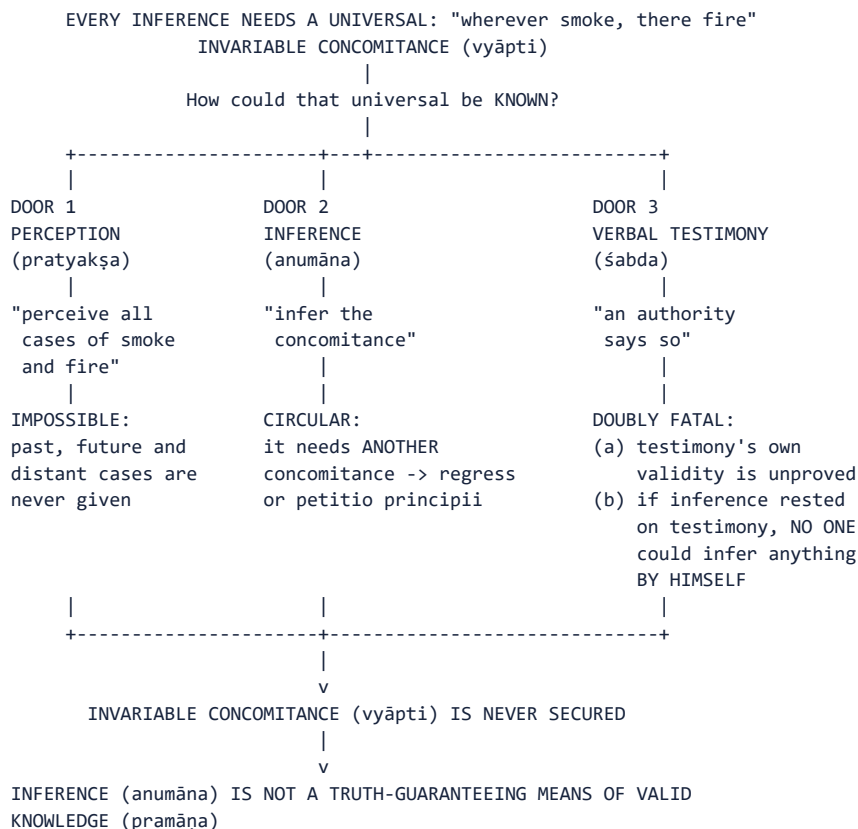
So "all smoke has fire" is not guaranteed merely by past cases

In simple words: inference needs a universal link called *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*). Cārvāka asks how anyone can inspect every past, present, future and distant case. A hidden condition (*upādhi*) may explain why the relation held in observed cases but fail elsewhere.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>Invariable concomitance</i> (<i>vyāpti</i>)	Exceptionless relation used by inference
<i>Hidden limiting condition</i> (<i>upādhi</i>)	Hidden condition that limits an apparently universal rule
Induction	Moving from observed cases to a universal rule
Deduction	Applying that universal rule to a particular case

One-line memory: if induction cannot secure the universal premise, deduction cannot rescue the conclusion.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The three-door trap: how invariable concomitance (vyāpti) is cornered



ANALYSIS: Caption. Draw this in the answer booklet. Three doors, all shut - that is the entire 2025 ten-marker, and the spine of the 2018, 2019 and 2022 questions. Notice that Door 3 is shut *twice*, and the second bolt (Sharma's "none would be able to infer anything by himself") is the one most candidates miss.

1. The doctrine, stated exactly

FACT: Thesis. Inference (*anumāna*) is not a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*), because inference is "a mere leap in the dark" (Sharma): we proceed from the known to the unknown, and there is no certainty in this, "though some inferences may turn out to be **accidentally** true."

FACT: The structural point. Inference is a movement from a perceived mark (*liṅga*, e.g. smoke) to an unperceived *sādhya* (e.g. fire), licensed by an invariable concomitance (*vyāpti*) between them. Chatterjee and Datta present the

Naiyāyika's own fuller statement of the inference - "all cases of smoke are cases of fire; this mountain is a case of smoke; therefore this is a case of fire" - and then locate the Cārvāka attack precisely: the argument "would be acceptable only if the **major premise**, stating the invariable relation between the middle term and the major, were beyond doubt."

ANALYSIS: **The move to memorise.** The Cārvāka never attacks the *form* of the inference. He grants that if the major premise were secure the conclusion would follow. He attacks the **licence** - the universal proposition that makes the movement legitimate. This is why the correct one-line statement of the doctrine is: *the Cārvāka critique of inference is a critique of the grounding of invariable concomitance (vyāpti), not of syllogistic validity.*

2. Door 1 - invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be established by perception

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "this invariable relation (*vyāpti*) can be established only if we have a knowledge of **all** cases of smoke and presence of fire. This, however, is not possible, as we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing **now** in different parts of the world, to speak nothing of those which existed in the **past** or will exist in the **future**."

OBSERVED SET		UNIVERSAL CLAIMED
-----		-----
[kitchen fire]		ALL smoke, everywhere,
[hill fire]	---- ? ---->	at every time, past,
[hearth fire]		present and future
[...n cases]		
finite, present,		infinite, temporally
local, contingent		unbounded, exceptionless
+--> the gap here is not a gap of DEGREE. It is a gap of KIND.		

FACT: **The class-character (sāmānya) rejoinder, and the Cārvāka's answer.** This is the sharpest exchange in the topic and almost no candidate reproduces it. The Naiyāyika-style objector says: granted we cannot perceive all individual smokes, but can we not perceive the **class-characters** "smokeness" (*dhūmatva*) and "fireness" (*vahnitva*), and perceive a relation *between the universals*, and thereby license the inference?

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta record the Cārvāka's two-part reply verbatim in substance:

1. Even granting perception of a relation between smokeness and fireness, "we cannot know therefrom any invariable relation between **all individual cases** of smoke and fire. To be able to infer a **particular** fire, we must know that it is inseparably related to the **particular** smoke perceived."
2. Worse, "it is not possible even to **know by perception** what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke."

ANALYSIS: **What this exchange really shows.** The Cārvāka refuses to let the Naiyāyika escape the particular-universal gap by relocating it in the universals: the same finitude that blocks the enumeration of instances blocks the perceptual grasp of the class-character. Chatterjee and Datta conclude for him: "the difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal, therefore, remains here as before."

3. Door 2 - invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be established by inference

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Neither can it be said to be based on another inference, because it will involve a **petitio principii**, since the validity of that inference again has to be similarly proved."

FACT: Sharma sharpens the same point into a pair:

DEDUCTION : "All men are mortal; Socrates is a man; so Socrates is mortal."
 The conclusion is ALREADY CONTAINED in the major premise.
 => petitio principii, an argument in a circle.

INDUCTION : offered to establish the major premise.
 But induction "proceeds unwarrantedly from the known to the unknown."
 => the major premise is never secured.

RESULT : "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle.
 The logicians, therefore, find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference." (Sharma, quoting the Carvaka gibe)

ANALYSIS: **Why this is not merely a dilemma but a trap.** Each horn is repaired only by the other. Deduction's circularity is cured by grounding the major premise inductively; induction's insecurity is cured by grounding it deductively. The Cārvāka's point is that the two cures are the same wound seen from two directions.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta add the causal variant, which candidates often think is a way out: "can we not base our knowledge of the invariable relation between smoke and fire on a **causal** relation between them?" The Cārvāka reply: "a causal relation, being only a kind of invariable relation, cannot be established by perception owing to the same difficulties."

4. Door 3 - invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be established by testimony

FACT: Two independent bolts, and both should appear in a 15-marker:

1. FACT: "Nor can this *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* be based on the testimony (*śabda*) of reliable persons ... For, the validity of testimony **itself requires to be proved by inference**" (Chatterjee and Datta). Grounding inference in testimony and testimony in inference is a closed circle.
2. FACT: "Besides, if inference always depended on testimony, **no one could infer anything by himself**" (Chatterjee and Datta; Sharma states the same *reductio*). Inference is manifestly a first-person cognitive capacity; making it parasitic on the word of another misdescribes what inference is.

5. The hidden limiting condition (upādhi) problem - the deepest cut

FACT: **Statement.** Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition (*upādhi*) may be doing the work; so observed constancy never establishes *unconditional* concomitance.

FACT: **The textbook example, exactly as Chatterjee and Datta give it** - and note that it runs in the direction most candidates get backwards:

A man perceives fire accompanied by smoke, many times.
 On another occasion he perceives FIRE and infers SMOKE.
 ^^^^ ^^^^

He is liable to ERROR.
 Why? Because he failed to notice a CONDITION (upādhi):
 WETNESS OF FUEL -- on the presence of which ALONE fire is
 attended with smoke.

The relation "fire -> smoke" holds only ARDRENDHANA-SAMYOGA-SAHITE,
 i.e. where fire is joined with wet fuel. A red-hot iron ball is
 fire WITHOUT smoke.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta draw the general conclusion: "So long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference. And unconditionality or **absence of conditions cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden and escape notice**. Inference or testimony cannot be used for proving this unconditionality without a *petitio principii*, because its validity also is being questioned here."

ANALYSIS: **Why the hidden limiting condition (upādhi) argument is stronger than the enumeration argument.** The enumeration argument says: you have not checked enough cases. The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* argument says: **even if you had checked every case you can check, you could not know that you had identified the right property as the ground of the relation**. The first is a problem of quantity; the second is a problem of the *identification of the relevant variable*. Nyāya can answer the first with more observation. It cannot answer the second with more observation alone - which is why it must bring in *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* (Subtopic 4).

7. The self-refutation charge (2018, 2019, 2022) - and the Cārvāka's replies

FACT: The charge, in its strongest form. Sharma states it without mercy: "To refuse the validity of inference from the empirical standpoint is to refuse to think and discuss. All thoughts, all discussions, all doctrines, all affirmations and denials, all proofs and disproofs are made possible by inference. The Cārvāka view that perception is valid and inference is invalid **is itself a result of inference**. The Cārvāka can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference. Thoughts and ideas, not being material objects, cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred. Hence the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy."

ANALYSIS: Reconstructed as numbered steps, because the examiner wants the logic and not the invective:

1. The Carvaka asserts: "No inference is a valid source of knowledge."
2. That assertion is UNIVERSAL. It quantifies over all inferential acts, past, present and future.
3. No universal proposition is given in any single perception.
4. Therefore the thesis is either (a) itself inferential -- and so self-defeating -- or (b) not knowledge by its own standard.
5. Further: to REFUTE Nyaya, the Carvaka must reason. To be UNDERSTOOD, he must rely on his hearers inferring his meaning from his words.
6. Further still: other MINDS are never perceived. The Carvaka's very act of arguing with an opponent presupposes an inference to another mind.

ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's three available replies - a strong answer gives all three and grades them.

Reply	Formulation	Assessment
R1 - The "no thesis" or vitaṇḍā reply	The Cārvāka advances no positive doctrine; he only <i>destroys</i> the opponent's claim to certainty, using the opponent's own standards. A purely destructive dialectic incurs no commitments.	ANALYSIS: Coherent, but it converts Cārvāka from a philosophy into a method - and Cārvāka <i>does</i> assert four elements, a body-self and <i>pleasure (kāma)</i> as the end, so it cannot be a global reply.
R2 - The softened-thesis reply	The thesis is not "no one ever infers" but "inference never yields apodictic certainty beyond what perception can check". As a claim about certainty rather than usability, it is not refuted by the fact that the Cārvāka reasons.	ANALYSIS: The strongest reply. It is the reading the authored knowledge file endorses, and it rescues consistency at the price of weakening the doctrine into radical fallibilism.
R3 - The level-distinction reply	Concede <i>vyāvahārika</i> validity to inference and deny only <i>pāramārthika</i> validity.	ANALYSIS: Effective against Sharma's "same standpoint" charge, but the level-distinction is, as Sharma says, "unknown to the Cārvāka" - so it is a repair offered by the interpreter, and must be labelled as such.

ANALYSIS: The verdict to write. *Against the uncompromising formulation the self-refutation charge is decisive; against the softened formulation it loses its force but so does the doctrine, which becomes a fallibilist warning rather than a denial of a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). The Cārvāka can be consistent or radical, but not both. That sentence answers 2019 Q5(c) almost by itself.*

8. Sharma's counter-attack on perception - the tu quoque

FACT: Sharma turns the Cārvāka's weapon around: "Perception itself which is regarded as valid by the Cārvāka is **often found untrue**. We perceive the earth as flat but it is almost round. We perceive the earth as static but it is moving round the sun. We perceive the disc of the sun as of a small size, but it is much bigger than the size of the earth. Such perceptual knowledge is **contradicted by inference**."

FACT: And the constructive half, which is really a Kantian point made in an Indian idiom: "pure perception in the sense of mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception or thought has arranged into order and has given meaning and significance to the loose threads of sense-data." Sharma cites the Buddhist *Tattvasaṅgraha* for this line of attack.

ANALYSIS: Why this is devastating and must be handled, not avoided. If perception is fallible *and* is corrected by inference, then the very hierarchy Cārvāka asserts is inverted: inference becomes the tribunal before which perception is judged. A 15- or 20-mark answer that reproduces the Cārvāka case without meeting this rejoinder is one-sided.

ANALYSIS: **Best Cārvāka response available:** the errors Sharma lists are corrected by **further perception plus practical checking**, not by pure inference - and a fallibilist Cārvāka can concede correction within perception while still denying that any *unperceivable* entity is established by it. That reply is decent for the flat-earth case and weak for the heliocentric case, and you should say so.

Exam link

Primary routes: 2019 Q5(c), 2019 Q6(c) and 2025 Q5(a). Reconstruct *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* through the three-door argument, add *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, then face self-refutation.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not write that the Cārvāka says the syllogism is **invalid**. He says the major premise is ungrounded, and that deduction is therefore circular.
2. FACT: Do not give the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* example backwards. The standard case is inferring **smoke from fire**, which fails because the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* of **wet fuel** was unnoticed.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not omit the *sāmānya* / class-character exchange. It is the difference between a textbook answer and a top answer.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not present the self-refutation charge without the Cārvāka's replies. A one-sided demolition scores poorly on "critically examine".
5. ANALYSIS: Do not claim all inference is literally impossible for the Cārvāka. Distinguish *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status from everyday expectation and practical action.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not forget Door 3's second bolt: if inference rested on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not ignore Sharma's *tu quoque* about perceptual error. Meeting it is what "critically evaluate" means.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not treat the causal-relation escape as untouched. A causal relation is itself a species of invariable relation and inherits the same problem.

Revision notes

- FACT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally".
- FACT: The attack is on the **major premise (vyāpti)**, never on syllogistic form.
- FACT: **Door 1 (perception)**: all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed.
- FACT: **Class-character reply**: even *dhūmatva* and *vahnitva* cannot be perceptually known, since all instances are not perceived; and universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference.
- FACT: **Door 2 (inference)**: *petitio principii* or infinite regress; deduction is circular, induction unwarranted.
- FACT: Causal relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect.
- FACT: **Door 3 (testimony)**: testimony's validity is itself inferred; and "if inference always depended on testimony, no one could infer anything by himself."
- FACT: **Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)**: the wet-fuel condition; unconditionality can never be perceptually certified because conditions may remain hidden.
- FACT: *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is a problem of the *right variable*, not merely of *sample size* - which is why more observation alone cannot answer it.
- FACT: **Self-refutation**: the universal denial of inference is itself a universal; and other minds, thoughts and ideas are never perceived.
- ANALYSIS: **Three replies**: no-thesis (*vitaṇḍā*) · softened certainty-thesis · level-distinction. The second is strongest; the third is a repair, not a historical doctrine.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's tu quoque**: flat earth, static earth, small sun - perception errs and is corrected *by inference*.
- ANALYSIS: **Verdict formula**: the Cārvāka may be consistent or radical, but not both.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti), HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (upādhi), THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM AND SELF-REFUTATION

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | THE CRITIQUE OF INFERENCE - INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti), HIDDEN LIMITING

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

invariable concomitance (vyāpti) ·
hidden limiting condition (upādhi) ·

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some
inferences are true only

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

This is why the correct one-line
statement of the doctrine is: the

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Against the uncompromising
formulation the self-refutation charge is

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) critique argues that

SESSION 4 - THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

Technical definition: The question says "the other systems" - plural - and asks for your own verdict as a third limb.
ANALYSIS: Do not present Advaita as agreeing with Cārvāka about inference.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- repeated observation (bhūyodarśana)
- agreement in presence (anvaya)
- agreement in absence (vyatireka)
- hypothetical reasoning (tarka)
- counterexample
- defeasible warrant

How to use them: Present Nyāya's combined method of positive and negative instances, removal of defeating conditions and hypothetical reasoning (tarka), then evaluate whether it yields certainty or only rational defeasibility.

EXAM-READY LINE: Nyāya (school of logic and realism) replies that repeated observation, agreement and difference, hypothetical reasoning (tarka) and the elimination of hidden limiting condition (upādhi) (hidden limiting conditions) justify defeasible but rationally warranted inference.

Plain-language visual - Nyaya's repair workshop

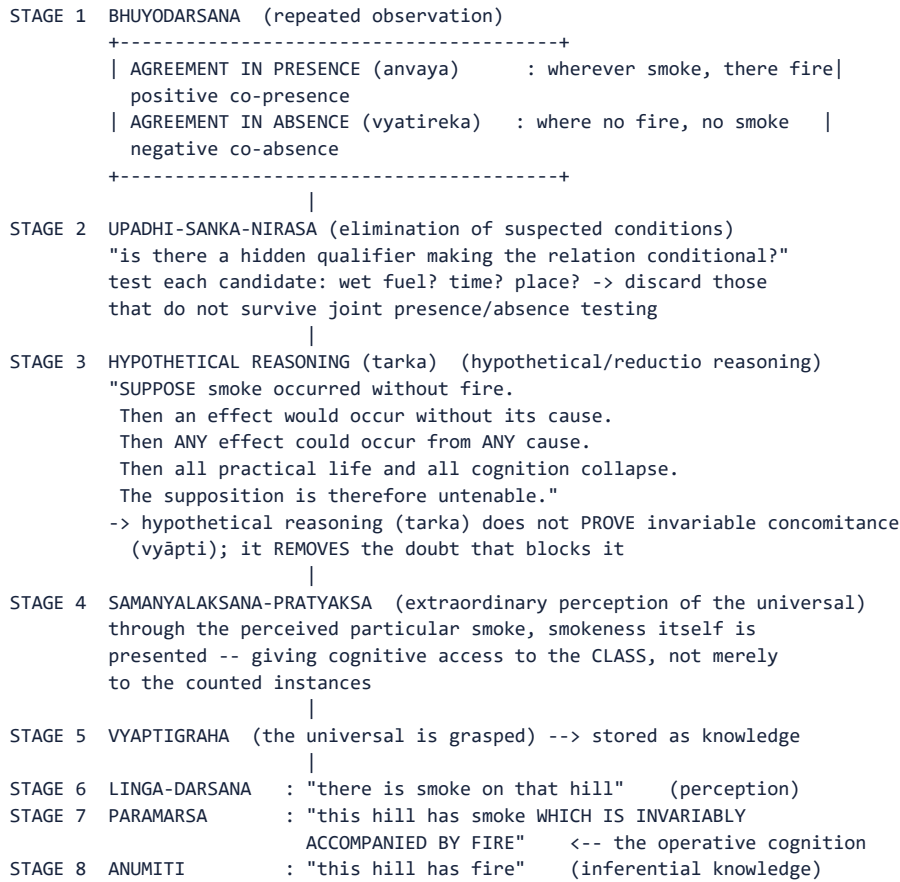
Repeated agreement: where smoke, there fire	(anvaya)
Repeated absence: where no fire, no smoke	(vyatireka)
Search for hidden conditions	(upadhi test)
Reject absurd alternatives	(tarka)
Apply the tested rule to this hill	(paramarsa)

In simple words: Nyāya does not claim that one casual observation proves a universal rule. It builds confidence through positive cases, negative cases, elimination of hidden conditions and rational testing. The final inference occurs when the tested universal relation is applied to the present case.

Cārvāka challenge	Nyāya reply
You have not seen every case	Universal features and systematic observation matter
A hidden condition may exist	Actively search for and eliminate <i>upādhis</i>
Inference is circular	<i>Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)</i> and repeated agreement/disagreement support <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i>

One-line memory: Nyāya answers "blind generalisation" with a disciplined method of testing.

VISUAL: VISUAL - How Nyāya actually builds a invariable concomitance (vyāpti), step by step



ANALYSIS: Caption. The Cārvāka argues as if *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* had to be acquired in one impossible act of total enumeration. Nyāya's reply is architectural: *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is **assembled** through five distinguishable operations, and the burden of certainty is distributed across them. Reproducing this eight-stage ladder is the single most effective way to show an examiner that you understand what Cārvāka is actually up against.

1. Why Nyāya cannot simply concede

ANALYSIS: Nyāya is the school of *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-theory. If inference falls, then *comparison (upamāna)* falls with it, *verbal testimony (śabda)* loses its warrant, the proofs of God (*kāryāt, āyojanāt, dhṛtyādeḥ, padāt/śruteḥ*) collapse, the atomic theory becomes unstateable, and the Nyāya proofs of the self go with them. The Cārvāka attack is therefore not a peripheral irritant but an existential threat, which is why the Naiyāyika reply is so highly developed.

2. Agreement in presence (anvaya) and agreement in absence (vyatireka) - the joint method

FACT: The doctrine. *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is established by **bhūyodarśana**, repeated observation, but of a particular disciplined kind:

Method	Sanskrit	Form	Function
Method of agreement	agreement in presence (anvaya)	Wherever <i>hetu</i> , there <i>sādhya</i>	Establishes positive co-presence across varied cases
Method of difference	agreement in absence (vyatireka)	Wherever <i>sādhya</i> is absent, <i>hetu</i> is absent	Rules out cases where the mark occurs without the probandum
Joint method	anvaya-vyatireka	Both together	The absence of a single counter-instance across wide, varied observation

ANALYSIS: The philosophical point to make explicit. The Cārvāka treats repeated observation as mere counting. Nyāya treats it as **structured testing**: it is not the number of positive cases that matters but the survival of the relation through deliberate search for **negative** cases. A relation that survives systematic attempts to find *hetu*-without-*sādhya*

has a warrant that a mere tally does not.

3. Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)-elimination - meeting the Cārvāka's strongest weapon

FACT: The Nyāya procedure. An *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is defined technically as a condition that pervades the *sādhya* but does not pervade the *hetu*. To test a suspected relation, the Naiyāyika asks whether any such condition can be found; where one is found, the *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is reformulated to include it.

```
BAD INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti) : "wherever fire, there smoke"
HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (upādhi) FOUND: wet fuel (ardra-indhana)
REPAIR      : "wherever fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke"
RESULT      : the conditional relation is not abandoned -- it is
              RESTATED at the correct level of generality.
```

ANALYSIS: The concession Nyāya must make, and an honest answer states it. Nyāya can eliminate *suspected* and *known upādhis*. It cannot demonstrate that **no hidden limiting condition (upādhi)** whatever remains undetected. What it claims instead is that a relation which survives systematic testing, negative-case search and *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* is **rationally warranted**, not that it is guaranteed by an omniscient survey.

ANALYSIS: The move that decides the debate. Nyāya shifts the standard from **impossible omniscience** to **disciplined rational warrant**. The Cārvāka has set a bar - indubitability plus correspondence - that nothing except present perception could clear, and even present perception clears it only if perceptual error is ignored. Nyāya's reply is that this bar is not a criterion of knowledge but a recipe for its abolition.

4. Hypothetical reasoning (tarka) - the argument the Cārvāka has no answer to

FACT: What hypothetical reasoning (tarka) is. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* is hypothetical reasoning, *reductio ad absurdum*: it assumes the contradictory of the proposed relation and exhibits the unacceptable consequence. It is expressly **not** an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* in Nyāya; it is a *pramāṇa-anugrahaka* - an auxiliary that removes doubt so that *vyāptigraha* can occur.

```
SUPPOSE : smoke without fire
THEN     : an effect exists without its cause
THEN     : the causal order is arbitrary
THEN     : no expectation, no action, no discourse, no refutation
BUT      : the Carvaka HIMSELF acts, expects, argues and refutes
THEREFORE: the supposition is untenable (anista-prasanga)
```

ANALYSIS: Why this is so powerful against Cārvāka specifically. The Cārvāka concedes that people act on inference and that action often succeeds. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* converts that concession into a premise: the intelligibility of the Cārvāka's own practice - including the practice of arguing against Nyāya - presupposes the very regularities he refuses to certify. The Cārvāka can escape only by retreating to the softened thesis (Subtopic 3, reply R2), at which point the dispute becomes verbal rather than doctrinal.

5. Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa - Nyāya's direct answer to the class-character objection

FACT: The doctrine. Nyāya admits an extraordinary (*alaukika*) perception in which, through a perceived particular, the **universal** itself is presented - smokeness through this smoke. The authored Nyāya file records the trap explicitly: it is an error to say that universals are not perceived in Nyāya; they are, through *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.

ANALYSIS: The exchange, laid out for the answer script:

Move	Claim
Cārvāka	FACT: You cannot perceive all smokes; therefore you cannot perceive smokeness; therefore you have no universal
Nyāya	FACT: The universal is not reached by adding up particulars; it is presented in any particular through extraordinary perception
Cārvāka rejoinder	ANALYSIS: <i>Sāmānyalakṣaṇa</i> is a technical device invented precisely to plug the hole; it is theory-laden, not independently attested
Assessment	ANALYSIS: Honest verdict: the device does real work inside Nyāya's realism about universals, but it will not convince anyone who does not already accept that realism. The debate here bottoms out in ontology, not in epistemology

6. Parāmarśa - what actually generates the inferential cognition

FACT: **The doctrine.** In Nyāya, inferential knowledge (*anumiti*) is produced by a specific operative cognition (*karaṇa*) called **parāmarśa**: the cognition of the mark as *qualified* by its invariable concomitance - "this hill possesses smoke, which is invariably accompanied by fire."

ANALYSIS: **Why this matters against Cārvāka.** The Cārvāka pictures inference as a **leap** across a gap: from perceived smoke, jump to unperceived fire. Nyāya's analysis denies that there is any leap at all. What produces the conclusion is a single complex cognition in which the mark is *already* apprehended under the concomitance. There is no moment at which the mind is stranded between premises with a chasm to cross.

ANALYSIS: **A memorable line for the answer:** *For Cārvāka, inference is a jump in the dark; for Nyāya, it is a step taken in the light of a concomitance already grasped.*

7. The Nyāya counter-attack on perception

FACT: Sharma reports this as the decisive counter-move, and it was set out in Subtopic 3 Section 8: perception itself errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - "such perceptual knowledge is contradicted by **inference**." And, following the *Tattvasaṅgraha*, "pure perception in the sense of mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless **conception or thought** has arranged into order and has given meaning and significance to the loose threads of sense-data."

ANALYSIS: **The structural result, and it is a genuine reversal:**

CARVAKA'S PICTURE	NYAYA'S CORRECTED PICTURE
-----	-----
perception = certain	perception = fallible, and CORRECTED by inference
inference = derivative	inference = the tribunal that corrects perception
hierarchy: P > I	hierarchy: neither is self-sufficient; perception supplies content, inference supplies order and correction

ANALYSIS: **Note the Nyāya distinction that keeps this honest:** Nyāya distinguishes **nirvikalpaka** (indeterminate, pre-predicative) from **savikalpaka** (determinate, qualified) perception. Only determinate perception is judgemental - and determinate perception already involves conceptual qualification. The Cārvāka's "pure given" is therefore, on the Nyāya analysis, either pre-cognitive and useless, or already conceptually shaped and therefore not the innocent bedrock he supposes.

Exam link

Primary route: 2018 Q8(b); cross-link 2022 Q7(c). Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons, and a criterion-named verdict on whether they are justified.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. ANALYSIS: Do not say Nyāya "proves" *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) with certainty. It claims disciplined warrant and eliminates *suspected* conditions.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not call *hypothetical reasoning* (*tarka*) a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*). It is *pramāṇa-anugrāhaka*, an auxiliary that removes doubt.
3. FACT: Do not write that Nyāya denies the perception of universals. It affirms it through *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not omit *parāmarśa*. Without it, you cannot explain why Nyāya denies that inference is a "leap" at all.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not answer 2018 Q8(b) with only one school. The question says "the other systems" - plural - and asks for your own verdict as a third limb.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not present Advaita as agreeing with Cārvāka about inference. Advaita's denial is at the *pāramārthika* level and applies to perception equally.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not forget Nyāya's *nirvikalpaka* / *savikalpaka* distinction when replying to the "pure given" assumption.

Revision notes

- FACT: *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is built by **bhūyodarśana**, disciplined as **agreement in presence (anvaya)** (co-presence) and **agreement in absence (vyatireka)** (co-absence).
- FACT: **Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)**-elimination repairs a defective universal by restating it at the correct level of generality - "fire **with wet fuel**, there smoke".
- FACT: **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** is hypothetical *reductio* reasoning; it is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* but removes the doubt blocking *vyāptigraha*.
- FACT: *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*'s force against Cārvāka: his own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify.
- FACT: **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular.
- FACT: **Parāmarśa** - the cognition of the mark as qualified by concomitance - is the *karaṇa* of *anumiti*; hence no "leap".
- FACT: The eight-stage ladder: *bhūyodarśana* -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*-elimination -> *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* -> *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* -> *vyāptigraha* -> *liṅga-darśana* -> *parāmarśa* -> *anumiti*.
- FACT: Sharma's counter-attack: perception errs (flat earth, static earth, small sun) and is corrected **by inference**.
- FACT: *Tattvasaṅgraha* point: mere sensation is not knowledge until conception orders "the loose threads of sense-data".
- ANALYSIS: Nyāya's decisive move: replace **omniscient certainty** with **disciplined warrant** as the standard for *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-hood.
- ANALYSIS: Honest residue: *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing alone; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* presupposes realism about universals; undetected *upādhis* cannot be excluded in principle.
- ANALYSIS: 2018 Q8(b) has **three** limbs - is it accepted, why not, and are the objectors justified. Answer all three.
- ANALYSIS: Verdict formula: Cārvāka loses the war and wins a battle - inference survives as warranted, not as indubitable.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW THE NYĀYA DEFENCE OF INFERENCE - AND A CRITICALLY BALANCED VERDICT			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS repeated observation (bhūyodarśana) - agreement in presence (anvaya)	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Nyāya's reply is architectural: invariable concomitance (vyāpti) is	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The question says "the other systems" - plural - and asks for your own	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Invariable concomitance (vyāpti) is established by bhūyodarśana,
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Answer all three limbs: rejection by other schools, their reasons,			

SESSION 5 - METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND EXPLANATION THROUGH NATURAL PROPERTIES (svabhāvavāda)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: The elemental ledger is therefore the neatest possible demonstration that Cārvāka metaphysics is epistemology applied.

Technical definition: Cārvāka materialism recognises earth, water, fire and air, rejects inferred ether, and explains bodies and consciousness through material combination and natural properties.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- four material elements (bhūtas)
- ether (ākāśa)
- natural properties (svabhāva)
- material combination
- emergence
- fermentation analogy

How to use them: Derive the four-element ontology from perceptualism, explain emergent consciousness through the fermentation analogy, and note that emergence is asserted more clearly than mechanistically explained.

CORE DEFINITION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that perceptible bhūtas (material elements) combine according to svabhāva (inherent nature) to produce the world, without requiring ākāśa (ether), a creator, or a supersensible cause.

Plain-language visual - matter first

EARTH + WATER + FIRE + AIR
|
organised combinations
|
body + senses + mind-like functions
|
consciousness emerges

AKASA is excluded because it is not directly perceived.

In simple words: Cārvāka accepts four perceptible elements and explains bodies and consciousness through their combinations. Consciousness need not exist separately before matter, just as an intoxicating power appears when ingredients ferment together.

Claim	Simple analogy
Consciousness emerges from matter	Red colour appears when betel ingredients combine
No separate soul-substance is needed	The living body itself is conscious
No creator is needed	Natural properties and combinations explain formation
No <i>ākāśa</i>	It is inferred from sound rather than directly perceived

One-line memory: organised matter produces life and consciousness; do not add an unseen substance without evidence.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The elemental ledger, and the one cell that is empty

	PR̥THIVĪ (earth)	AP (water)	TEJAS (fire)	VĀYU (air)	ĀKĀŚA (ether / space)
NYĀYA-VAIŚEṢIKA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
plus time (kāla), direction (dik), self (ātman) and mind (manas) = nine substances (dravyas)					
SĀṂKHYA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y (from the tanmātras)
JAINISM	matter is pudgala; ether (ākāśa) is a separate substance				
MĪMĀṂSĀ / VEDĀNTA	Y	Y	Y	Y	Y
CĀRVĀKA	Y	Y	Y	Y	-- NO -- ^^^^^^^^ the empty cell that carries the whole epistemology

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** One empty cell, and it is not an accident of cosmology. *Ākāśa* is refused for exactly the reason inference and testimony are refused: it is not perceived, it is **inferred**. The elemental ledger is therefore the neatest possible demonstration that Cārvāka metaphysics is epistemology applied. This visual answers the first half of the 2020 fifteen-marker on its own.

1. The bridging principle - ontology follows epistemology

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta state the derivation in a single sentence: "The Cārvāka theory of reality **follows from** the epistemological conclusion just discussed. If perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adr̥ṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

ANALYSIS: **The principle, formalised for the answer script:**

- P1. Only perception is a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
(epistemology)
- P2. Ontological commitment should not outrun the
reach of the means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) one accepts.
(bridging principle)
-
- C. Only perceptible entities may be admitted as real. (ontology)

ANALYSIS: **P2 is doing enormous work and is rarely noticed by candidates.** It is not a truth of logic. An opponent could accept P1 and yet hold that reality exceeds knowledge - that there are unknowable realities. Cārvāka refuses that gap: for him, what cannot in principle be presented in perception has no claim to be admitted. Naming P2 explicitly, and observing that it is a *presupposition* rather than a proof, is exactly the kind of move that separates a 60% script from an 80% script.

2. The four bhūtas

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - "earth, water, fire and air are the elements." And the second: *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viśaya-saṃjñā* - "bodies, senses and objects" are the results of the different combinations of these elements.

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta add the biological consequence explicitly: "Not only non-living material objects but also **living organisms**, like plants and animal bodies, are composed of these four elements, by the combination of which they are produced and to which they are **reduced on death**." There is no separate vital principle and no separate psychic substance.

FACT: Sharma adds the ontological refinement that many candidates miss: "**The elements are eternal, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution.**"

ANALYSIS: **This is a significant doctrinal point.** Cārvāka is not a philosophy of universal flux. The material elements are permanent; only configurations arise and perish. That gives Cārvāka a stable ontological substrate - and it is why the school is classified as a **realist** materialism rather than as a scepticism. It also sharpens the contrast with Buddhism (Subtopic 6) and with Jainism (Subtopic 8).

3. Why ākāśa is rejected - the 2020 question's first half

FACT: **The argument, in four steps.**

1. Earth, water, fire and air are each **perceptible**: they present themselves through manifest sensible qualities - solidity, fluidity, heat and light, motion and touch.
2. *Ākāśa* is **not** perceived as an entity. Chatterjee and Datta: the Cārvākas "reject ether, because its existence cannot be perceived; **it has to be inferred**." Sharma: "he rejects the fifth, the ether, because it is not perceived but inferred."
3. The inference in question is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika one: sound (*śabda* as a quality) is a quality; every quality must inhere in a substance; sound is not a quality of earth, water, fire, air, *enduring self* (*ātman*), *sensory mind* (*manas*), time or space; therefore there is a ninth-listed substance, *ākāśa*, as its unique substrate.
4. Since inference is not a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*), that argument cannot establish anything. Hence the world is composed of **four** elements.

ANALYSIS: **The exchange in table form**, which is what a 15-marker needs:

Move	Position
Vaiśeṣika	FACT: Sound is heard; qualities require substrates; by elimination the substrate is <i>ākāśa</i> , which is one, eternal, all-pervading and imperceptible
Cārvāka	FACT: The hearing of sound is perceptual; the <i>substrate</i> is not. The move from quality to imperceptible substance is an inference and inherits the whole <i>invariable concomitance</i> (<i>vyāpti</i>) problem
Vaiśeṣika rejoinder	ANALYSIS: Then sound is left without a bearer, and the doctrine that qualities inhere in substances is broken
Cārvāka reply	ANALYSIS: Either sound is a state of the perceptible air-medium, or the demand for a bearer is itself a metaphysical prejudice; positing an imperceptible substrate is an unnecessary multiplication
Assessment	ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka is consistent, and the cost is real: he must either naturalise sound into the air or abandon the substance-quality framework that his own four-element realism assumes

ANALYSIS: **The self-critical point that earns the highest marks on this question.** The Cārvāka accepts the four elements as *substances*. But if he accepts the substance-quality scheme for earth, water, fire and air, he cannot simply refuse it for sound without argument. His most defensible line is therefore **not** "qualities need no substrates" but "sound is a modification of perceptible air", which is a naturalising move rather than a sceptical one. Saying this shows you have thought past the textbook.

4. Consciousness from matter - emergent consciousness from material elements (*bhūta-caitanya-vāda*)

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - "consciousness [arises] from matter as the intoxicating power [arises] from fermenting agents."

FACT: **The problem the doctrine answers.** Chatterjee and Datta pose the objection sharply: "we do not perceive consciousness in **any** of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?"

FACT: **The Cārvāka reply - the emergence thesis and its two canonical analogies.**

Analogy	The ingredients	The novel property	The point made
Betel (<i>tāmbūla</i>)	Betel leaf, lime and areca nut - "none of which is originally red"	A reddish tinge, "when chewed together"	A property may appear in a combination that is present in no ingredient separately
Fermentation	Molasses (<i>guḍa</i>), "originally non-intoxicant"	Intoxicating power, "when allowed to ferment"	The same substance under a different condition may develop qualities originally absent

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta draw the conclusion: "In a similar way, it is possible to think that the material elements combined in a particular way give rise to the conscious living body. **Consciousness is an epiphenomenon or bye-product of matter**; there is no evidence of its existence independent of the body." Sharma reports the same doctrine and quotes the striking Western formulation used of it: "Matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile."

ANALYSIS: **Read the two analogies carefully, because they are not the same argument.**

BETEL : combination of DIFFERENT ingredients -> new quality
(structural / compositional emergence)

FERMENTATION: the SAME ingredient under a NEW CONDITION -> new quality
(processual / transformational emergence)

Together they block two different objections:

- (i) "consciousness is in none of the elements" -> betel answers it
- (ii) "the elements are the same before and after" -> fermentation answers it

ANALYSIS: **The explanatory gap, stated honestly - and this is what distinguishes a philosophical answer from a report.** Both analogies establish that **novel observable qualities** can arise from combination. Consciousness, however, is not an observable third-person quality like redness or intoxicating power. It is the *condition of observation itself* - subjective, first-personal, and, as Sharma notes, **private** in a way redness is not: consciousness "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". The analogies therefore establish emergence of the wrong logical type.

ANALYSIS: **The Cārvāka's best available reply**, which a fair answer must supply: positing an immaterial soul does not close the gap either - it **renames** it. To say "consciousness arises because there is a conscious substance" explains nothing that "consciousness arises from a specifically organised living body" does not; the dualist has bought a word, not an explanation. ANALYSIS: Assessment: the reply neutralises the dualist's claim to explanatory superiority without discharging the Cārvāka's own explanatory debt. Both sides face the gap; only one side pretends to have crossed it.

5. Why no God is needed - the pot-and-potter exchange and explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)

FACT: **The objection, in Chatterjee and Datta's exact form.** "Can the material elements by themselves give rise to this wonderful world? We find that even the production of an object like an earthen jar requires, in addition to **clay** which is its **material cause**, a **potter** who is the **efficient cause**, that shapes the material into the desired form. The four elements supply only the material cause of the world. Do we not require an efficient cause, like God, as the shaper and designer?"

FACT: **The Cārvāka reply.** "The material elements themselves have got each its **fixed nature (svabhāva)**. It is by the natures and laws inherent in them that they combine together to form this world. There is thus no necessity for God. **There is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design.** They can be explained more reasonably as the fortuitous products of the elements."

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta then supply the three technical labels, all of which should appear in a 10-marker on Cārvāka metaphysics:

Label	Sanskrit	Meaning	Textbook wording
Naturalism	<i>explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)</i>	The world is explained "only by nature"; things behave by their own inherent natures	FACT: "Insofar as this Cārvāka theory tries to explain the world only by nature, it is sometimes called naturalism"
Mechanism / accidentalism	<i>yadr̥cchāvāda</i>	Denies conscious purpose behind the world; explains it as "a mere mechanical or fortuitous combination of elements"	FACT: "It is also called mechanism (<i>yadr̥cchā-vāda</i>)"
Positivism	-	Believes "only in positive facts or observable phenomena"	FACT: "The Cārvāka theory on the whole may also be called positivism "

ANALYSIS: **Note carefully for the 2024 question:** the label "positivism" is not an examiner's invention or a modern imposition. It is applied to Cārvāka **by the standard textbook itself**, and with a stated reason. That is a decisive evidential point for Subtopic 9 and for the workbook's 2024 answer - although, as we shall see, the label still needs heavy qualification.

ANALYSIS: **A refinement on explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) that strengthens any answer.** *Svabhāva* is invoked twice in Cārvāka, at two different points, and they must not be confused:

- (1) EPISTEMOLOGICAL USE : "why is fire always hot and water cool?"
 -> because of their inherent natures; no supernatural principle is needed, AND "there is neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future."
 (Chatterjee & Datta)
- (2) COSMOLOGICAL USE : "who arranged the world?"
 -> nothing did; the elements combine by their own natures; no designer is required.

ANALYSIS: Use (1) is a **deflationary** appeal: "nature" is a label for observed regularity, deliberately not an explanatory power, and the Cārvāka refuses to guarantee its persistence. Use (2) is a **substantive** appeal: nature is doing real cosmological work in place of God. The obvious objection - that "nature" is an empty word unless analysed - bites hard on use (2) and hardly at all on use (1). Separating them is the most sophisticated move available in this subtopic.

6. How many materialisms? Sadānanda's fourfold classification

FACT: Sharma records, from Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra*, that **four** different materialist schools were distinguished by their identification of the self:

Variant	The self is identified with	Sanskrit
1	The gross body	<i>sthūla śarīra</i>
2	The senses	<i>indriya</i>
3	The vital breaths	<i>prāṇa</i>
4	The mental organ	<i>sensory mind (manas)</i>

FACT: Sharma adds: "All the schools agree in regarding the soul as a **product of matter**." He also records Śāntarakṣita's report that the materialist *Kambalāśvatara* held that consciousness arises out of the material body **associated with vital breaths**.

ANALYSIS: **Exam value**. This single table shows that "Cārvāka" names a **family** of materialist positions, not a monolith. It supports the source-caution of Subtopic 1, it forestalls the objection that the school was crude and undifferentiated, and it gives you a precise, citable internal differentiation almost no other candidate will have.

Exam link

Primary route: the first half of 2020 Q6(b). Derive four-element materialism and the rejection of *ākāśa* from the epistemic rule, then evaluate emergence without calling it modern science.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

- FACT: **Four elements, not five**. This is the single most examined factual trap in the topic.
- FACT: Do not say Cārvāka "does not know of" *ākāśa*. He knows the Vaiśeṣika argument for it and rejects it, precisely because it is inferential.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies the reality of sound. He denies the inference from sound to an imperceptible substrate.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say the elements are impermanent. Sharma: "the elements are eternal, but their combinations undergo production and dissolution."
- ANALYSIS: Do not present the betel and fermentation analogies as one analogy. They answer two different objections - compositional and transformational emergence.
- ANALYSIS: Do not claim the analogies solve the problem of consciousness. State the explanatory gap **and** the Cārvāka's reply that dualism merely renames it.
- ANALYSIS: Do not translate *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* as "scientific naturalism". It is a metaphysical refusal of teleology, not an experimental programme.
- ANALYSIS: Do not forget *yadrucchāvāda*. The denial of purpose is a distinct thesis from the affirmation of inherent natures, and the two sit together somewhat uneasily.

9. ANALYSIS: Do not treat "Cārvāka" as one uniform doctrine. The *Vedāntasāra* records four materialist identifications of the self.

Revision notes

- FACT: **Bridging principle**: ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇas*). Name it as a presupposition, not a proof.
- FACT: *pr̥thivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - four elements; and *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viṣaya-saṃjñā* - bodies, senses and objects from their combination.
- FACT: Living bodies too are elemental combinations, "reduced on death" to the elements.
- FACT: **The elements are eternal; only their combinations arise and perish** (Sharma).
- FACT: *Ākāśa* is rejected "because it is not perceived but inferred" - the Vaiśeṣika sound-to-substrate inference is refused.
- FACT: *kiṇvātibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - consciousness arises as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents.
- FACT: **Betel** = compositional emergence (leaf, lime, nut -> red). **Fermentation** = transformational emergence (*guḍa* -> intoxicant).
- FACT: Consciousness is an "epiphenomenon or by-product of matter"; "matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile."
- ANALYSIS: **Explanatory gap**: redness and intoxication are third-person properties; consciousness is private and first-personal. The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap rather than closing it.
- FACT: **Pot-and-potter**: the objector needs an efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* and denies that design is proved.
- FACT: Three labels from the textbook: **naturalism** (*svabhāvavāda*), **mechanism** (*yadṛcchāvāda*), and **positivism** ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena").
- ANALYSIS: Separate the **deflationary** use of *svabhāva* (regularity, with no guarantee of future uniformity) from the **substantive** cosmological use (nature in place of God).
- FACT: *Vedāntasāra*: four materialist schools identify the self with gross body, senses, vital breaths, or *sensory mind* (*manas*).
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's materialism is anti-inferential; modern materialism is thoroughly inferential. Same conclusion, opposite method.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND EXPLANATION THROUGH NATURAL PROPERTIES (*svabhāvavāda*)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | METAPHYSICS AND MATERIALISM - FOUR BHŪTAS, THE REJECTION OF ĀKĀŚA, AND EXPLANATION

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE
four material elements (bhūtas) · ether (ākāśa) · natural properties	The Cārvāka's best reply is that the soul-hypothesis renames the gap	The elemental ledger is therefore the nearest possible demonstration	State the explanatory gap and the Cārvāka's reply that dualism merely

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) materialism holds that

SESSION 6 - SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - CONSCIOUS BODY AS SELF (*dehātmavāda*), AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Conscious body as self (*dehātmavāda*) (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist *anātman* (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

Technical definition: FACT: The transmitted formula: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* - "the person is the body qualified by consciousness"; and, in Chatterjee and Datta's rendering of the Cārvāka position, "What people mean by

a soul is nothing more than this conscious living body (caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā).".

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda) (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)**
- **emergent consciousness**
- **body-property**
- **enduring self (ātman)**
- **Buddhist no-self (anātman)**
- **causal stream**

How to use them: Contrast Cārvāka's identity of self with the living conscious body against Buddhism's analysis of the person as a dependently arisen causal stream.

CORE DEFINITION: Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda) (doctrine that the body is the self) explains consciousness as an emergent property of the living body, whereas Buddhist anātman (no-permanent-self doctrine) analyses the person as a causal continuum without identifying self and body.

Plain-language visual - two different denials of a permanent soul

CARVAKA	BUDDHISM
living body = conscious self	changing five aggregates
continuity of body explains "I"	causal continuity explains "I"
no body-independent enduring self (ātman)	no permanent substance at all

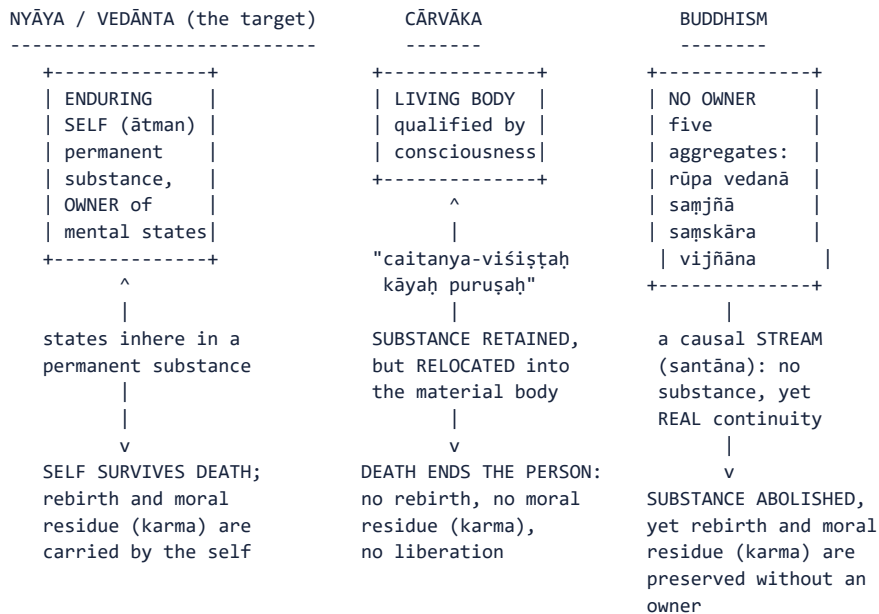
In simple words: Cārvāka does not deny the everyday person; it identifies the person with the conscious living body. Buddhism also rejects a permanent *enduring self (ātman)*, but analyses the person as a changing causal stream rather than as one material body.

Test	Cārvāka answer
What is the self?	The body qualified by consciousness
Why say "I am strong"?	The first-person predicate applies directly to the body
What happens at death?	The organised body dissolves; consciousness ends
Main difficulty	Explaining memory, unity and personal identity fully

One-line memory: Cārvāka is body-self theory; Buddhism is no-substance process theory.

VISUAL: VISUAL - Three ways of denying the transcendental self (they are not the same denial)

THE QUESTION: what am I?



ANALYSIS: **Caption.** This single diagram is the answer to the 2024 twenty-marker. Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into a process. One keeps a bearer and changes its nature; the other removes the bearer altogether. The moral and soteriological consequences then diverge completely: Cārvāka's denial ends the moral story at death, while Buddhism's denial is designed precisely to keep the moral story running without an owner.

1. Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda) - the doctrine stated exactly

FACT: **The transmitted formula:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ* - "the person is the body qualified by consciousness"; and, in Chatterjee and Datta's rendering of the Cārvāka position, "What people mean by a soul is nothing more than this **conscious living body** (*caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā*)."

ANALYSIS: **Read the formula carefully - every word is load-bearing:**

CAITANYA-VISISTA	: QUALIFIED BY CONSCIOUSNESS -> not any body; the LIVING body
KAYAH	: THE BODY -> the perceptible material organism
PURUSAH / ATMA	: IS the person / IS the self -> identity, not correlation

ANALYSIS: **Three misreadings to avoid**, each of which has sunk otherwise good answers:

1. It is **not** "the self is the corpse". The self is the *living, conscious* body; consciousness is the qualifier that makes a body a self.
2. It is **not** "there is no self". There is a self; it is material. Cārvāka is not an eliminativist about persons.
3. It is **not** "consciousness is identical with any one element". Consciousness belongs to the **organised** body-complex, as the emergence analogies establish.

2. The argument for conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)

FACT: **Step 1 - the negative argument.** "The non-material soul is **never perceived**" (Chatterjee and Datta). What internal perception delivers is a state, not a substance behind the state.

FACT: **Step 2 - the positive argument from ordinary first-person judgements.** This is the Cārvāka's most distinctive and most quotable move: "we have **direct evidence of the identity of the self with the body** in our daily experiences and judgments like, 'I am fat,' 'I am lame,' 'I am blind.' If the 'I', the self, were different from the body, these would be **meaningless**."

ANALYSIS: **The logic of the argument from first-person statements, reconstructed:**

1. In ordinary speech, bodily predicates are attached directly to "I":
I am fat; I am lame; I am blind; I am hungry; I am tall.
2. Predication of this kind is intelligible only if the SUBJECT and the BEARER of the predicate are the same thing.
3. If "I" named an immaterial soul, "I am fat" would be a CATEGORY MISTAKE -- as odd as "the number seven is blue".
4. But these statements are not category mistakes; they are the ordinary currency of self-description.
5. Therefore "I" refers to the body.

ANALYSIS: The dualist's standard reply, and the Cārvāka's rejoinder. The dualist answers that such expressions are **figurative** - the soul speaks of *its* body as a person speaks of "my house". The Cārvāka's rejoinder is that the figurative reading is a **theory-driven reinterpretation** of language, adopted only to save a doctrine that has no independent perceptual support; and that "my body" and "I am lame" are not on a par, since no one says "my body is lame, therefore I am figuratively lame" in the natural course of speech. **ANALYSIS: Assessment:** the argument does not *prove* materialism, but it correctly shifts the burden onto the dualist to explain why ordinary self-ascription runs the way it does.

FACT: Step 3 - the argument from covariation. The authored knowledge file records the standard supporting evidence: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease visibly alter awareness. Consciousness tracks the states of the body with a fidelity that would be inexplicable if it belonged to something else.

FACT: Step 4 - the consequence. Chatterjee and Datta: "If the existence of a soul apart from the body is not proved, there is no possibility of proving its immortality. On the contrary, **death of the body means the end of the individual.** All questions about previous life, after-life, rebirth, enjoyment of the fruits of actions in heaven or hell, therefore, become **meaningless.**"

ANALYSIS: Note the word Chatterjee and Datta use twice: *meaningless*, not merely false. That is a quasi-verificationist register, and it is a genuine evidential asset for the 2024 "positivism" question - though it must be used carefully, since the Cārvāka has no explicit theory of meaning.

3. The objections - Sharma's full battery, and the Cārvāka's replies

ANALYSIS: This is the richest objection-set in Indian philosophy, and reproducing four or five of these with replies is what turns a 12/20 into an 16/20. Sharma sets them out at length; each is paired below with the best available Cārvāka answer.

#	Objection (Sharma)	Best Cārvāka reply	Residual pressure
1	Self-consciousness. If consciousness means <i>self</i> -consciousness, it cannot be identified with the living body, since animals have living bodies without rational consciousness	ANALYSIS: Only a particular combination of elements, obtaining in the human body, produces consciousness; so no counter-example arises from animals	ANALYSIS: Sharma calls this "wrong": it makes consciousness essential to a specific organisation, which invites objection 2
2	Separability. If consciousness were an essential property of the living body it would be inseparable from it. But "in swoons, fits, epilepsy, dreamless sleep etc. the living body is seen without consciousness"	ANALYSIS: These are states in which the relevant <i>organisation</i> is disrupted; the property is essential to the organisation, not to bare bodily existence	ANALYSIS: Strong reply, but it moves the doctrine from "body" to "functional organisation", which is a real concession
3	Dream-consciousness. "In dreams, consciousness is seen without the living body"; the dreamer on waking disowns the dream-body but owns the dream-consciousness	ANALYSIS: The dreaming subject is the sleeping physical body; the dream-body is imagined content, not a second body	ANALYSIS: The reply is decent; Sharma's inference that consciousness therefore "persists through" waking, dream and deep sleep already presupposes the Vedāntic three-state argument
4	Subject-object asymmetry. "The subject, the knower, cannot be reduced to the object, the known, since all objects presuppose the existence of the subject"; the subject is enjoyer, the object enjoyed	ANALYSIS: A material organism can be both knower and known, as a hand can touch itself; asymmetry of <i>role</i> does not entail difference of <i>substance</i>	ANALYSIS: This is the deepest objection and it is not fully answered; it is the ancestor of the modern subjectivity problem

#	Objection (Sharma)	Best Cārvāka reply	Residual pressure
5	Co-existence is not causation. "The eye cannot see in darkness. Sight is not possible without light, yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; "the two horns of a bull which are always found together cannot be regarded as causally related." The body may be the instrument of consciousness, not its cause	ANALYSIS: Correct as logic - but the instrument-hypothesis needs an independent user, and no such user is perceived; the materialist hypothesis is the more economical of two unproven options	ANALYSIS: Genuinely undecided; both sides are arguing from the same evidence to different best explanations
6	Imperceptibility of the alleged property. "If consciousness is a property of the body, it must be perceived like other material properties. But it is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard "	ANALYSIS: It is perceived - by internal perception, which Cārvāka admits	ANALYSIS: But then the Cārvāka's own criterion has been stretched: internal perception delivers something with no external sensory mode, which is precisely the anomaly the dualist is pointing at
7	Privacy. A material property "should be known by all in the same manner and should not be private. But we find that consciousness is intimately private and consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others"	ANALYSIS: Privacy is explained by the <i>locality</i> of the organism: each body has its own internal states, as each fire has its own heat	ANALYSIS: The reply confuses <i>causal locality</i> with <i>epistemic inaccessibility</i> ; the objection retains real force
8	Self-manifestation regress. If consciousness is a property of the body, "why should the body, qualified to produce consciousness, itself stand in need of being manifested by consciousness?"	ANALYSIS: Being a producer of awareness and being an object of awareness are different roles, and one thing may play both	ANALYSIS: A fair reply, though it again concedes a role-distinction that dualists exploit
9	Symmetry of ignorance. "If the existence of the soul surviving death cannot be demonstrated, its non-existence too cannot be so demonstrated"	ANALYSIS: The Cārvāka's principle is asymmetrical by design: the burden lies on the one who <i>posits</i> an entity, not on the one who withholds assent	ANALYSIS: This exposes the difference between <i>not asserting</i> and <i>denying</i> , and most doxographies attribute outright denial rather than agnosticism to Cārvāka

ANALYSIS: **The single most useful evaluative sentence to carry from this table:** *Sharma's objections 2, 3 and 5 show that the Cārvāka's evidence establishes at most a dependence of consciousness on the body, and dependence is compatible with the body being the instrument rather than the cause - so the materialist conclusion is under-determined by the materialist's own evidence.* That sentence is worth reproducing in any answer on the Cārvāka self.

4. Memory and personal identity

ANALYSIS: **The objection.** Memory reaches across time: I remember what I did. What sustains the "I" through the constant replacement of bodily material? A permanent substance seems required.

ANALYSIS: **The three answers on the table, and the exam requires you to distinguish them:**

School	What secures the identity of the rememberer
Nyāya / Vedānta	FACT: A permanent <i>enduring self</i> (<i>ātman</i>) which is the single owner of past experience and present memory
Cārvāka	ANALYSIS: Bodily-psychological continuity: the same living organism persists, so the same organism that experienced now recalls. Memory is a bodily-mental trace in a continuing body
Buddhism	FACT: <i>Santāna</i> , the causal stream; memory belongs to the same causal continuum, reinforced by <i>pratisandhāna</i> (relinking), and in Yogācāra by <i>ālaya-vijñāna</i> carrying <i>bījas</i>

ANALYSIS: **The comparative point that examiners reward.** Cārvāka and Buddhism both reject the permanent owner, but they replace it with different things: Cārvāka with a **material continuant** (a body that endures), Buddhism with a **causal continuant** (a stream in which nothing endures). The Cārvāka answer is metaphysically cheaper and psychologically thinner; the Buddhist answer is metaphysically subtler and must work much harder, which is why it develops *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and eventually *ālaya-vijñāna*.

Exam link

Primary route: 2024 Q6(a), 20 marks. Use shared denial but different reconstruction: Cārvāka relocates self into body; Buddhism dissolves self into a causal process.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

1. FACT: **Never write that Cārvāka and Buddhism deny the self "in the same way"**. This is the exact error the 2024 question was designed to catch.
2. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies the self *simpliciter*. He denies a transcendental self and affirms a material one.
3. ANALYSIS: Do not say Buddhism reduces the person to the body. *Rūpa* is only one of five *skandhas*, and is itself denied selfhood.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka denies consciousness. He denies that consciousness needs an immaterial bearer.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not omit *santāna* when handling memory in Buddhism; and do not smuggle a soul into it.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not present Sharma's objections as unanswerable. Give the Cārvāka's reply and *then* assess.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not miss the asymmetry point: Cārvāka's denial ends the moral narrative; Buddhism's denial is constructed to continue it.
8. ANALYSIS: Do not forget the first-person statements - "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind". They are the Cārvāka's own positive argument and are frequently omitted.
9. ANALYSIS: Do not treat "death alone is liberation" as a serious soteriology. It is a *rejection* of soteriology expressed in soteriological vocabulary.

Revision notes

- FACT: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā* - the person is the **living** body qualified by consciousness.
- FACT: Negative argument: "the non-material soul is **never perceived**."
- FACT: Positive argument: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - bodily predicates attach directly to "I"; on dualism they would be meaningless.
- FACT: Covariation: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease alter awareness.
- FACT: Consequence: death of the body is the end of the individual; questions of rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless".
- FACT: **Sharma's objections**: swoon and dreamless sleep (body without consciousness) · dreams (consciousness without body) · subject cannot be reduced to object · co-existence is not causation (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is neither smelt, tasted, seen, touched nor heard · consciousness is **private** · non-existence of the soul is equally undemonstrable.
- ANALYSIS: Best evaluative line: the evidence establishes **dependence**, and dependence is compatible with the body being the **instrument** rather than the cause.
- FACT: Memory: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke *enduring self (ātman)*; Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity; Buddhism invokes *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and *ālaya-vijñāna*.
- FACT: **2024 contrast in one line**: Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into process.
- FACT: Cārvāka's ground is epistemic; Buddhism's is ontological (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*) and soteriological (self-belief breeds craving).
- FACT: Cārvāka rejects rebirth, action and moral consequence (karma) and *liberation (mokṣa)*; Buddhism retains rebirth, action and moral consequence (karma) and *cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)* without a self.
- ANALYSIS: *Rūpa* is one of the five *skandhas* - so Buddhist *anātman* refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**.
- ANALYSIS: **Puggalavāda** (Vātsīputrīya) is the internal Buddhist foil; **Sadānanda's four materialisms** are the internal Cārvāka foil.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - CONSCIOUS BODY AS SELF (dehātmavāda), AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS BUDDHIST ANĀTMAN (2024, 20 MARKS)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | SELF, BODY AND CONSCIOUSNESS - CONSCIOUS BODY AS SELF (dehātmavāda), AND CĀRVĀKA

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)
· emergent consciousness ·

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ /
caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā - the

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Use shared denial but different
reconstruction: Cārvāka relocates self

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

He denies a transcendental self and
affirms a material one. ANALYSIS: Do
not

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda) (doctrine that the body is the

SESSION 7 - THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma), REBIRTH, HEAVEN, LIBERATION (mokṣa), VEDA AND RITUAL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, action and its moral consequence across lives (karma), rebirth and liberation (mokṣa) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

Technical definition: FACT: Chatterjee and Datta name adṛṣṭa explicitly among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, action and its moral consequence across lives (karma), rebirth and liberation (mokṣa) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- creator God
- immortal soul
- action and moral consequence (karma)
- rebirth
- Vedic authority
- ritual efficacy

How to use them: Show how the perception criterion removes each transcendent entity in sequence, while distinguishing denial of Vedic authority from the narrower modern meaning of atheism.

CORE DEFINITION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul, action and its moral consequence across lives (karma), rebirth and liberation (mokṣa) because none is established by perception, and it rejects Vedic ritual authority as epistemically unsupported.

Plain-language visual - one rule removes seven unseen claims

Only perception is certain

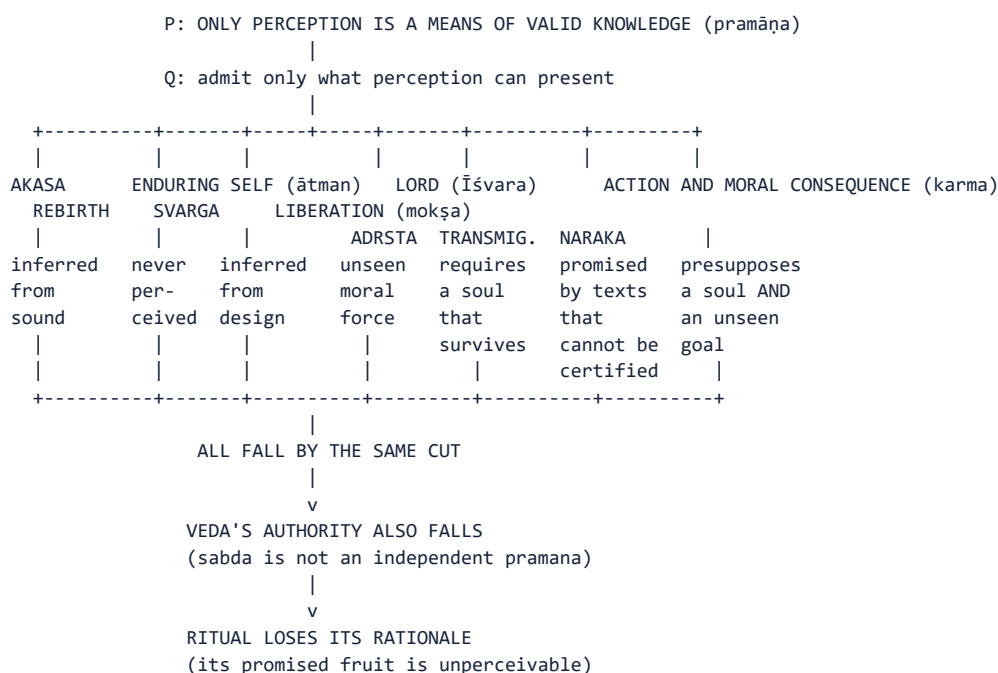
- |
- > no separate soul
- > no God
- > no unseen action and moral consequence (karma)/adrista
- > no rebirth
- > no heaven or hell
- > no liberation (mokṣa) after death
- > no infallible Vedic authority

In simple words: these denials are not seven unrelated opinions. Each follows from the same rule: if an entity can be reached only through inference or testimony, Cārvāka does not accept it as established knowledge.

Unseen claim	Why it falls
God	Known through design inference, which Cārvāka rejects
Action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth	Require an unseen moral force and a surviving carrier
Heaven, hell and liberation	Post-mortem states are not perceived
Vedic ritual	Scriptural testimony has no independent authority

One-line memory: epistemology is the root; rejection of transcendence is the branch.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The demolition tree: one premise, seven casualties



ANALYSIS: Caption. This tree is the answer to the 2021 ten-marker in diagram form. The examiner's phrase - "the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities" - asks for exactly this: not a list of denials, but the demonstration that a single epistemic cut severs them all at once.

1. The general form of every Cārvāka denial

ANALYSIS: Every denial in this subtopic instantiates one template. Learn the template, not the list.

1. X is claimed to exist.
2. X is not, and cannot in principle be, presented in perception.
3. The only routes to X are inference or scriptural testimony.
4. Neither inference nor testimony is an independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa).
5. Therefore there is no valid means by which X could be known.
6. Therefore X should not be admitted into our ontology.

ANALYSIS: The precision point at step 6. There is a real difference between *withholding assent* (agnosticism) and *denying* (atheism, in the broad sense). **CAUTION:** The doxographical sources overwhelmingly present Cārvāka as **denying** - "the Cārvākas, therefore, prefer atheism" (Chatterjee and Datta) - but the argument as stated licenses only the weaker conclusion. Sharma records the opposing school's exploitation of exactly this gap: "if the existence of the soul surviving death cannot be demonstrated, its **non-existence** too cannot be so demonstrated." A first-class answer notes the gap and states which reading it is defending.

2. God - and why explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) is the operative reason

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "God, whose existence cannot be perceived, **fares no better than the soul**. The material elements produce the world, and the supposition of a creator is unnecessary."

ANALYSIS: Two distinct arguments are at work, and separating them is worth marks:

Argument	Form	Force
Epistemic	God is imperceptible; the only routes to God are inference (the design and causal arguments) and <i>verbal testimony (śabda)</i> ; both are denied <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> -status	FACT: Removes the warrant for theism
Explanatory (<i>svabhāvavāda</i>)	Even granting the explanatory question, the fixed natures of the elements suffice; "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design"	FACT: Removes the need for theism

ANALYSIS: Note that the second argument is logically independent of the first, and is the more interesting one, because it engages Nyāya on Nyāya's own ground. Nyāya's *kāryāt* inference argues from the world as a composite **effect** to an intelligent efficient cause. The Cārvāka's *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* rejoinder does not merely say "you cannot know that"; it says "the explanandum is discharged without you". ANALYSIS: Chatterjee and Datta record the further Cārvāka move: the objects of the world "can be explained more reasonably as the **fortuitous** products of the elements" - which is *yadṛcchāvāda*, and which sits in some tension with a strong *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* that grounds regularity in fixed natures. Noting that internal tension is a genuinely advanced observation.

3. Action and moral consequence (karma), adṛṣṭa and the moral order

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta name *adṛṣṭa* explicitly among the casualties: "God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and **any unperceived law (like adṛṣṭa)** cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

ANALYSIS: **Why adṛṣṭa is the decisive test case.** *Adṛṣṭa* - "the unseen" - is by its own definition imperceptible. It is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and Mīmāṃsā device for connecting an act performed now with a fruit enjoyed later, sometimes in another life. The Cārvāka's objection is therefore not incidental but **definitional**: an entity whose name announces its imperceptibility is precisely what an epistemology of perception must refuse.

FACT: **The objection from moral order, and the Cārvāka's reply.** The authored knowledge file records the exchange: without *action and moral consequence (karma)* and rebirth, moral order is said to collapse. The Cārvāka answer is that "morality need not be underwritten by cosmic bookkeeping; human pain, pleasure, prudence, and social consequences are enough for practical conduct."

ANALYSIS: **Assessment to write.** The reply establishes that a *this-worldly* account of moral motivation is available; it does not establish that such an account can support obligations that run against self-interest with no observer. This is the enduring weak point of Cārvāka ethics and connects directly to Subtopic 8.

4. Rebirth and transmigration - the 2020 question's second half

FACT: **Exact question (2020, Q6(b), 15 marks).** "*Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul.*"

ANALYSIS: **What transmigration requires, and where Cārvāka cuts each requirement:**

Requirement of transmigration	Cārvāka's cut
(a) A self distinct from the body	FACT: <i>Conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)</i> : the self is the living body; no separable subject exists to migrate
(b) Survival of that self after bodily death	FACT: "Death of the body means the end of the individual"; the elements disperse, and the combination that carried consciousness is dissolved
(c) A carrier of moral desert across the gap	FACT: <i>Action and moral consequence (karma)</i> and <i>adṛṣṭa</i> are unperceived and hence unwarranted
(d) Knowledge that any of (a)-(c) obtains	FACT: Only scripture and inference could supply it; both are denied <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> -status

Requirement of transmigration	Cārvāka's cut
(e) Meaningfulness of the claim	ANALYSIS: Chatterjee and Datta report that questions about "previous life, after-life, rebirth, enjoyment of the fruits of actions in heaven or hell" become meaningless - a quasi-verificationist step

ANALYSIS: **The critical evaluation the question explicitly demands.** A "critically evaluate" question is not answered by exposition. Supply both sides:

STRENGTHS of the Carvaka position

- (i) consistency: the same criterion cuts akasa, enduring self (ātman) and rebirth alike
- (ii) economy: nothing unobservable is posited
- (iii) anti-exploitation: it removes the machinery on which ritual prescription and priestly authority rested
- (iv) it forces every rival school to say HOW an unseen bearer of desert is known -- a demand Nyaya answers only inferentially

WEAKNESSES

- (i) the argument rests on the rejection of inference, which is itself vulnerable (Subtopics 3-4)
- (ii) dependence of consciousness on the body does not entail production by the body (Sharma's instrument objection)
- (iii) "not established" is slid into "does not exist"
- (iv) the disappearance of moral continuity leaves desert and obligation without any ground beyond prudence
- (v) Sharma: the non-existence of a surviving soul is as undemonstrable as its existence

ANALYSIS: **Verdict formula for this question:** *The rejection of ākāśa and of transmigration are the same argument applied twice - once to cosmology and once to soteriology - and their force is exactly the force of the underlying epistemology. Where that epistemology is defensible, as a demand that metaphysical postulates earn their keep, the rejection is powerful; where it over-reaches, in converting "unestablished" into "unreal", the rejection outruns its warrant.*

5. Heaven, hell and liberation (mokṣa)

FACT: **Heaven.** Chatterjee and Datta: the Mīmāṃsakas hold that the highest goal is heaven (*svarga*), "a state of unalloyed bliss that can be attained hereafter by performing here the Vedic rites. **The Cārvāka rejects this view, because it is based on the unproved existence of a life after death.** 'Heaven' and 'hell' are the inventions of the priests whose professional interest lies in coaxing, threatening and making people perform the rituals. Enlightened men will always refuse to be duped by them."

FACT: **Liberation.** The Cārvāka argument is a dilemma, and it is elegant:

What could "liberation" mean?

HORN 1: freedom of the SOUL from bondage to physical existence
-> "absurd, because there is no soul"

HORN 2: attainment, IN THIS LIFE, of a state free from ALL pain
-> "an impossible ideal. Existence in this body is bound up with pleasure as well as pain."

RESIDUE: "Liberation in the sense of complete cessation of sufferings can only mean DEATH." -> maraṇam eva apavargah

FACT: Both horns and the residue are given verbatim in substance by Chatterjee and Datta, and the residue is one of the six transmitted *Bṛhaspati sūtras*.

ANALYSIS: **How to present maraṇam eva apavargah without caricature.** It is not a recommendation of death and it is not nihilism. It is a **reductio of the concept of liberation**: if *liberation (mokṣa)* means the total cessation of suffering, then the only state that satisfies the definition is the one no wise person would work for. The verse is a critique of the *coherence* of the goal, not an endorsement of dying. Saying this in one sentence is worth a mark and protects you from the commonest misreading in the topic.

6. The Veda, priestcraft and the ritual reductions

FACT: **The epistemic charge.** *Verbal testimony (śabda)* is not an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* (Subtopic 2); Vedic authority therefore has no certified standing. Claims of authorlessness or infallibility are not perceptually available.

FACT: **The sociological charge.** Chatterjee and Datta report it plainly: "in reality the Vedas are the works of some **cunning priests** who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous", and the tangible benefit of the rites goes to "the priests who officiate and enjoy the emoluments."

FACT: **The Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha summary**, as reproduced by Sharma, is the sharpest form of the polemic and should be used with an explicit source-caution: "There is no heaven, no final liberation, nor any soul in another world; nor do the actions of the four castes, orders etc. produce any real effect. The **Agnihotra**, the three Vedas, the ascetic's three staves and smearing one's self with ashes, were made by Nature as the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness... **(All the ceremonies are) a means of livelihood (for) Brāhmaṇas. The three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons.**"

FACT: **The three ritual reductions** - each is a genuine argument, not merely abuse, and each has the same logical shape: *take the ritual's own premise seriously, and derive an absurdity the practitioner will not accept.*

#	The reductio	The premise it tests	The absurdity generated
1	The śrāddha argument. If the food offered at the funeral ceremony can appease the hunger of the departed, "what is the use of a traveller's taking food with him? Why should not his people make some offerings in his name at home to satisfy his hunger?"	That an offering here nourishes a person elsewhere	ANALYSIS: Nourishment at a distance would make travel provisions pointless - a consequence no one accepts
2	The upstairs argument. "Food offered on the ground floor should satisfy a person living upstairs."	The same, in miniature	ANALYSIS: A vivid <i>reductio</i> of action-at-a-distance nourishment
3	The jyotiṣṭoma argument. "If the priests really believe, as they say, that the animals killed at a sacrifice are sure to reach heaven, why do they not rather sacrifice their own old parents instead of animals and make heaven sure for them?"	That ritual slaughter secures heaven for the victim	ANALYSIS: The priest's refusal reveals that he does not believe his own premise - an argument from revealed preference

ANALYSIS: **The philosophically important observation to add.** The *jyotiṣṭoma* argument is not a joke; it is an early and powerful use of **revealed preference** as evidence about belief. It says: your unwillingness to apply your doctrine where it would cost you shows that you do not hold it in the way you profess. That is a serious epistemic argument and deserves to be presented as one.

ANALYSIS: **The balance an answer must strike.** Chatterjee and Datta themselves describe the Cārvākas as raising "cheap laughter at the customary rites". An answer that reproduces only the abuse looks unserious; an answer that reproduces only the epistemology misses the school's historical bite. Present the polemic **and** extract the argument inside it.

Exam link

Primary routes: 2020 Q6(b) on transmigration and 2021 Q5(e) on the bearing of epistemology. Show one premise generating each denial rather than listing conclusions.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

- ANALYSIS: Do not present the denials as a list. Show the **derivation** from the single epistemic premise - that is what "bearing" means in 2021 Q5(e).
- ANALYSIS: Do not slide from "not established" to "does not exist" without noticing. Sharma exploits exactly that slide.

3. ANALYSIS: Do not read *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ* as a recommendation of death. It is a *reductio* of the concept of liberation.
4. ANALYSIS: Do not reduce the ritual criticisms to abuse. The *śrāddha* and *jyotiṣṭoma* arguments are genuine *reductios*, and the second is an argument from revealed preference.
5. ANALYSIS: Do not quote the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* invective without a source-caution; it is a summary preserved by an opponent.
6. ANALYSIS: Do not say "Cārvāka is the only atheist school in India". Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism are all non-theistic. Cārvāka is the only school whose atheism follows from its **epistemology** and which also discards action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation.
7. ANALYSIS: Do not forget *adr̥ṣṭa* by name. It is the perfect test case, since its name means "the unseen".
8. ANALYSIS: Do not miss the internal tension between *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) (fixed natures grounding regularity) and *yadr̥cchāvāda* (fortuitous combination). Noting it is a mark of independent thought.

Revision notes

- FACT: **The template:** X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*) -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected.
- ANALYSIS: Note the gap between withholding assent and denying; the doxographies attribute denial, the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion.
- FACT: God falls twice over: **epistemically** (no *pramāṇa*) and **explanatorily** (*svabhāva* suffices; "no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design").
- FACT: *Adr̥ṣṭa* is named explicitly among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like *adr̥ṣṭa*)".
- FACT: Transmigration requires a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three; Cārvāka cuts every one.
- FACT: Heaven and hell are "the inventions of the priests"; *svarga* is rejected because it rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death".
- FACT: **The liberation dilemma:** freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) or freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain); residue - *marāṇam eva apavargaḥ*.
- FACT: **Three ritual reductios:** *śrāddha* and the traveller's food · food downstairs for a person upstairs · *jyotiṣṭoma* and "why not sacrifice their own old parents".
- FACT: *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*: Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes are "the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons" - quote with a source-caution.
- ANALYSIS: The *jyotiṣṭoma* argument is an argument from **revealed preference** about what the priest actually believes.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is not the only non-theistic Indian school; it is the only one whose atheism is generated **epistemologically**, and the only one that also discards action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation (*mokṣa*).
- ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth noting: *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) grounds regularity in fixed natures, while *yadr̥cchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products".

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE (karma), REBIRTH, HEAVEN, LIBERATION (mokṣa), VEDA AND RITUAL

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW THE REJECTION OF TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES - GOD, SOUL, ACTION AND MORAL CONSEQUENCE			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS creator God · immortal soul · action and moral consequence (karma) ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT The template: X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Cārvāka is the only school whose atheism follows from its epistemology	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not miss this limiting distinction: FACT: The <i>Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha</i>
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) rejects God, an immortal soul,			

SESSION 8 - ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

Technical definition: Cārvāka ethics prioritises attainable goods in embodied life and criticises unseen ritual rewards, while its social significance lies in challenging priestly and metaphysical authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- this-worldliness
- pleasure (kāma)
- material well-being (artha)
- prudential hedonism
- ritual critique
- Jaina plural realism

How to use them: Frame Cārvāka ethics as embodied this-worldliness rather than reckless indulgence, then contrast its materialism with Jaina souls, action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation.

CORE DEFINITION: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent this-worldly well-being rather than crude hedonism: pleasure is valuable, pain is a cost, and action requires intelligent calculation within embodied social life.

Plain-language visual - the purpose-of-life filter

DHARMA -> rejected as scripture-dependent
MATERIAL WELL-BEING (artha) -> accepted as a means
PLEASURE (kāma) -> accepted as the final this-worldly end
LIBERATION (mokṣa) -> rejected as an unproved post-mortem ideal

MATERIAL WELL-BEING (artha) -----> PLEASURE (kāma)
means end

In simple words: because this life is the only life securely known, Cārvāka values attainable well-being here. Wealth matters as a tool for enjoyment, not as an end by itself. The tradition must not be reduced automatically to reckless pleasure: sources distinguish crude and cultured forms.

Crude reading	Refined reading
Immediate sensual gratification	Intelligent enjoyment shaped by skill and self-control
Ignores social discipline	Recognises that society requires restraint
Common hostile caricature	Supported by the <i>dhūrta</i> / <i>suśikṣita</i> distinction

One-line memory: this-worldly enjoyment is central, but intelligent enjoyment is not identical with reckless indulgence.

VISUAL: VISUAL - The puruṣārtha ledger, and the two axes of the Cārvāka position

THE FOUR PURUSARTHAS		CARVAKA'S VERDICT

DHARMA	(virtue / duty)	-----> REJECTED : "distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted"
MATERIAL WELL-BEING	(artha) (wealth)	-----> ACCEPTED as MEANS, not as end
PLEASURE (kāma)	(enjoyment)	-----> ACCEPTED as THE END
liberation (mokṣa)		-----> REJECTED : obtainable "only by death, and no wise man would work for that"

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+-----+
| MATERIAL WELL-BEING (artha) ---- means ----> PLEASURE (kāma) |
|                               (ultimate) |
+-----+

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AND WITHIN "PLEASURE (kāma)" THERE ARE TWO CARVAKAS:

DHURTA (cunning/crude)	SUSIKSITA (cultured/refined)

gross sensual pleasure	pleasure disciplined by the
immediate gratification	sixty-four fine arts, self-
egoistic hedonism	control and urbanity
the caricature the	Vatsyayana's Kama-sutra as the
opponents preserved	"best positive evidence"
	(Chatterjee & Datta)

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** Two axes, not one. The first axis is which *puruṣārthas* survive; the second is *what kind of* hedonist is doing the surviving. Almost every weak answer collapses the second axis and presents only the *dhūrta*. The textbooks themselves refuse that collapse.

1. The doctrine, stated exactly

FACT: **The transmitted sūtra:** *pleasure (kāma) evaiḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - "enjoyment is the only end of human life."

FACT: **The four-fold verdict**, in Chatterjee and Datta's exact terms: "Of these four, the Cārvāka rejects the last two. Liberation in the sense of destruction of all sufferings can be obtained only by death and no wise man would willingly work for that end. **Virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted.** Therefore neither liberation nor virtue should be our end. Wealth and enjoyment are the only rational ends that a wise man can toil to achieve. But **enjoyment is the ultimate end; wealth is not an end in itself, it is good only as a means to enjoyment.**"

ANALYSIS: **Two things to notice, both examinable.**

1. The rejection of *dharma* is **epistemically** driven, not merely appetitive. *Dharma* is rejected because it is a *scriptural* category and *verbal testimony (śabda)* is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* - the same cut that removed *ākāśa* and *enduring self (ātman)*. Writing "Cārvāka rejects virtue because he loves pleasure" reverses the direction of the argument.
2. *Material well-being (artha)* is subordinated, not co-ordinate. Cārvāka is not a materialist about *wealth*; wealth is instrumental. That is a real ethical thesis and it separates Cārvāka from mere acquisitiveness.

2. The standard of right action, and its consequentialist form

FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "A **good action** is one which leads to a **balance of pleasure** and a **bad action** is one which brings about **more pain than pleasure**. This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, **hedonism** or the theory that pleasure is the highest goal."

ANALYSIS: **The structure of the criterion, made explicit:**

VALUE THEORY	: pleasure is the sole intrinsic good; pain the sole intrinsic evil
NORMATIVE THEORY	: the right action is the one whose balance of pleasure over pain is greatest
SCOPE	: the doxographies present the scope as EGOISTIC -- "pleasure of the senses in this life and that too of the individual is the sole end" (Sharma)
BUT	: Chatterjee & Datta explicitly deny that ALL materialists were egoistic hedonists

ANALYSIS: **The scope question is where the real philosophy is.** Egoistic hedonism and universalistic hedonism share a value theory and differ entirely in their normative consequences. Chatterjee and Datta record the decisive consideration: **"Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline. Life in society is impossible if man does not sacrifice a part of his pleasures for others."** And they immediately supply the evidence that some Cārvākas saw this: "Some Cārvākas, we are told, regard the **king as God**. This implies their great faith in the necessity of society and its head."

3. Refined hedonism - the evidence, and why it matters

FACT: **The dhūrta / suśikṣita distinction.** Chatterjee and Datta: "a distinction found sometimes between the **cunning (dhūrta)** and **cultured (suśikṣita)** Cārvākas makes it likely that the Cārvākas were **not all of the same gross, uncultured type**." Sharma records the same twofold division of "Crude and Refined Materialists".

FACT: **The evidence for refinement**, as Chatterjee and Datta present it:

Evidence	Detail
The fine arts	Materialists "devoted themselves also to the pursuit of more refined pleasures by cultivating, for example, the fine arts, the number of which is as large as sixty-four (<i>catuḥ-śaṣṭi-kalāḥ</i>), according to Vātsyāyana"
Political philosophy and economics	"Political philosophy and economy (daṇḍanīti and vārttā) came to be incorporated at some stage in the philosophy of the Lokāyatikas"
The king as God	Reported of some Cārvākas - implying "great faith in the necessity of society and its head"
Vātsyāyana's Kāma-sūtra	"The best positive evidence of refined hedonism is found in the ethical philosophy propounded by Vātsyāyana in the second chapter of the <i>Kāma-sūtra</i> "

FACT: **Vātsyāyana's position, stated precisely - and note the important qualification.** Chatterjee and Datta are careful: "Though Vātsyāyana **believes in God and in life after death** and, therefore, is **not a materialist in the ordinary sense**, yet he may be regarded as one, according to a **wider** sense of the term, namely, one who tries to explain 'higher phenomena by lower ones'." His materialist tendency "consists in holding that *dharma* and *material well-being (artha)* are to be treated only as **means** to enjoyment, which is therefore the supreme end."

FACT: **The content of the refinement**, which is the material that rescues Cārvāka ethics from caricature:

1. Emphasis on **self-control (brahmacharya)**, spiritual discipline (*dharma*) and **urbanity (nāgarika-vṛtti)**, "without which human enjoyment of pleasure is reduced to the level of beastly enjoyment."
2. All *pleasure (kāma)* is "ultimately reducible to the gratification of the five senses"; the satisfaction of the senses is "necessary for the very existence of the body (*śarīra-sthiti*)", like the satisfaction of hunger.
3. The senses "must be **educated, disciplined and cultured** through a training in the sixty-four fine arts", given only after "absolute self-continenence and study" in the earlier part of life.
4. Against the impatient hedonist who will not "forgo present comfort" or "undergo any toil for future enjoyment", Vātsyāyana argues that such an attitude "would be **suicidal**", since it "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds in the hope of the future enjoyment of a crop."
5. **"Inordinate desire, inconsistent with the principles of dharma and wealth, leads to ruin and annihilates the chances of all enjoyment."**
6. He argues, "like a modern scientific man, that some science is at the root of every successful practice."

ANALYSIS: **The philosophical upshot, and it is important.** Point 4 is a **prudential** argument *internal* to hedonism: unregulated present gratification is self-defeating **on hedonistic grounds**. That is exactly the structure of Epicurus' argument in the West, and it means that the refined Cārvāka position is not a compromise with morality imported from outside - it is what consistent hedonism requires of itself. Chatterjee and Datta conclude that Vātsyāyana "represents Indian hedonism at its best", and that the name *susīkṣita-cārvāka* was "perhaps" applied to thinkers of this kind.

ANALYSIS: **The honest counterweight.** Sharma's verdict is far harsher and must be carried too: "The ethics of the Cārvāka is a **crude individual hedonism**"; "All values are mere phantoms created by a diseased mind"; and he locates the school's downfall not in its atheism or its materialism - which it shares with respected schools - but in "the Cārvāka's **denial of all human values** which make life worth living... Sensual pleasure is a very faint shadow of the supreme pleasure. There is a qualitative difference in pleasure. **The pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher.**"

ANALYSIS: **How to adjudicate in an answer.** The two verdicts are about different things and both are usable:

SHARMA'S TARGET	: the doctrine as transmitted in the doxographies -- gross, egoistic, quantitative hedonism
CHATTERJEE & DATTA'S TARGET	: the historical breadth of the movement -- the susīkṣita strand, the fine arts, dandaniti and varta, the king-as-God report, Vatsyayana's discipline
VERDICT TO WRITE	: the transmitted doctrine is vulnerable to Sharma's "pleasure of the pig" objection because it offers no QUALITATIVE distinction among pleasures; the refined strand supplies a PRUDENTIAL and CULTURAL regulation of pleasure but still no independent standard of value. Carvaka can be made prudent; it cannot easily be made moral.

4. The "debt and ghee" verse - and the source caution

CAUTION: **The verse**, as preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* and reproduced by Sharma: **"While life remains let a man live happily, let him feed on ghee (clarified butter) even though he runs in debt; when once the body becomes ashes, how can it ever return here?"**

ANALYSIS: **The source caution, which must accompany every use of this verse.** This is:

1. A verse preserved in a **fourteenth-century doxography** compiled by **Mādhava**, a Vedāntin - that is, by an opponent;
2. Presented in a chapter whose purpose is refutation;
3. Not attributable to any surviving primary Cārvāka text;
4. Frequently paraphrased in exam scripts as *yāvaj jīvet sukhaṃ jīvet*, which the authored knowledge file itself flags as a **doxographical verse associated with the tradition, not a securely locatable quotation from an extant primary Cārvāka text.**

ANALYSIS: **How to use it correctly in an answer:** *"The often-quoted verse - live happily, feed on ghee even in debt, for the body once turned to ashes does not return - is preserved in the Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha, an opponent's compendium, and should be treated as a doxographical characterisation of the school's spirit rather than as its own scripture."* That single sentence signals scholarly care and forestalls the examiner's objection.

ANALYSIS: **The philosophical point beneath the rhetoric.** Strip away the polemic and the verse encodes a real argument: *if there is no post-mortem accounting, then the discounting of present goods in favour of future or other-worldly ones is irrational*. That is an argument about the **rationality of deferral under a finite horizon**, and it is answerable - Vātsyāyana himself answers it, in point 4 above, by observing that a refusal to defer would prevent even sowing a crop. Presenting the verse *with* its internal rebuttal is far better than quoting it as a slogan.

5. Positivistic, naturalistic, secular - a first pass at the 2024 label

ANALYSIS: Full treatment belongs to Subtopic 9 and the workbook, but the ethical material contributes three of the strongest points:

Label	Why it fits FACT:	Why it must be qualified ANALYSIS:
Naturalistic	<i>Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda); value grounded in embodied pleasure and pain; no supernatural sanction</i>	The notion of "nature" is descriptive, not analysed into laws
Secular	Morality is detached from scripture and priesthood; <i>daṇḍanīti</i> and <i>vārttā</i> enter the school; the king, not God, is the guarantor of order	The detachment is polemical rather than institutional; no political theory survives
Positivistic	FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply the word themselves: the theory "may also be called positivism, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena "; they add that the Cārvāka view "that no inference can yield certain knowledge is the view of many contemporary Western thinkers like the pragmatists and logical positivists "	ANALYSIS: Positivism venerates science , which is built on inference; Cārvāka attacks inference. Positivism has a constructive programme; Cārvāka has a polemical minimalism. And Comte's positivism carries a philosophy of history and a sociology entirely absent here

Exam link

Primary routes: 2020 Q7(c) and 2024 Q5(a). Keep ethics source-critical, separate prudence from morality, and compare Cārvāka with Jainism or positivism only on named axes.

Traps and recap

UPSC traps

- ANALYSIS: Do not reduce Cārvāka ethics to reckless sensualism. The textbooks themselves distinguish *dhūrta* from *suśikṣita* Cārvākas.
- ANALYSIS: Do not say Cārvāka rejects *dharma* because he prefers pleasure. He rejects it because it is a **scriptural** category, and *verbal testimony (śabda)* is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- ANALYSIS: Do not treat *material well-being (artha)* as a second end. It is explicitly a **means** to *pleasure (kāma)*.
- CAUTION: Do not quote the "ghee and debt" verse as Cārvāka scripture. It is preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*, an opponent's compendium.
- ANALYSIS: Do not call Vātsyāyana a Cārvāka without qualification. He "believes in God and in life after death" and is a materialist only "according to a wider sense of the term".
- ANALYSIS: Do not omit *daṇḍanīti*, *vārttā* and the king-as-God report if the question touches the school's social or political meaning.
- ANALYSIS: Do not answer the 2020 Jainism comparison with "materialism versus spirituality". Run the axes: *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)*, definition of the real, constituents, *ākāśa*, soul, substance-mode, standpoint, action and moral consequence (karma), liberation.
- ANALYSIS: Do not forget that Jainism holds consciousness to be the soul's **inseparable essence**, expressly denying the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".
- ANALYSIS: Do not present Sharma's harsh verdict and Chatterjee and Datta's sympathetic one as a contradiction. They target different objects - the transmitted doctrine and the historical movement.

Revision notes

- FACT: *pleasure (kāma) evaiḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - enjoyment is the only end; *material well-being (artha)* is its **means**; *dharma* and *liberation (mokṣa)* are rejected.
- FACT: *Dharma* is rejected on **epistemic** grounds: virtue and vice are "distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted".
- FACT: Criterion of right action: a good action yields a balance of pleasure; a bad one brings more pain than pleasure. Hence hedonism.
- FACT: **Dhūrta** (cunning/crude) versus **suśikṣita** (cultured/refined) Cārvākas - the textbooks refuse a single, gross portrait.
- FACT: Evidence for refinement: the sixty-four fine arts (*catuḥ-śaṣṭi-kalāḥ*); *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā* incorporated into Lokāyata; some Cārvākas regard the **king as God**.

- FACT: **Vātsyāyana** is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism" - but he believes in God and an afterlife and so is a materialist only "in a wider sense".
- FACT: Vātsyāyana's regulation: *brahmacarya*, urbanity (*nāgarika-vṛtti*), education of the senses, and the argument that refusing to defer would prevent even sowing a crop.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is not compatible with social discipline."
- ANALYSIS: Sharma's counterweight: "crude individual hedonism"; the school fell through "the denial of all human values"; "the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher."
- CAUTION: The "ghee and debt" verse comes from the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha* - an opponent's compendium; quote with caution, and extract the argument about deferral under a finite horizon.
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply the word **positivism** to Cārvāka themselves - "because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena" - and compare its view of inference to the pragmatists and logical positivists.
- FACT: **2020 comparison**: one *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus five kinds of knowledge · four *bhūtas* versus six *dravyas* · *ākāśa* rejected versus accepted · no soul versus infinite *individual self (jīvas)* with consciousness as inseparable essence · single standpoint versus *anekāntavāda* and *syādvāda* · no action and moral consequence (karma) versus **material** action and moral consequence (karma) · no liberation versus *liberation (mokṣa)* and *kevala-jñāna*.
- ANALYSIS: Shared ground with Jainism: both *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)*, both realist about the perceptible world, both reject a creator God.
- ANALYSIS: Verdict: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of **prudence** and an incomplete theory of **morality**.

COMPARATIVE SYNTHESIS AND ANSWER-WRITING ARCHITECTURE

EXAM-READY LINE: Final verdict: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) is philosophically strongest as a critique of dogmatism and weak inference, but its restriction of knowledge to perception is too narrow to explain science, ordinary reasoning and its own universal claims.

Plain-language visual - the complete answer spine

```

PERCEPTION ONLY
|
INFERENCE / TESTIMONY REJECTED
|
FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
|
BODY-SELF + NO TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
|
MATERIAL WELL-BEING (artha) AS MEANS + PLEASURE (kāma) AS END
|
BALANCED VERDICT: critical empiricism, but too narrow for science

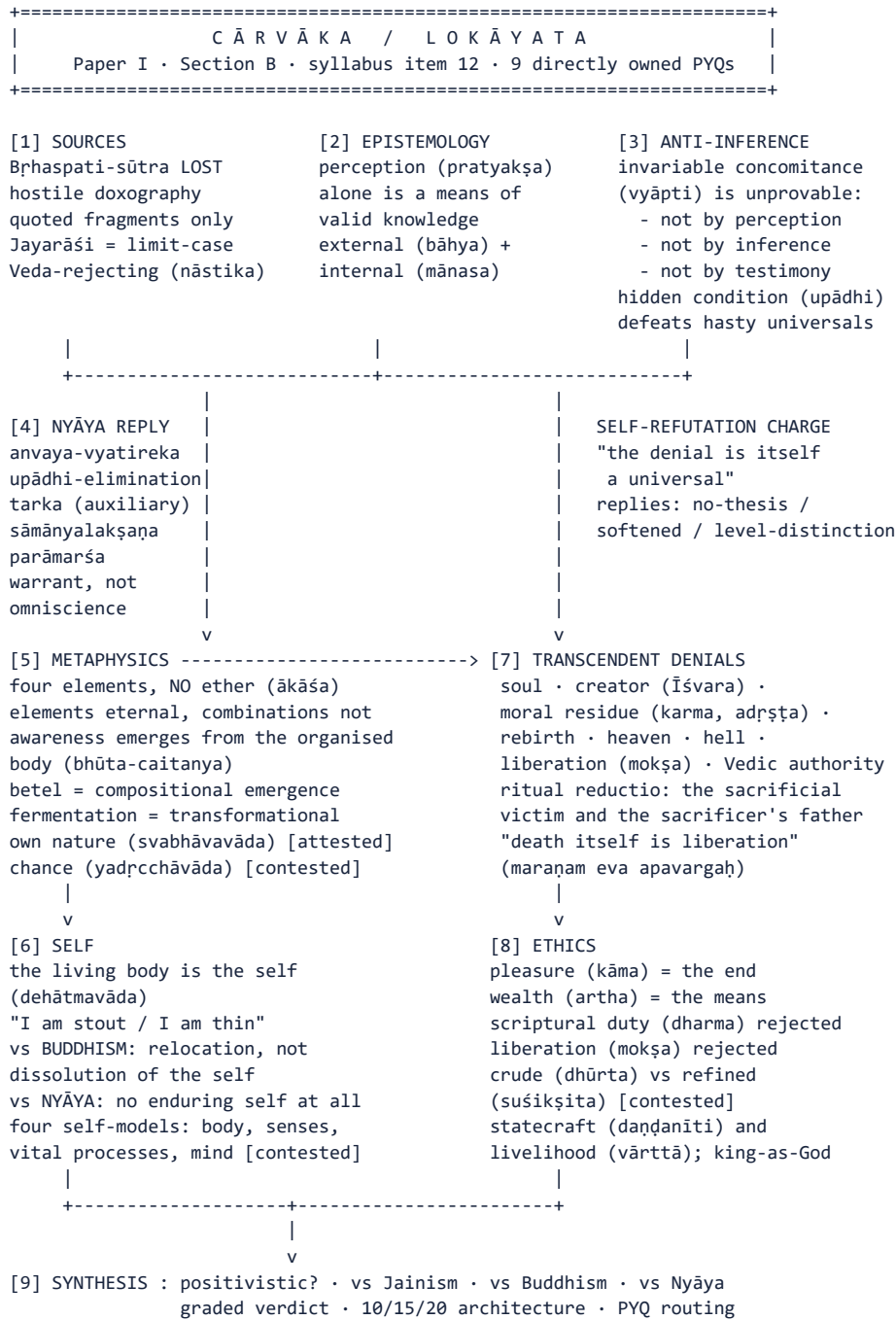
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In simple words: every Cārvāka answer should show a chain, not a list. Begin with the epistemic rule, derive the metaphysics and ethics, then evaluate both the achievement and the cost.

Marks	Fast structure
10	Define -> derive -> one objection -> verdict
15	Reconstruct -> example -> criticism/reply -> evaluation
20	Full dialectic -> comparison -> graded conclusion

One-line memory: ONE *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, FOUR elements, TWO accepted aims, ZERO transcendent entities.

VISUAL: MASTER CONCEPT MAP - the whole syllabus item on one page



1. The master comparison table

Axis	Cārvāka	Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Buddhism	Jainism
<i>Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)</i>	FACT: 1 - perception	FACT: 4 - perception, inference, comparison, testimony	FACT: 2 - perception, inference	FACT: Fivefold knowledge; inference admitted
Elements / substances	FACT: 4 <i>bhūtas</i> , no <i>ākāśa</i>	FACT: 9 <i>dravyas</i> , including <i>ākāśa</i> , <i>enduring self (ātman)</i> , <i>sensory mind (manas)</i>	ANALYSIS: <i>Dharmas</i> , momentary	FACT: 6 <i>dravyas</i> , including <i>ākāśa</i> and <i>kāla</i>
Self	FACT: Living body (<i>dehātmavāda</i>)	FACT: Eternal substantial <i>enduring self (ātman)</i>	FACT: No self; five <i>skandhas</i> , <i>santāna</i>	FACT: Infinite <i>individual self (jīvas)</i> ; consciousness their inseparable essence
Consciousness	FACT: Emergent by-product of matter	FACT: Adventitious quality of <i>enduring self (ātman)</i>	FACT: <i>Vijñāna</i> , one conditioned <i>skandha</i>	FACT: Essence of the soul, obscured by action and moral consequence (karma)
God	FACT: Rejected; <i>svabhāva</i> suffices	FACT: Proved by <i>kāryāt, āyojanāt, dhṛtyādeḥ, padāt/śruteḥ</i>	FACT: Rejected; conditions suffice	FACT: No creator; godhood attained by the <i>siddha</i>
Action and moral consequence (karma)	FACT: Rejected as unseen	FACT: Accepted; <i>adṛṣṭa</i> , God as dispenser	FACT: Accepted; causal-moral continuity	FACT: Accepted; action and moral consequence (karma) as subtle matter
Rebirth	FACT: Rejected	FACT: Accepted	FACT: Accepted, without a self	FACT: Accepted
Liberation	FACT: None; <i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>	FACT: <i>Release (apavarga)</i> as cessation of pain	FACT: <i>Cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)</i>	FACT: <i>Liberation (mokṣa)</i> ; <i>kevala-jñāna</i>
Vedic authority	FACT: Rejected - hence <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i>	FACT: Accepted	FACT: Rejected	FACT: Rejected
Standpoint theory	ANALYSIS: None; single standpoint	ANALYSIS: None	FACT: <i>Samvṛti / paramārtha</i>	FACT: <i>Anekānta, naya, syādvāda</i>

2. Criticisms and replies - the consolidated grid

#	Criticism	Cārvāka's best reply	Residual assessment
1	FACT: Self-refutation : the universal denial of inference is itself inferential; other minds and ideas are never perceived	ANALYSIS: Soften the thesis to a denial of <i>apodictic certainty</i> , or restrict it to transcendental inference; or advance no thesis at all (<i>vitaṇḍā</i>)	ANALYSIS: Decisive against the strong form; the softened form survives but is a much weaker doctrine
2	FACT: Science becomes impossible : without induction, no stable knowledge beyond isolated perceptions	ANALYSIS: Practical expectations remain available, tied to future perceptual check	ANALYSIS: Saves practice better than theory; narrows Cārvāka into radical empiricist caution
3	FACT: Perception itself errs (flat earth, static earth, small sun) - and is corrected <i>by inference</i>	ANALYSIS: The corrections are ultimately perceptual and practical; and fallibility about <i>how</i> things appear does not license unperceivable entities	ANALYSIS: Adequate for the flat-earth case, weak for heliocentrism; the hierarchy P over I is genuinely threatened
4	FACT: Emergence does not explain subjectivity : redness and intoxication are public; consciousness is private, and "neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard"	ANALYSIS: Positing an immaterial soul renames the gap rather than closing it	ANALYSIS: Both sides face the gap; the Cārvāka at least does not claim to have crossed it
5	FACT: Dependence is not production : light is necessary for sight but is not its cause; the two horns of a bull are constantly conjoined but not causally related	ANALYSIS: The instrument-hypothesis needs a user, and no user is perceived; materialism is the more economical of two unproven options	ANALYSIS: Genuinely undecided; an honest answer says so
6	FACT: Crude hedonism : no qualitative distinction among pleasures - "the pleasure of the pig"	ANALYSIS: The <i>suśikṣita</i> strand, the sixty-four arts, and Vātsyāyana's prudential regulation of desire	ANALYSIS: Supplies prudence and culture, not an independent standard of value
7	CAUTION: Hostile sources make fair reconstruction impossible	ANALYSIS: Convergence across Buddhist, Advaita, Jaina and Vedāntic doxographies fixes a doctrinal core	ANALYSIS: Use caution without abandoning content
8	ANALYSIS: Same-standpoint inconsistency (Sharma): perception is accepted and inference rejected at the same level, with no <i>vyāvahārika</i> / <i>pāramārthika</i> distinction available	ANALYSIS: Adopt the level-distinction as a repair	ANALYSIS: Effective, but the repair is the interpreter's, not the school's

Exam link

Use the complete 2018-2025 routing matrix and the 10/15/20-mark architecture. Every answer must end in a graded verdict tied to a named criterion.

Traps and recap

The synthesis-stage diagnostic questions are retained in the next section so that the complete Basic teaching remains separate from objective retrieval practice.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15 MARKS)

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW ETHICS AND THE POLITICAL-SOCIAL MEANING - AND CĀRVĀKA VERSUS JAINA REALITY (2020, 15			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS this-worldliness · pleasure (kāma) · material well-being (artha) ·	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Hence hedonism. FACT: Dhūrta (cunning/crude) versus suśikṣita	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST This Cārvāka ethics may be called, therefore, hedonism or the theory	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE He "believes in God and in life after death" and is a materialist only
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka (Indian materialist school) ethics is best read as prudent			

SESSION 9 - ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVE DECODING AND THE GRADED VERDICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: answer architecture is the fixed route by which the Cārvāka material is converted into a script - epistemic rule first, ontology derived from it, one comparison, and a verdict tied to a named criterion.

Technical definition: a Cārvāka answer is an *epistemically generated* answer: the perception-only criterion is the premise, the four-element ontology, the body-self, the emergent account of awareness and the rejection of every supersensible entity are its consequences, and the evaluation therefore has to be conducted at the level of the criterion rather than at the level of the individual denials.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Cārvāka is best judged as a single argument rather than as a list of denials: restrict valid knowledge to perception, and the soul, moral residue (karma), rebirth, heaven, the creator and liberation follow out of the world together - which is why the school stands or falls with its epistemology and not with its reputation for pleasure.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- epistemically generated ontology
- standing opponent's position (pūrvapakṣa)
- criterion-named verdict
- warrant versus entailment
- doxographical reconstruction
- graded, not flat, evaluation

How to use them: open by naming the criterion, derive at least two denials from it, concede the strongest objection, then deliver a verdict that says *by which standard* Cārvāka succeeds and *by which standard* it fails.

Plain-language visual - one route, three lengths

ROUTE (same for every question)	LENGTH CONTROL
define + flag reconstruction	10 marks -> define -> derive ->
	one objection -> verdict
perception-only criterion	(about 150 words)
	15 marks -> reconstruct -> named
three doors + hidden condition	example -> criticism and
	reply -> evaluation
Nyāya reply, honestly stated	(about 250 words)
	20 marks -> full dialectic -> ONE
derived ontology and ethics	school comparison ->
	graded conclusion
ONE comparison, not four	(about 250-340 words)
verdict naming its criterion	

In simple words: the same spine carries every question; only the number of stops changes with the marks. Candidates lose marks by changing the route, not by writing too little.

Directive decoder - what each command word is actually testing

Directive	What is being tested	Structural move	Closing verdict to adapt
Discuss	Breadth with balance	Doctrine -> basis in the means of valid knowledge -> metaphysical consequences -> one criticism	"Radical epistemic economy, not mere denial."
Examine	Internal logic	Trace how perception-only generates anti-inference and anti-transcendence	"The conclusion follows once the strict perceptual premise is granted."
Critically examine	Doctrine plus objections	Argument -> Nyāya, Vedānta and Mīmāṃsā objections -> replies	"Powerful as critique, unstable as a complete system."
Analyse	Component-wise logic	Break into means of knowledge, concomitance, hidden condition, testimony, ontology, ethics	"Its metaphysics is generated by its epistemology."
Evaluate	A final judgement	Weigh strengths, weaknesses and the contested source history	"Valuable negative philosophy; limited positive account."
Compare / Distinguish	Relation to another school	Fixed axes: knowledge, self, consciousness, moral residue, liberation	"Similarity at one point must not hide doctrinal difference."
Do you think / Do you agree?	A reasoned personal verdict	Doctrinal exposition first, qualified agreement second	"Agree with the critique of unwarranted transcendence, not with the total restriction."

How to write the paragraph - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Cārvāka's rejection of transcendent entities is not an independent metaphysical preference but the ontological consequence of a prior epistemic rule. **Named evidence.** The same template is applied to every item: the soul, moral residue (karma), heaven and the creator are all imperceptible, and the only routes to them - inference (anumāna) and testimony (śabda) - have already been refused independent standing, the first because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be secured and the second because it collapses into an inference about a speaker. **Analysis.** Because one criterion does all the work, the denials cannot be evaluated piecemeal; an opponent who saves inference recovers the whole supersensible order at once, which is exactly what Nyāya attempts by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant. **Qualification.** The verdict must therefore be graded: judged as a demand for infeasible certainty the Cārvāka critique still stands, while judged as an account of how knowledge is actually secured it is too narrow to license even the reasoning by which it is defended.

Named evidence to keep in the memory bank

- **Chatterjee and Datta:** the school made itself a **touchstone** on which every other Indian system tested its theories.
- **C.D. Sharma:** "Materialism in Indian Philosophy has never been a force. Born in discontent, it soon died in serious thought."
- **Sharma's other-minds point:** thoughts and ideas are never perceived, so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference".
- **The level-distinction Sharma denies him:** the everyday/ultimate (*vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*) contrast is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

The graded verdict - ready to adapt at three lengths

- **10 marks:** ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is strongest as an epistemological protest against unverifiable metaphysics and weakest when the rejection of inference is made absolute.
- **15 marks:** ANALYSIS: The perception-only principle explains the rejection of the soul, moral residue (karma), the creator and liberation with real economy, yet the self-refutation charge and the Nyāya reconstruction of concomitance show why it cannot stand as a complete theory of knowledge.
- **20 marks:** ANALYSIS: The best verdict is layered: the dogmatic wing is vulnerable, the refined (*suśikṣita*) wing is a coherent empiricist restriction on supersensible inference, and Jayarāśi's wing is a serious destructive dialectic rather than crude materialism.

UPSC traps for this session

- WRONG: Ending with a flat "Cārvāka is wrong" or "Cārvāka is right"; the marks live in the criterion that grades the judgement.
- WRONG: Comparing with three or four schools in a 15-marker; one comparison argued properly beats four listed.
- WRONG: Opening with the pleasure verse; the epistemology, not the ethics, is what generates the system.
- WRONG: Treating the source problem as a disclaimer to be dropped after the first line rather than as a live control on what may be asserted.

Mini recap

One criterion -> four elements -> a body-self -> no supersensible remainder -> two human ends. Concede the Nyāya reply honestly, then grade the verdict by naming the standard you are using.

CLOSING RECALL FLOW - ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVE DECODING AND THE GRADED VERDICT

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW ANSWER ARCHITECTURE, DIRECTIVE DECODING AND THE GRADED VERDICT			
1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS epistemically generated ontology · standing opponent's position	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT one criterion generates every denial, so evaluation must be pitched at	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Nyāya rescues the supersensible order in one move by exchanging	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE a flat verdict earns little; name the standard by which Cārvāka
ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cārvāka should be judged as a single argument rather than as a			

BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity and grammar so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

MCQ 1. The three names of the school

Consider the following statements.

1. *Lokāyata* is standardly explained as the doctrine of the ordinary world or of common people.
2. *Bārhaspatya* names the tradition of Bṛhaspati, whose attributed aphorisms survive as a complete work.
3. The derivations of *Cārvāka* from "to chew" or from "pleasant speech" are doxographical etymologies rather than settled history.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 2 and 3 only
- C. 1 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: statement 2 promotes a founder legend into a surviving document, whereas the attributed *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and known only through quoted fragments.
- **B:** Incorrect: it keeps the false survival claim in 2 while discarding the sound gloss of *Lokāyata* as the worldly or popular doctrine.
- **C:** Correct: 1 and 3 reproduce the two safe cautions - *Lokāyata* is the this-worldly or popular doctrine, and the *Cārvāka* etymologies are doxographers' explanations, not historical evidence.
- **D:** Incorrect: including 2 converts a traditional founder attribution into textual proof and contradicts the school's central source problem.

Examiner trap 1: The *Bārhaspatya* label records who the tradition claims as founder; it never certifies that a complete *Cārvāka* scripture is available for quotation.

MCQ 2. The exact sense of Veda-rejecting (nāstika)

In classical Sanskrit philosophical classification, Cārvāka is called *nāstika* chiefly because it

- A. rejects the authority of the Vedas, and only in a secondary sense because it denies existence after death
- B. denies a creator God, this being the primary test that separates orthodox from unorthodox systems
- C. denies the reality of the perceptible external world along with its material objects and processes
- D. accepts the authority of the Vedas while rejecting only the ritual apparatus that has grown around them

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the primary criterion of *nāstika* is rejection of Vedic authority; denial of life after death is a genuine but secondary sense in which the school also qualifies.
- **B:** Incorrect: non-theism cannot be the classifying test, because classical Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā accept the Veda while not requiring a creator God.
- **C:** Incorrect: the school affirms the perceptible world emphatically; its denials fall only on what cannot in principle be perceived.
- **D:** Incorrect: the rejection reaches Vedic authority itself, not merely the ritual practices that authority sanctions.

Examiner trap 2: Translating *nāstika* flatly as "atheist" loses the Veda-authority criterion and wrongly makes non-theistic orthodox schools unorthodox.

MCQ 3. The textual situation of the school

Which statement best describes the source position of Cārvāka philosophy?

- A. A complete *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* survives, accompanied by commentaries written within the materialist tradition itself.
- B. Mādhava's *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* is an authentic primary work composed by a Cārvāka teacher for his own school.
- C. Nothing responsible can be said about the school, because every surviving witness to it is polemical and hostile.
- D. No systematic materialist primary work survives, so the school is reconstructed chiefly from opponents who state its views in order to refute them.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the attributed sūtra tradition is lost, and only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors remain.
- **B:** Incorrect: the *Sarvadarśanasamgraha* chapter is a Vedāntin compendium's presentation of an opponent, valuable but not Cārvāka scripture.
- **C:** Incorrect: hostility restricts confidence but does not abolish it, because independent opponents converge on the same doctrinal core.
- **D:** Correct: reconstruction rests on convergent hostile testimony, which is why claims should be framed as the standard doxographical reconstruction.

Examiner trap 3: Writing that the sources are hostile is only half the point; the mark comes from adding that convergence across independent opponents still fixes a recoverable core.

MCQ 4. The correct use of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa

In an answer on Cārvāka, the *Tattvopaplavasīṃha* of Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa is best used

- A. as the primary text that positively establishes perception as the sole independent means of valid knowledge, supplying the school with the systematic treatise it otherwise lacks
- B. as the one surviving text usually classified with the tradition and as its sceptical limit-case, since it attacks every definition of a means of valid knowledge, perception included
- C. as a Nyāya refutation that attacks materialist epistemology from outside the tradition it describes, and therefore as hostile testimony of the ordinary doxographical kind
- D. as a Mīmāṃsā defence of the intrinsic authority of the Veda, written to protect ritual obligation against the epistemological criticisms pressed by the materialists

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: Jayarāśi challenges the definability of perception as a means of valid knowledge, so he cannot be quoted to establish the school's defining thesis.
- **B:** Correct: he is the single surviving text-witness and simultaneously the internal limit-case, which is why his affiliation is discussed cautiously rather than assumed.
- **C:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika; his dialectic dissolves Nyāya definitions rather than defending them.
- **D:** Incorrect: nothing in the work defends Vedic authority; his method is destructive of all definitional claims, orthodox and unorthodox alike.

Examiner trap 4: Using Jayarāśi to state Cārvāka epistemology destroys the very thesis - perception alone is valid - that the standard school is defined by.

MCQ 5. Why perception alone is admitted

The Cārvāka argument for restricting valid knowledge to perception proceeds by showing that

- A. inference travels beyond what is immediately given, while testimony reduces to trust in a speaker plus an inference from words to facts, so neither is independent
- B. inference is acceptable while testimony is not, leaving perception and inference as the only two admissible independent sources of knowledge
- C. perception is incapable of error, so no further source is needed to correct or supplement its deliverances at any point
- D. every cognition is fundamentally verbal, so perception must be treated as prior to the language in which knowledge is expressed

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: this is the two-step economy - only perception presents its object immediately, and every rival source is either derivative or unproved.
- **B:** Incorrect: it concedes exactly what the school denies, since the rejection of inference as an independent source is the school's most famous thesis.
- **C:** Incorrect: infallibility is not claimed; indeed the perceptual illusion counter-argument is later pressed against the school by its critics.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is a thesis about language, not the epistemic-economy argument that actually generates the perception-only rule.

Examiner trap 5: The thesis is that perception is the *only independent* means of valid knowledge, which is far stronger than the uncontroversial claim that perception is the *primary* one.

MCQ 6. Whether consciousness is denied

The statement "Cārvāka denies consciousness" is

- A. correct, because consciousness is not one of the four admitted elements and therefore has no place in the ontology
- B. correct, because only externally perceived material objects are admitted as belonging to the perceptible world
- C. incorrect, because pleasure, pain and desire are internally perceived; what is denied is the further inference from consciousness to an imperceptible bearer
- D. incorrect, because the school treats consciousness as an eternal quality inhering in a substance distinct from the living body

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: consciousness is explained as a property of the organised elemental body, not eliminated from the world.
- **B:** Incorrect: internal or mental perception of conscious states is expressly admitted alongside external perception.
- **C:** Correct: the school accepts the occurrence of awareness and rejects only the inferential addition of an immaterial possessor of it.
- **D:** Incorrect: an eternal quality inhering in a separate substance is precisely the Nyāya position the school is attacking.

Examiner trap 6: Denying a transcendental self is not denying awareness; scripts that merge the two lose the school's actual position on internal perception.

MCQ 7. The attack on invariable concomitance

The central Cārvāka objection to inference is that invariable concomitance cannot be established because

- A. no inference has ever been observed to succeed, so the practice has no record of reliability to appeal to
- B. it cannot be had by perception, which surveys only finite cases; nor by inference, which is circular or regressive; nor by testimony, whose own validity is unproved
- C. the probans and the probandum are never in fact observed together, so no concomitance is available for generalisation at all
- D. universals do not exist, so no relation obtaining between two universals can be stated or known in the first place

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the school concedes that inferences often succeed and argues instead that success is accidental rather than warranting.
- **B:** Correct: this is the three-doors argument, and stating it as three closed routes rather than a vague "cannot be proved" is what earns marks.
- **C:** Incorrect: the co-observation of smoke and fire is granted; the dispute concerns the leap from finite co-observation to an unrestricted universal.
- **D:** Incorrect: denying universals is a Buddhist strategy; the Cārvāka objection is epistemic, about how the relation could be known.

Examiner trap 7: Reducing three distinct closed routes to one sentence about uncertainty is the commonest way of throwing away the marks in this argument.

MCQ 8. The hidden limiting condition

The *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) argument establishes that

- A. a decisive counter-instance has already been observed against every universal that has so far been proposed
- B. inference must be rejected because the conclusion drawn from a general rule is invariably found to be false
- C. universal relations become secure automatically once a sufficiently large number of positive instances is collected
- D. an observed regularity may in fact track an unnoticed further condition, so constancy of observation cannot certify unconditionality

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no such empirical claim is made; the argument is about what observation can guarantee, not about actual refutations.
- **B:** Incorrect: falsity of conclusions is not asserted, and many inferences are admitted to reach true conclusions accidentally.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the position under attack, since accumulation of positive cases is exactly what the objection says is insufficient.
- **D:** Correct: the wet-fuel qualification shows that what looked like a bare universal may have been conditioned all along.

Examiner trap 8: This is a structural objection about unnoticed qualifiers, not a complaint that too few instances have been counted.

MCQ 9. Why verbal testimony is refused

Verbal testimony is denied the status of an independent means of valid knowledge because

- A. words are conventional signs and therefore convey no determinate meaning that could be true or false at all
- B. the passage from an utterance to its truth needs an unstated assumption about the speaker's competence and honesty, which is itself inferred
- C. the Veda is held to be authorless, and an authorless composition can carry no intelligible content for a hearer
- D. language is incapable of guiding practical action, so nothing said can ever be acted upon by a rational agent

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: meaning is not denied; the school accepts ordinary communication and denies only its independent epistemic warrant.
- **B:** Correct: testimony collapses into inference plus trust, so it cannot be rescued once inference has been denied independent validity.
- **C:** Incorrect: authorlessness is rejected as unproved, not treated as a source of unintelligibility.
- **D:** Incorrect: pragmatic reliance on what people say is conceded; usefulness is separated from the status of a means of valid knowledge.

Examiner trap 9: Rejecting testimony as a means of valid knowledge is not rejecting language, and a script that confuses the two invites the charge of caricature.

MCQ 10. Comparison, postulation and non-cognition

Applying the Cārvāka criterion to comparison (*upamāna*), postulation (*arthāpatti*) and non-cognition (*anupalabdhi*) yields which result?

- A. All three survive as independent sources, because each of them terminates directly in a fresh perceptual presentation of the object whose knowledge is being claimed.
- B. All three survive as independent sources, because none of them depends on the universal relation that inference presupposes and each rests on a distinct cognitive act.
- C. Only non-cognition survives, because the absence of an object is itself given directly in a single act of perception without any conditional reasoning being required.
- D. Each either presents only what perception already delivers, adding nothing independent, or moves beyond perception through an unproved universal and inherits the objection to inference.

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: if they terminated in perception they would add nothing independent, which is the first half of the dilemma rather than an escape from it.
- **B:** Incorrect: postulation excludes alternatives by a general rule and non-cognition uses a universal conditional, so both do depend on the disputed move.
- **C:** Incorrect: "if the object were here it would be perceived" is a universal conditional, not the content of one perception.
- **D:** Correct: the dilemma is exhaustive, though this systematic extension is a reconstruction rather than a claim that a surviving Cārvāka text refutes each later category by name.

Examiner trap 10: Present the extension to the larger catalogue as systematic reconstruction; asserting that a surviving Cārvāka work separately refuted each later category is unsupported.

MCQ 11. How Nyāya rebuilds concomitance

Which set correctly lists the Nyāya devices for establishing invariable concomitance?

- A. Agreement in presence and in absence, elimination of suspected limiting conditions, hypothetical reasoning, and in later Nyāya a perception of the universal
- B. Scriptural authority, the intuition of the accomplished yogin, and the reported statement of a person accepted as reliable by the community
- C. An exhaustive enumeration of every past, present and future instance, secured by a survey that no finite observer has yet completed
- D. The postulation of an unseen moral force that guarantees the stability of the regularity across all the cases not yet examined

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: positive and negative correlation, elimination of suspected conditions and supportive reasoning replace omniscient survey with disciplined procedure.
- **B:** Incorrect: scripture and yogic intuition are not the Nyāya route to concomitance, which is built from ordinary observation and reasoning.
- **C:** Incorrect: complete enumeration is the impossible standard the Cārvāka demands, and Nyāya's reply consists precisely in abandoning it.
- **D:** Incorrect: an unseen moral force is a Mīmāṃsā-style postulate and would concede the Cārvāka charge that the universal rests on the imperceptible.

Examiner trap 11: Supportive reasoning is not itself a means of valid knowledge; it removes doubt and cannot by itself establish the relation, and saying so keeps the answer balanced.

MCQ 12. The self-refutation charge

The charge of self-refutation against Cārvāka is most precisely stated as follows.

- A. A materialist cannot live consistently, because the necessities of eating, drinking and social life already presuppose a moral order.
- B. The ethics of pleasure contradicts the metaphysics of four elements, because pleasure is not itself an element in that list.
- C. "No inference is a means of valid knowledge" is a universal claim that no single perception delivers, so it must either be inferred or abandoned.
- D. The rejection of the Veda is inconsistent, because the very Sanskrit in which the rejection is stated is a Vedic inheritance.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a practical taunt, not the internal inconsistency that makes the philosophical charge severe.
- **B:** Incorrect: pleasure is treated as a state of the organised body, so no contradiction with the elemental ontology arises here.
- **C:** Correct: the thesis quantifies over all inferential acts, and universality is exactly what perception alone cannot supply.
- **D:** Incorrect: a linguistic genealogy establishes nothing about the epistemic status of the doctrine being asserted.

Examiner trap 12: The charge is that the position is internally unstable, which is far stronger than the familiar and much weaker complaint that it is impractical.

MCQ 13. Practical inference and accidental truth

Which formulation best preserves the refined Cārvāka position on everyday inference?

- A. Everyday inference is a genuine means of valid knowledge in worldly matters, while inference employed in scriptural argument alone is disqualified as invalid and unwarranted.
- B. Everyday inference is a corrigible habit answerable to later perception, while transcendence-bearing inference admits no perceptual check, and predictive success proves nothing because truth is accidental to inferential practice.
- C. Everyday inference must be surrendered together with all reasoning about what is absent, since a consistent materialist can appeal to nothing whatever beyond present sensation.
- D. Everyday inference establishes unseen entities whenever it succeeds repeatedly, so accumulated success gradually converts a practical habit into demonstrative and certain knowledge.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: granting the status of a means of valid knowledge in one domain surrenders the thesis, since status is not domain-relative.
- **B:** Correct: this keeps action possible, locates the real target in unredeemable inference, and blocks the appeal to predictive success.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the caricature the refined reading is designed to avoid, and it makes ordinary life unintelligible.
- **D:** Incorrect: accumulating success is habit-formation, and the school's whole point is that habit never matures into certainty.

Examiner trap 13: The distinction between practical usability and the status of a means of valid knowledge is the hinge of the refined reading; omitting it makes the answer look naïve.

MCQ 14. Where Cārvāka sits in the ledger of knowledge sources

Arranged by the number of independent means of valid knowledge admitted, which sequence is correct?

- A. Cārvāka two · Nyāya three · Mīmāṃsā four · Advaita five, with comparison counted only inside the Mīmāṃsā tradition
- B. Cārvāka one · Nyāya two · Sāṃkhya four · Advaita three, with testimony counted only where scripture is decisive
- C. All classical schools admit exactly three, differing only in the names they give to those three sources
- D. Cārvāka one · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism two · Sāṃkhya-Yoga three · Nyāya four · Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā five · Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā and Advaita six

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it credits Cārvāka with two sources and understates Advaita, which is standardly assigned the fullest list.
- **B:** Incorrect: Sāṃkhya admits perception, inference and testimony, and Advaita is placed above Nyāya, not below it.
- **C:** Incorrect: the number of admitted sources is precisely what the schools dispute, from one up to six.
- **D:** Correct: Cārvāka occupies the lower bound of a shared ledger, which is why every richer epistemology must justify its additions against it.

Examiner trap 14: Presenting Cārvāka as an eccentric outlier misses the structural point that it fixes the minimum against which every other school defends its additions.

MCQ 15. The elemental scheme

Which statement about the Cārvāka account of the elements is correct?

- A. Five elements are accepted, including *ākāśa*, because the perception of sound requires an imperceptible substratum in which the quality of sound can inhere.
- B. Four elements are accepted and *ākāśa* is retained as a non-substantial medium that accommodates bodies without itself counting as one of the material elements.
- C. Four elements - earth, water, fire and air - are accepted, and *ākāśa* is rejected because it is not perceived, the inference from sound to a substratum inheriting the disputed problem of concomitance.
- D. Three elements are accepted, since air is treated as a rarefied condition of fire and water rather than as an independent element with a sensible quality of its own.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika inference, and it is exactly the move the perceptual criterion disallows.
- **B:** Incorrect: retaining *ākāśa* in any form readmits an imperceptible item that the criterion excludes.
- **C:** Correct: the fourfold scheme follows from the criterion, and refusing an imperceptible substratum for sound is the reason usually given.
- **D:** Incorrect: no reduction of air is reported; the disputed element is *ākāśa*, and the count in question is four against five.

Examiner trap 15: Writing "five elements" is the single most punished factual slip in this topic, because five is the standard number in most other Indian systems.

MCQ 16. Evidence for the body-self

Which evidence is characteristically used to identify the self with the living body?

- A. Ordinary first-person predications such as "I am stout" or "I am thin" attach bodily properties directly to the person, and no self is ever met with apart from bodily states.
- B. Scriptural passages are cited in which the self is expressly identified with the gross body rather than with an inner controller.
- C. A subtle body is perceived departing at the moment of death, which shows that personhood is exhausted by material organisation.
- D. Memory-continuity is inferred to require a persisting substance, and that substance is then identified with the physical organism.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: identity-language plus the absence of any separately encountered self supplies a perceptual, non-inferential case for the body-self.
- **B:** Incorrect: scriptural support would be self-defeating for a school that denies testimony the status of a means of valid knowledge.
- **C:** Incorrect: no such perception is claimed, and a departing subtle body would concede survival after death.
- **D:** Incorrect: this argues from an inference, whereas the school's strength here is its refusal to add an unperceived bearer.

Examiner trap 16: The opponent's reply that "my body" separates possessor from possessed must be met by noting that possessive grammar does not by itself prove a separate substance.

MCQ 17. The betel and fermentation analogies

The betel and fermentation analogies are offered in order to show that

- A. consciousness is identical with one of the four elements taken singly, most often with the element of fire in the living body
- B. consciousness is an eternal quality of a separate self that the body merely manifests when the sense organs are in working order
- C. the elements are severally conscious already, though their consciousness remains unnoticed until they enter a bodily combination
- D. an organised combination can display a novel property absent from its separate ingredients, so awareness need not require an immaterial bearer

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the analogies work precisely because the novel property belongs to none of the ingredients taken singly.
- **B:** Incorrect: manifestation of a pre-existing quality is the rival account that the emergence claim is designed to replace.
- **C:** Incorrect: attributing latent consciousness to each element abandons emergence and concedes a form of panpsychism.
- **D:** Correct: red colour from betel ingredients and intoxicating power from fermenting agents illustrate emergent properties of an organised whole.

Examiner trap 17: The honest qualification is that emergence is asserted rather than explained, since redness and intoxicating power are third-personal while awareness is first-personal.

MCQ 18. The four materialist identifications of the self

Sadānanda's *Vedāntasāra* reports four materialist positions distinguished by what each takes the self to be. Which set is correct?

- A. Gross body, subtle body, causal body and the witnessing consciousness that underlies all three of them
- B. The body, the intellect, the store of past actions and the liberated condition attained after their exhaustion
- C. Gross body, the sense faculties, the vital processes, and the internal mental organ
- D. The body, the accumulated moral residue, memory, and the desire that binds a person to future births

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Vedāntic sheath-and-witness scheme, which posits exactly the transcendent principle materialists reject.
- **B:** Incorrect: moral residue and liberation are among the entities the school denies, so they cannot appear as materialist candidates.
- **C:** Correct: body, senses, vital processes and mind exhaust the reported list, and each candidate perishes with the living complex.
- **D:** Incorrect: it imports rebirth-machinery into a taxonomy whose whole point is that no candidate survives bodily dissolution.

Examiner trap 18: This fourfold list classifies the proposed bearer of personhood and must not be confused with the later crude-versus-refined contrast between types of Cārvāka.

MCQ 19. The denial of transcendent entities

The opponent-preserved formula "death itself is liberation" is best read as

- A. a positive description of a blissful post-mortem condition attained once the body has been dissolved
- B. a verse from surviving Cārvāka scripture that formally defines liberation for the materialist school
- C. a claim that liberation is produced by the correct performance of funerary ritual at the moment of death
- D. a denial of any positive release: bodily dissolution ends the person and therefore ends experienced suffering

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: any positive post-mortem state would reinstate the survival the school denies on perceptual grounds.
- **B:** Incorrect: the formula is preserved by opponents, and no Cārvāka scripture survives from which it could be quoted.
- **C:** Incorrect: the school's ritual critique is directed against exactly this kind of claim about unseen ritual results.
- **D:** Correct: the phrase is deflationary, cancelling the goal rather than describing an attainment.

Examiner trap 19: Quoting the formula as a Cārvāka definition of liberation reverses its sense, since it abolishes the category instead of filling it.

MCQ 20. Own-nature and accidentalism

Which statement correctly distinguishes explanation by own-nature (*svabhāvavāda*) from accidentalism (*yadrucchāvāda*)?

- A. Explanation by own-nature denies transcendent causation while preserving natural regularity; accidentalism denies determinate causation altogether, and its attribution to Cārvāka is contested.
- B. Both deny causation entirely, so the two terms are interchangeable labels for a single Cārvāka doctrine about the natural world and the regularities that are observed in it.
- C. Explanation by own-nature denies all causation, while accidentalism preserves observed regularity by grounding it in chance conjunctions among the four admitted material elements.
- D. Both are orthodox doctrines about an unseen causal order which the materialists rejected in favour of a purely perceptual account of how natural processes come about.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: thorn-sharpness and the peacock's colours illustrate real regularities explained immanently, whereas accidentalism dissolves determinate causation.
- **B:** Incorrect: own-nature explanation retains causation and merely refuses to ground it in an unseen moral or divine order.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two positions are reversed, since it is accidentalism, not own-nature, that abandons determinate causation.
- **D:** Incorrect: neither is an orthodox doctrine, and accidentalism is criticised by Buddhists, Jainas and Naiyāyikas alike.

Examiner trap 20: Attribute own-nature explanation to Cārvāka as its mainstream principle, and flag the accidentalist association as contested rather than asserting it.

MCQ 21. The structure of Cārvāka ethics

Which statement best expresses the ethical position of the school?

- A. Pleasure and wealth are co-equal ultimate ends of human life, and neither is subordinate to the other in the ordering of goods.
- B. Pleasure is the end and wealth its instrument; foreseeable pain is to be limited rather than made a reason for renouncing pleasure, as grain is not discarded because it carries a husk.
- C. Immediate gratification is to be maximised without any weighing of consequence, since consequences lie in a future that cannot be perceived now.
- D. Duty grounded in scripture is retained as a social necessity while liberation alone is rejected as an unverifiable transcendent goal.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the two are expressly ranked, wealth being valuable only in so far as it sustains enjoyment.
- **B:** Correct: this is prudential hedonism, and the husk-and-grain image is the standard reply to the objection that pleasure always carries pain.
- **C:** Incorrect: reckless indulgence is the hostile caricature, and the reported incorporation of statecraft and economics tells against it.
- **D:** Incorrect: scripturally grounded duty is rejected along with liberation, since both rest on the sources already denied.

Examiner trap 21: The reported inclusion of statecraft and livelihood in the Lokāyata curriculum is thin doxographical evidence; present it as suggestive of a secular social theory, not as established.

MCQ 22. Cārvāka and the Jaina conception of reality

Which contrast between the two conceptions of reality is accurate?

- A. Cārvāka admits perceptible material particulars only, while Jainism admits plural substances that persist through change and are described under standpoint-conditioned predication.
- B. Cārvāka admits plural substances including souls, while Jainism reduces all reality to a single conscious principle that appears as many.
- C. Both restrict reality to matter, differing only over whether the number of material elements is four or five.
- D. Both accept an unchanging reality behind appearances, differing only over whether that reality can be known by perception.

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the contrast runs through the means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation, not merely through the slogan of matter against spirit.
- **B:** Incorrect: the positions are inverted, since souls are plural in Jainism and denied altogether in Cārvāka.
- **C:** Incorrect: Jaina reality includes conscious substance, so the disagreement is not a dispute about counting elements.
- **D:** Incorrect: Cārvāka posits no reality behind appearances, and Jaina persistence-through-change is not an unchanging substratum.

Examiner trap 22: Reducing this comparison to "materialism versus spiritualism" forfeits the marks that come from arguing it across knowledge, substance, self and liberation.

MCQ 23. Whether the school is positivistic

Which is the strongest reason for qualifying the label "positivistic" when it is applied to Cārvāka?

- A. The term is modern and Western, so any comparison between it and a classical Indian school is illegitimate in principle and can only distort both sides of the comparison.
- B. Cārvāka accepts scriptural testimony in a restricted practical form, whereas positivism excludes revelation altogether from the domain of statements that can count as knowledge.
- C. Positivism depends on scientific inference and law-like explanation, whereas Cārvāka denies inference the status of a means of valid knowledge, so a shared anti-metaphysical spirit conceals opposite methods.
- D. Positivism admits an immaterial self as the subject of experience, whereas Cārvāka identifies the person with the living body and allows no bearer beyond it.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: controlled comparison is legitimate and is even used in the standard expositions, provided it is offered as analogy rather than identity.
- **B:** Incorrect: scriptural testimony is rejected outright, so this cannot be the point of divergence.
- **C:** Correct: the agreement is about what may be admitted, and the disagreement is about the very inferential machinery on which science runs.
- **D:** Incorrect: positivism does not require an immaterial self, so this supposed contrast does not exist.

Examiner trap 23: A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks here; the demand invites a graded verdict that concedes the empiricist temper and refuses the inferential identification.

MCQ 24. Two refusals of the self

Which statement correctly differentiates the Cārvāka refusal of a transcendental self from the Buddhist rejection of a self?

- A. Both denials are identical in content and differ only in the technical vocabulary that each tradition happens to employ when it states its rejection of an enduring self.
- B. Cārvāka denies transcendence while keeping a material bearer; Buddhism denies substantiality while retaining moral continuity, and rules out the body-self because material form is itself an aggregate declared not-self.
- C. Cārvāka denies the self while Buddhism affirms an eternal self that survives the dissolution of the aggregates at death and carries the moral record forward into a further life.
- D. Buddhism identifies the person with the physical body while Cārvāka denies that any bearer of personhood exists at all, whether that bearer is conceived as material or as immaterial.

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the two denials rest on different arguments and yield different consequences for rebirth and moral continuity.
- **B:** Correct: the Buddhist analysis is wider, not weaker, because it dismantles the very identification the Cārvāka retains.
- **C:** Incorrect: an eternal self is exactly what the Buddhist doctrine of not-self is formulated to reject.
- **D:** Incorrect: the positions are reversed, since it is Cārvāka that keeps a bearer and makes it material.

Examiner trap 24: Writing that both schools "deny the self in the same way" collapses a twenty-mark comparison into a one-line similarity and cannot recover the marks.

MCQ 25. Remedial drill - what exactly is denied about awareness

Which claim about awareness is actually held by the school?

- A. Awareness does not occur at all, since nothing beyond the four elements is admitted into the account of the world.
- B. Awareness is an eternal quality inhering in an immaterial self that uses the body as its temporary instrument.
- C. Awareness occurs and is internally perceived, but no imperceptible bearer of it follows from that occurrence.
- D. Awareness is identical with the element of air, which circulates through the body and animates its organs.

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: eliminating awareness would contradict internal perception, which the school expressly admits.
- **B:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of the self and its qualities, which the school is arguing against.
- **C:** Correct: the occurrence is granted and only the inferential addition of a possessor is refused.
- **D:** Incorrect: identification with a single element is ruled out by the emergence account, in which no ingredient carries the property alone.

Examiner trap 25: The frequent slip is to move from "no soul" to "no consciousness"; the school's position lies precisely between those two claims.

MCQ 26. Remedial drill - rejecting inference and never inferring

A script states: "Because Cārvāka rejects inference, a Cārvāka never reasons from smoke to fire in ordinary life." The error is that

- A. the school in fact accepts inference as a fully independent means of valid knowledge alongside perception
- B. what is denied is the status of inference as an independently valid source, not the practical habit of moving from a sign to what it signifies
- C. the school denies perception as well, so no example drawn from ordinary observation can illustrate its position
- D. reasoning from smoke to fire counts as testimony rather than inference, so the example is misclassified from the start

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: granting independent validity would surrender the school's most characteristic thesis.
- **B:** Correct: practical movement from sign to signified is conceded as corrigible habit answerable to later perception.
- **C:** Incorrect: perception is the one source that is affirmed, so the premise of this option is false.
- **D:** Incorrect: smoke-to-fire is the standard textbook example of inference, not of testimony.

Examiner trap 26: Confusing a claim about epistemic status with a claim about behaviour makes the school look absurd and invites the examiner's charge of caricature.

MCQ 27. Remedial drill - own-nature against unseen moral force

"Fire burns by its own nature" differs from "fire burns because of an unseen moral factor" because

- A. both statements appeal to transcendent causation and differ only in the vocabulary that each of them happens to choose for the cause
- B. the first appeals to divine will while the second appeals to an impersonal physical law that governs combustion wherever it occurs
- C. the first denies that any regularity obtains in nature, whereas the second affirms regularity and offers an account of its stability
- D. the first stops explanation at an observable nature, while the second posits an imperceptible moral factor of exactly the kind the perceptual criterion excludes

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: only the second appeals to something transcendent; the first is deliberately immanent.
- **B:** Incorrect: divine will belongs to neither, and the unseen moral factor is not an impersonal physical law.
- **C:** Incorrect: regularity is affirmed by own-nature explanation, which is what separates it from accidentalism.
- **D:** Correct: the contrast is between an immanent stopping point and a supersensible postulate.

Examiner trap 27: Concede the fair objection that "by its own nature" can look like a placeholder, then answer it by noting that every explanatory chain terminates somewhere and this terminus is at least observable.

MCQ 28. Remedial drill - two different objections to a universal

Consider two objections to a proposed universal relation: (i) not every case has been observed; (ii) the observed cases may have shared an unnoticed further condition. Which is the hidden-limiting-condition objection, and why does the difference matter?

- A. Objection (ii), because it survives however extensive the observation becomes, showing that constancy of observation cannot certify unconditionality
- B. Objection (i), because a hidden limiting condition is simply another name for an incomplete survey of the available instances
- C. Both, because the two objections restate a single complaint about the finitude of human observation in different words
- D. Neither, because the hidden limiting condition concerns the formal validity of the syllogism rather than the truth of its premise

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: incompleteness is quantitative and could in principle be reduced, whereas an unnoticed qualifier defeats the universal itself.
- **B:** Incorrect: this collapses the sharper objection into the weaker one and loses what makes the argument structural.
- **C:** Incorrect: the two differ in kind, since only one of them concerns the content of the supposed relation.
- **D:** Incorrect: formal validity is expressly conceded in the school's treatment of the standard syllogism.

Examiner trap 28: Stating only the incomplete-survey point leaves the strongest half of the case unwritten, because the qualifier objection is what defeats unconditionality.

MCQ 29. Remedial drill - the crude and refined contrast

How should the crude and refined (*dhūrta* and *suśikṣita*) contrast be used in an answer?

- A. As two securely attested Cārvāka schools with surviving texts, named teachers and datable institutional histories running in parallel
- B. As an indirect doxographical contrast preserved by opponents, valuable because the refined form supplies the strongest reply to the self-refutation charge
- C. As another name for the fourfold taxonomy of materialist identifications of the self that Vedāntic sources report and classify
- D. As a modern scholarly invention with no basis in the Indian doxographical literature through which the school has been transmitted

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no surviving Cārvāka text confirms two schools with fixed doctrines, and the labels vary across doxographies.
- **B:** Correct: the safe formula is that later doxographers distinguish a crude from a refined form, though the evidence is indirect.
- **C:** Incorrect: that taxonomy classifies the bearer of personhood, a different question altogether.
- **D:** Incorrect: the contrast is genuinely reported in the doxographical literature, even though it is transmitted by opponents.

Examiner trap 29: Over-documenting this contrast as institutional history is as damaging as ignoring it, because the source base cannot carry that weight.

MCQ 30. Remedial drill - what survives of the attributed aphorisms

What survives of the aphorisms attributed to Bṛhaspati?

- A. The complete work, together with at least one commentary composed within the materialist tradition itself
- B. A condensed summary chapter, written by a Cārvāka author for the instruction of students of the school
- C. No continuous text; only scattered aphorisms and verses quoted by other authors, usually while refuting them
- D. Nothing whatever, so that not even a single quoted line can be attributed to the tradition with any confidence

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no such work or commentary is extant, which is the root of the school's reconstruction problem.
- **B:** Incorrect: the well-known summary chapter is by a Vedāntin compiler presenting an opponent's view.
- **C:** Correct: about a dozen aphorisms and verses are quoted by others, which is why reconstruction is cautious but not impossible.
- **D:** Incorrect: quoted fragments do survive, and denying them overstates the loss and paralyses the answer.

Examiner trap 30: Both overstatements fail here - claiming a surviving treatise, and claiming that nothing at all survives.

MCQ 31. Remedial drill - the status of the pleasure verse

How should the verse "as long as one lives, let one live happily", with the associated line about incurring debt, be handled in an answer?

- A. As a traditional doxographical verse associated with the school's image, cited without claiming that it comes from an extant primary Cārvāka text
- B. As a word-for-word quotation from the surviving aphorisms of Bṛhaspati, and therefore as decisive documentary evidence
- C. As the school's official ethical formula, sufficient on its own to describe the whole of Cārvāka moral philosophy
- D. As a Mīmāṃsā parody of materialism with no genuine connection to the Lokāyata tradition at any point

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the verse may be used for colour and framing provided its transmission status is stated honestly.
- **B:** Incorrect: no extant primary text exists from which a verbatim quotation could be taken.
- **C:** Incorrect: treating a slogan as the complete ethics reproduces the caricature that the refined reading exists to correct.
- **D:** Incorrect: the verse is genuinely transmitted in association with the tradition, even though its provenance is doxographical.

Examiner trap 31: Quoting the verse is safe; presenting it as scripture, or as the school's entire ethical theory, is not.

MCQ 32. Remedial drill - placing the sceptical wing

Which use of Jayarāśi in an answer is defensible?

- A. Quoting him to establish that perception alone is the school's single independent means of valid knowledge
- B. Treating him as proof that all Cārvākas denied the existence of the four elements they are otherwise reported to accept
- C. Presenting him as a Naiyāyika author who refuted the materialists from a standpoint outside their tradition
- D. Citing him to show a sceptical wing whose destructive method needs no competing theory of knowledge, while noting that his school-affiliation is contested

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: his argument turns against the definability of perception itself, so he cannot certify the standard thesis.
- **B:** Incorrect: generalising a limit-case to the whole tradition contradicts the convergent reports of four-element materialism.
- **C:** Incorrect: he is not a Naiyāyika, and his dialectic dismantles Nyāya definitions rather than deploying them.
- **D:** Correct: he supplies the strongest answer to the self-refutation charge precisely because a purely destructive dialectic asserts no rival thesis.

Examiner trap 32: Even a purely destructive dialectic may covertly assume that destructive reasoning is reliable, and conceding that residual worry strengthens rather than weakens the answer.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Every model answer here is independent learner practice and is **never** an official UPSC key. Because the *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost and the doctrine is reconstructed chiefly from hostile or refutational witnesses, doctrinal claims are framed as the standard Cārvāka reconstruction, and Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa is used only as a contested sceptical limit-case rather than as a plain representative of that standard position. Question wording is reproduced exactly as printed in the official papers.

Answer-length convention used throughout this package. UPSC Philosophy Paper I parts are written longer than General Studies answers. The working bands are **10 marks - about 150 to 200 words**, **15 marks - about 250 to 300 words**, and **20 marks - about 340 to 400 words**. Each solution prints the timed answer first; where a paragraph is marked *Depth refinement*, it is a teaching addendum that sits **outside** the timed word count.

Coverage: nine directly owned Cārvāka PYQs from 2018 to 2025, one supporting routed 2022 question owned by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, and six original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks.

2018 · Q8(b) · 15 marks

Question: Is Cārvāka rejection of inference acceptable to the other systems of Indian philosophy? If not, why? Do you think the views of other systems to be justified? Give reasons for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Three-limbed: a factual survey, an explanatory account, and an evaluative judgement in the candidate's own voice
Limb 1	Is it accepted? - a cross-school survey; the answer is overwhelmingly no
Limb 2	If not, why not? - the <i>reasons</i> , school by school, not a single generic reason
Limb 3	Are they justified? - the candidate's graded verdict, with reasons
Scope boundary	Stay on inference ; do not drift into Cārvāka ethics or the ritual polemic
Ideal thesis	The other systems are justified against the strong thesis, but the Cārvāka's residual point - that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal - survives, and Nyāya concedes it by shifting from certainty to warrant
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; at least three named schools with their distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka holds that *inference (anumāna)* is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* cannot be secured: not by perception, since all cases past, present and future are never surveyed; not by inference, which yields a *petitio principii*; and not by testimony, whose own validity is inferred - and which, if it grounded inference, would mean "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens this: the wet-fuel condition shows that unconditionality can never be perceptually certified.

No system accepts this. Nyāya replies that *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is built by *anvaya-vyatireka*, elimination of suspected *upādhis*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, and that *parāmarśa* - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - means no "leap" occurs. Sāṃkhya must reject it, since *primordial material nature (prakṛti)* and *conscious witness (puruṣa)* are established only inferentially. Mīmāṃsā must, since injunction and *apūrva* presuppose it. Buddhism, through Dignāga and Dharmakīrti, constructs an entire logic, and the *Tattvasaṅgraha* attacks Cārvāka's naïve perceptualism directly. Jainism needs inference for *matī* and *śrūta*. Advaita alone partly agrees, but denies **ultimate** validity to perception as well - a level-distinction, as Sharma observes, "unknown to the Cārvāka".

Are they justified? Largely yes. The universal denial of inference is itself a universal; other minds and ideas are never perceived; Sharma is right that "the Cārvāka can understand others only through inference".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: they are justified against the strong thesis but not entitled to complacency, since Nyāya answers only by replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined warrant - a substitution that concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while denying his epistemological conclusion.

Depth refinement. The dispute is therefore not between reason and anti-reason. It concerns whether *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* means indefeasible truth or responsibly corrigible warrant. Nyāya is strongest by the latter criterion; Cārvāka survives as a challenge to unrestricted universals.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2018 Q8(b): all three limbs must be visibly answered: the cross-school survey, the school-specific reasons, and the candidate's own graded verdict. A single generic reason for all schools halves the marks.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: thesis and three doors in four lines; four schools with distinct reasons; the self-refutation charge in two lines; a criterion-named verdict.

- **Structure:** state the Cārvāka thesis with its argument -> survey the schools with **distinct** reasons -> the self-refutation charge -> the candidate's graded verdict. All three limbs must be visibly answered.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*, *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*, *parāmarśa*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must appear as three, not as a vague "cannot be proved".

- **Distinction:** rejection of inference as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus rejection of practical inference - flag it, or the answer looks naïve.
- **Comparison:** at least four schools with school-specific reasons. A generic "all schools accept inference" earns half the marks.
- **Criticism:** self-refutation stated as steps, plus Sharma's point that thoughts and other minds are never perceived.

2019 · Q5(c) · 10 marks

Question: Are the Cārvākas consistent when they hold that inference is not a source of knowledge? Discuss.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Discuss with an explicit verdict on consistency - a yes/no question that requires a qualified answer
Core issue	Whether the denial of inference can be stated and defended without using inference
Scope boundary	This is about internal coherence , not about whether inference is in fact valid
Ideal thesis	Inconsistent on the strong reading; consistent on the softened reading - but the softened reading is a much weaker doctrine
Non-negotiables	The charge reconstructed as steps; at least two of the three replies; the point that other minds and ideas are never perceived; a graded verdict

Independent model answer

The charge. The Cārvāka asserts that no inference is a valid source of knowledge. That assertion is a **universal**, quantifying over all inferential acts; no universal is given in any single perception. So it is either itself inferential - and self-defeating - or it fails its own standard. Sharma presses further: thoughts and ideas "cannot be perceived; they can only be inferred", so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference and make others understand him only through inference".

The replies. ANALYSIS: Three are available. (i) *Vitaṇḍā*: the Cārvāka advances no thesis, only destroys the opponent's claim to certainty - but he does assert four elements and a body-self, so this cannot be global. (ii) The **softened thesis**: he denies not inference itself but its capacity to yield **apodictic certainty**, especially about the transcendent. (iii) The **level-distinction**: concede *vyāvahārika* validity, deny the *pāramārthika* - though Sharma notes this distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka".

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** inconsistent as an unrestricted denial; consistent as a fallibilist warning. The Cārvāka may be **radical or consistent, but not both**.

Depth refinement. A practical concession needs an epistemic status: if successful worldly inference is knowledge, the absolute thesis contracts; if it is only expectation, Cārvāka must explain why rational action may trust what philosophy disqualifies.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q5(c): the question is about internal coherence, not about whether inference is valid. Reconstruct the charge as numbered steps, then supply at least two of the three replies before judging.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the charge in three steps; two replies; one line on other minds; a verdict that separates the radical from the consistent reading.

- **Structure:** state the charge as numbered steps -> give the replies -> deliver the verdict. Do not narrate the *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* argument at length; the question presupposes it.
- **Doctrine:** the exact form of the thesis being tested - "no inference is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*" - and its universality.
- **Argument:** the step from "universal claim" to "not perceptually given" must be explicit.
- **Distinction:** *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status versus practical usability; strong versus softened formulation.
- **Technical terms:** *vitaṇḍā*, *vyāvahārika* / *pāramārthika*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.

- **Criticism:** the other-minds point is the sharpest form of the charge and is usually omitted.

2019 · Q6(c) · 15 marks

Question: What is wrong according to the Cārvākas with the following argument? All men are mortal. Socrates is a man. Therefore, Socrates is mortal. Justify your answer with arguments.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	Diagnose a specific argument, then justify the diagnosis - application, not recitation
Core issue	Whether the candidate attacks the right thing: the major premise , not the form
Scope boundary	Use the smoke-and-fire material only as illustration; the syllogism itself must stay in focus
Ideal thesis	The syllogism is valid but epistemically empty - it transmits a certainty in the major premise that was never independently acquired
Non-negotiables	Explicit refusal to attack validity; the major premise identified as <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; the three doors applied to "All men are mortal"; <i>petitio principii</i> ; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; one line of self-critical balance

Independent model answer

The Cārvāka objection is **not** that the argument is formally invalid. If the premises hold, the conclusion follows; the Cārvāka concedes this and attacks elsewhere.

The target is the **major premise**, "All men are mortal", which functions exactly as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* does in Indian inference: an invariable, exceptionless concomitance between man-ness and mortality. How is such a universal known?

Not by perception. No one has perceived all men. Chatterjee and Datta press the point: we cannot perceive even all present cases, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future." Nor does relocating the relation among class-characters help: "it is not possible even to know by perception what 'smokeness' ... is, because we do not perceive all cases of smoke", and a relation between universals does not license an inference about **this** particular.

Not by inference. Establishing the universal inferentially requires a further universal - *petitio principii*, or an endless regress.

Not by testimony. Testimony's validity is itself inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hence, in Sharma's formulation, the syllogism is an **argument in a circle**: the conclusion "Socrates is mortal" is already contained in "All men are mortal". Deduction merely extracts what induction never established. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* deepens the charge: perhaps what is genuinely invariable is not man-ness with mortality but organic embodiment under conditions never fully surveyed.

ANALYSIS: Verdict: the syllogism is valid but epistemically empty. The charge is a serious one about induction - though the Cārvāka must still explain how his own universal denial of inference is known.

Depth refinement. This diagnosis anticipates the problem of induction without making Cārvāka a modern empiricist. Its precise claim is not that deduction fails formally, but that deduction cannot manufacture warrant absent from its universal premise.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2019 Q6(c): refuse the temptation to attack validity. Concede the form at once, identify the major premise as an invariable concomitance, then apply the three doors to 'All men are mortal'.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: two lines conceding form; the major premise identified; three doors applied to the actual premise; the hidden condition; one line of self-critical balance.

- **Structure:** disclaim the attack on validity -> identify the major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> run the three doors **on this premise** -> *petitio principii* -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> verdict.

- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *sāmānya* / class-character, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be applied to "All men are mortal" specifically, not narrated abstractly about smoke.
- **Distinction:** validity versus soundness; deduction's circularity versus induction's insecurity, and the fact that each is cured only by the other.
- **Technical terms:** major premise as *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*; *sādhya* and *hetu*; *inference (anumāna)* and *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Comparison:** one line noting that Nyāya would answer with *anvaya-vyatireka*, *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *parāmarśa*.

2020 · Q6(b) · 15 marks

Question: Critically evaluate Cārvākas' rejection of Ākāśa as one of the elements of reality and examine their criticism of transmigration of Soul.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate and examine</i> - two tasks, both requiring two-sided assessment
Core issue	That both rejections are the same argument applied twice , once to cosmology and once to soteriology
Scope boundary	Two halves, roughly balanced; do not let <i>ākāśa</i> consume the answer
Ideal thesis	The rejections are impeccably consistent with the epistemology, and are therefore exactly as strong - and as vulnerable - as that epistemology
Non-negotiables	The Vaiśeṣika sound-to- <i>ākāśa</i> inference named and refused; the four requirements of transmigration each cut; at least two objections with replies; a criterion-named verdict

Independent model answer

Ākāśa. FACT: Most Indian schools admit five elements; Cārvāka admits four - earth, water, fire and air. The reason is exact: *ākāśa* "is not perceived but **inferred**" (Sharma). The Vaiśeṣika reaches it by argument - sound is a quality; qualities inhere in substances; sound belongs to no other admitted substance; therefore *ākāśa* exists as its substrate. Since inference is not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that route is closed.

ANALYSIS: Critical evaluation. The rejection is consistent and economical, and it correctly identifies that *ākāśa* is a **theoretical posit**, not a datum. But it carries a cost: the Cārvāka accepts the four elements *as substances*, so he cannot refuse the substance-quality scheme for sound alone without argument. His strongest line is therefore to naturalise sound as a modification of perceptible air - a naturalising rather than a merely sceptical move.

Transmigration. FACT: Transmigration requires (a) a self distinct from the body, (b) its survival after death, (c) a carrier of moral desert, and (d) knowledge that these obtain. Cārvāka cuts each: *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)* makes the self the living body - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*; "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)* and *adṛṣṭa* are unperceived; and only scripture or inference could supply the knowledge.

ANALYSIS: Examination. Strengths: consistency, economy, and the exposure of unfalsifiable postulates.

Weaknesses: Sharma shows that dependence is not production - "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight"; the argument slides from "unestablished" to "unreal"; and, as Sharma adds, the soul's non-existence "too cannot be demonstrated".

ANALYSIS: Verdict: one epistemic cut, applied twice - and its force is exactly the force of that cut.

Depth refinement. The burden of proof remains crucial: Cārvāka may show that the opponent has not established *ākāśa* or transmigration, but the stronger claim of non-existence needs a bridge from epistemic absence to ontological absence.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q6(b): the question has two limbs and both must be evaluated critically, not merely reported. Keep the rejection of ether and the criticism of transmigration on the same single criterion.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the criterion in two lines; the ether limb; the transmigration limb; one Nyāya or Vedāntic objection with a reply; a graded verdict.

- **Structure:** two clearly signposted halves, each with exposition and evaluation; a unifying final sentence.
- **Doctrine:** four *bhūtas*; the Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate inference; *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)*; *adrṣṭa*.
- **Argument:** the four requirements of transmigration, each explicitly cut.
- **Distinction:** rejecting *ākāśa* as an entity versus denying that sound is heard; "unestablished" versus "unreal".
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *bhūta*, *adrṣṭa*, *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- **Criticism:** at least two - the instrument objection and the unestablished/unreal slide; ideally Sharma's symmetry point too.

2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks

Question: Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the differences</i> - a sustained axis-by-axis comparison, not two mini-essays
Core issue	Conceptions of reality : what exists, how it is known, and how change and persistence are accommodated
Scope boundary	Metaphysics and its epistemology; ethics only if it illuminates the ontology
Ideal thesis	The deepest difference is not materialism versus spiritualism but the number of standpoints each admits - Jainism multiplies both entities and viewpoints; Cārvāka admits one of each
Non-negotiables	<i>Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)</i> ; the definition of <i>sat</i> ; four <i>bhūtas</i> versus six <i>dravyas</i> ; <i>ākāśa</i> ; soul and consciousness; <i>anekāntavāda</i> and <i>syādvāda</i> ; action and moral consequence (karma); liberation; and the shared <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> ground

Independent model answer

Epistemic root. FACT: Cārvāka admits one *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *perception (pratyakṣa)*. Jainism admits a fivefold knowledge - *mati*, *śruta*, *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya*, *kevala* - and hence inference. Every later divergence follows from this.

Definition of the real. FACT: For Jainism, *sat* is **utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya** - origination, decay and persistence together; the gold that becomes bracelet and then ring persists as *dravya* while its *paryāyas* change. Cārvāka has no such analysis: elements are eternal, combinations transient, and that is all.

Constituents. FACT: Four *bhūtas* for Cārvāka; **six dravyas** for Jainism - *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *dharma*, *adharma*, *ākāśa*, *kāla*. *Ākāśa* is rejected by the Cārvāka as inferred; for Jainism it is a distinct substance providing accommodation.

Soul and consciousness. FACT: Cārvāka: no *individual self (jīva)*; the self is the living body, and consciousness an emergent by-product. Jainism: infinitely many *individual self (jīvas)*, with consciousness their **inseparable essence** - expressly denying, as the sources put it, the Cārvāka view that it is "a mere accidental property, arising only under some conditions".

Standpoint. FACT: Jainism's **anekāntavāda**, with *nayavāda* and *syādvāda*, holds reality many-faced and every judgement conditioned. Cārvāka admits a single standpoint and no level-distinction at all.

Action and moral consequence (karma) and liberation. FACT: Jainism: action and moral consequence (karma) as **subtle matter** adhering to the *individual self (jīva)*, *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*, with *liberation (mokṣa)* through the three jewels and *kevala-jñāna*. Cārvāka: no action and moral consequence (karma), and *marāṇam eva apavargah*.

ANALYSIS: Verdict. Their agreement is instructive: both are *Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)*, both realists about the perceptible world, both reject a creator. The divergence is over standpoints and substances - which is why Jainism can hold change and persistence together while Cārvāka can only assert them side by side.

Depth refinement. Jainism buys explanatory articulation through ontological plurality; Cārvāka buys economy through restriction. Jainism therefore wins on change-and-persistence, while Cārvāka preserves the question of evidential cost.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2020 Q7(c): argue the contrast across four axes - means of knowledge, substance, self and liberation - instead of writing 'materialism versus spiritualism', which is the answer the examiner expects to reject.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: define each conception in two lines; four contrast axes with named doctrine; one point of contact; a verdict on which conception is better supported and by what standard.

- **Structure:** named axes, each carrying both positions in the same sentence or row; then the unifying thesis; then the shared ground.
- **Doctrine:** *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya*; six *dravyas*; *constituent quality (guṇa)* and *paryāya*; *anekānta*, *naya*, *syādvāda*; four *bhūtas*.
- **Argument:** show that the metaphysical divergence is *generated* by the epistemic divergence.
- **Distinction:** Jaina *dharma* and *adharma* are **media of motion and rest**, not merit and demerit - a classic trap.
- **Technical terms:** *sat*, *dravya*, *individual self (jīva)*, *pudgala*, *bhūta*, *kevala-jñāna*, *bhāva-bandha* and *dravya-bandha*.
- **Comparison:** at least seven axes; fewer looks thin at 15 marks.

2021 · Q5(e) · 10 marks

Question: Comment on the bearing of Cārvāka epistemology on the rejection of transcendental entities by them.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Comment on the bearing</i> - the examiner wants the derivation , not two lists
Core issue	That a single epistemic premise severs every transcendent entity at once
Scope boundary	Do not narrate the <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> argument at length; compress it and spend the words on the derivation
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka ontology is the exact ontological shadow of its epistemology, so the denials are consequences and not separate acts of unbelief
Non-negotiables	The compressed epistemic argument; the bridging principle named as a presupposition; at least five entities derived; one line of evaluation

Independent model answer

For Cārvāka, ontology is the shadow cast by epistemology. Perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*: *inference (anumāna)* fails because *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is established neither by perception (all cases are never surveyed), nor by inference (*petitio principii*), nor by testimony (whose own validity is inferred); *verbal testimony (śabda)* fails because words certify only that something was said. Chatterjee and Datta accordingly state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" this epistemological conclusion.

The **bearing** is systematic. The bridging principle - ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - is then applied without exception. *Ākāśa* falls, being inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls, never being perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (Īśvara)* falls, being reached only by design-inference while *svabhāva* discharges the explanatory work. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states no perception could present. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual loses its rationale with it.

ANALYSIS: Comment: the derivation is impeccably consistent; its cost is that the whole ontology stands or falls with the rejection of inference.

Depth refinement. The denials are not object-level duplicates: some reject theoretical substrates, some moral mechanisms, and some authoritative testimony. Their unity lies in one evidential filter rather than one identical argument.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2021 Q5(e): the directive is *comment on the bearing*, so the epistemology must be shown doing the work. Derive at least three denials from the single criterion rather than listing them.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: state the criterion; derive three denials from it in one movement; one objection; a one-sentence verdict on the derivation, not on materialism in general.

- **Structure:** epistemology compressed into one paragraph -> the bridging principle -> the derivation, entity by entity -> one evaluative line.
- **Doctrine:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda*; the bridging principle; *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*).
- **Argument:** the derivation must read as a *consequence*, with connectives such as "hence", "therefore", "with it".
- **Distinction:** the bridging principle is a **presupposition**, not a theorem - an opponent could accept the epistemology and still hold that reality exceeds knowledge.
- **Technical terms:** *ākāśa*, *enduring self (ātman)*, *Lord (Īśvara)*, *action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adṛṣṭa*, *svarga*, *liberation (mokṣa)*, *verbal testimony (śabda)*.
- **Comparison:** if space allows, one clause noting that Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are also non-theistic but keep *action and moral consequence (karma)* and rebirth, because their epistemology admits inference.

2024 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications for your answer.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	An explicit personal verdict with reasons and justifications - a graded answer, never a flat yes or no
Core issue	Whether an empiricist criterion and anti-metaphysical temper suffice for the label, given that Cārvāka rejects inference
Scope boundary	Comparative epistemology and method; do not turn it into a history of logical positivism
Ideal thesis	Positivistic in spirit , not in method ; "radical empiricism" is the safer label
Non-negotiables	The evidential point that the textbooks themselves apply the word; at least three points for and three against; the inference divergence; a named alternative label

Independent model answer

ANALYSIS: Yes in spirit, no in method.

The case for. FACT: The label is not imported by the examiner: Chatterjee and Datta write that the Cārvāka theory "may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in **positive facts or observable phenomena**", and compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". Cārvāka restricts the knowable to what perception presents; rejects God, soul, *action and moral consequence (karma)* and heaven as unwarranted; refuses scriptural authority; grounds value in this-worldly pleasure and pain; and even adopts a quasi-verificationist register, since questions about rebirth and heaven are said to become "**meaningless**".

The case against. ANALYSIS: Positivism is built on **inference** - science is systematised inference - which Cārvāka denies *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*-status. Positivism admits unobservables that earn their explanatory keep; Cārvāka refuses them. Positivism offers a constructive programme with formal and semantic tools; Cārvāka offers a polemical minimalism. Comte's law of three stages and sociology have no Indian counterpart.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** an illuminating analogy, not a historical identity. **Radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism** is the more accurate description. The paradox is that Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an **anti-inferential** route.

Depth refinement. The comparison is heuristic, not genealogical. Cārvāka resembles positivism in policing metaphysical admission but differs because its anti-inferentialism weakens the law-governed science that later positivisms elevate.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q5(a): a flat yes or a flat no both lose marks. Establish that the label is already used in the standard expositions, give the case for it, then the decisive disanalogy about inference.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: three movements - the label is not imported, the case for it, the case against it - and a verdict that accepts the empiricist temper while refusing the identification.

- **Structure:** verdict first -> case for -> case against -> refined label. A graded verdict announced early controls the whole answer.
- **Doctrine:** the textbook's own use of the word "positivism", with its stated reason - this is the strongest single evidential move available.
- **Argument:** the inference divergence must be identified as the **decisive** disanalogy, not listed among equals.
- **Distinction:** spirit versus method; empiricism versus positivism; verificationism versus mere anti-metaphysics.
- **Technical terms:** *perception (pratyakṣa)*, *inference (anumāna)*, *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)*, verification, unobservables.
- **Comparison:** at least one named Western reference point - Comte or Ayer - used precisely.

2024 · Q6(a) · 20 marks

Question: Differentiate between the Cārvākas' refutation of self as a transcendental category and the Buddhist rejection of ātmā.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Differentiate</i> - sustained contrast on named axes; separate descriptions will not do
Core issue	That two denials of <i>enduring self (ātman)</i> can be philosophically opposite in target, ground, aftermath and metaphysical price
Scope boundary	The self; bring in action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation only as consequences of the two denials
Ideal thesis	Cārvāka relocates the self into matter; Buddhism dissolves it into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished
Non-negotiables	<i>Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)</i> with its formula; the five <i>skandhas</i> ; <i>santāna</i> ; the epistemic versus ontological-soteriological grounds; the point that <i>rūpa</i> is itself a <i>skandha</i> ; the divergent aftermaths

Independent model answer

Both schools reject the *enduring self (ātman)* of Nyāya and Vedānta, but the rejections are not species of one genus.

Cārvāka: relocation. FACT: The doctrine is *conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)* - *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, the person is the body qualified by consciousness. The **ground is epistemological**: perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, and "the non-material soul is never perceived". The positive argument is drawn from ordinary speech: we say "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind", and if the "I" were distinct from the body these would be meaningless. Consciousness is admitted, but as an **emergent by-product** of the organised elements - as the betel leaf, lime and nut together yield a redness none possesses, and as molasses becomes intoxicant on fermenting. Since no self survives the body's dissolution, "death of the body means the end of the individual"; *action and moral consequence (karma)*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* all lapse, and *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*.

Buddhism: dissolution. FACT: *Anātman* denies not the transcendence but the **substantiality** of the self. The person is analysed into five *skandhas* - *rūpa*, *vedanā*, *saṃjñā*, *saṃskāra*, *viññāna* - with no owner behind them; "chariot" names an arrangement of parts, and so does "person". The **ground is ontological and soteriological**: *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda* leave no room for a permanent entity, and belief in a self generates craving and suffering. Continuity is preserved by *santāna*, the causal stream, with *pratisandhāna* and, in Yogācāra, *ālaya-vijñāna* bearing *bīja*s. Hence action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth survive **without** a self, and *cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)* remains the goal.

ANALYSIS: **The four differentiating theses.** (i) **Targets** differ: Cārvāka substitutes a material self, whereas Buddhism denies substantiality of any kind - and since *rūpa* is itself one of the *skandhas*, Buddhist analysis refutes the Cārvāka body-self **by name**. (ii) **Grounds** differ: epistemic versus ontological-soteriological. (iii) **Aftermaths** differ: Cārvāka terminates the moral narrative at death; Buddhism is engineered precisely to continue it. (iv) **Prices** differ: Cārvāka must explain how matter yields subjectivity; Buddhism must explain how an ownerless stream yields memory, desert and liberation.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** Cārvāka denies the self's **transcendence** while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its **moral continuity**.

Depth refinement. Both views face continuity problems of different kinds: Cārvāka must explain identity through bodily change without a separate subject; Buddhism must explain responsibility across an ownerless causal series. This symmetry prevents a one-sided comparison.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2024 Q6(a): the twenty-mark demand is *differentiate*, so the two denials must be shown to be different in kind. The decisive line is that material form is itself an aggregate declared not-self.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: define both denials; four axes of difference; the aggregate argument; the Puggalavāda foil in one clause; a conclusion that refuses to treat them as species of one genus.

- **Structure:** the two positions stated compactly -> four explicit differentiating theses -> a one-line verdict. Do not write two biographies.
- **Doctrine:** *conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)* with the Sanskrit formula; the five *skandhas* named in order; *santāna*; *pratītyasamutpāda* and *kṣaṇikavāda*.
- **Argument:** the "I am fat / lame / blind" argument, and the chariot analogy, both reproduced.
- **Distinction:** transcendence versus substantiality - this single distinction carries the whole answer.
- **Technical terms:** *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ*, *anātman / nairātmyavāda*, *pudgala-nairātmya*, *ālaya-vijñāna*, *bīja*.
- **Criticism:** the point that *rūpa* is itself a *skandha*, so Buddhism rules out the Cārvāka self explicitly - very few candidates make it.

2025 · Q5(a) · 10 marks

Question: Explain the ground on which Cārvāka rejects inference as a valid source of knowledge.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain the ground</i> - a focused, architecturally clean exposition; evaluation is secondary
Core issue	The impossibility of establishing <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i>
Scope boundary	Stay on the ground for rejection; do not survey the other schools' replies at length
Ideal thesis	The ground is that <i>invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> , without which inference cannot claim certainty, is unobtainable by any means the Cārvāka admits
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> defined; the three doors; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; the "accident and separable" line; one closing sentence of balance

Independent model answer

FACT: The ground is the **impossibility of establishing invariable concomitance (vyāpti)**. Inference moves from a perceived mark to an unperceived *sādhya*, and is licensed only by an invariable concomitance - "wherever smoke, there fire". For inference to be a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*, that universal must be beyond doubt.

It cannot be had by perception: we cannot perceive all cases of smoke and fire even now, "to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future"; and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known while all instances are not perceived.

Nor by inference: that would be a *petitio principii*, since the further inference needs its own *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.

Nor by testimony: testimony's own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on it, "no one could infer anything by himself."

Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) completes the case: fire yields smoke only where fuel is wet, and hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice", so unconditionality is never certified.

ANALYSIS: Hence truth is "only an **accident**, and a **separable** one" in inference - not the guaranteed character a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* requires.

Depth refinement. The strongest soft reading permits corrigible, perception-redeemable practical expectation. It protects ordinary life but transforms the dispute into one about certainty, scope and transcendental overreach.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2025 Q5(a): the directive is *explain the ground*, so the three doors are the answer and the Nyāya reply is not asked for. Give it at most one clause.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: define invariable concomitance; three doors, visibly three; the hidden condition in one line; close on the accidental-truth point rather than on evaluation.

- **Structure:** define *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* -> three doors -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* -> the "accident and separable" conclusion. Clean, fast, complete.
- **Doctrine:** *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, *liṅga* and *sādhya*, *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, *petitio principii*.
- **Argument:** the three doors must be visibly three; a vague "it cannot be proved" earns little.
- **Distinction:** rejection as *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* versus everyday expectation - one clause is enough, but it must be there.
- **Technical terms:** at least four Sanskrit terms, each glossed on first use.
- **Comparison:** at most one clause on Nyāya's reply; the question does not ask for it.

2022 · Q7(c) · 15 marks - supporting routed question, primary owner Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika

Question: How do Naiyāyikas respond to Cārvāka's objections against inference (anumāna) and establish inference as an independent means of knowledge? Critically discuss.

Practice status and source caution: This is an independent learner model, not an official UPSC key. The question is owned primarily by Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika and is reproduced here because it tests the Cārvāka objections from the other side; the Cārvāka half must therefore be stated accurately and then answered, not caricatured.

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> - reconstruct the Nyāya reply and then judge whether it succeeds
Limb 1	How do they respond? - the specific devices, named, not a general appeal to reason
Limb 2	How is independence established? - inference must not reduce to perception or testimony
Limb 3	Critical judgement - what the reply achieves and what it concedes
Scope boundary	Stay on inference; do not drift into the Nyāya proofs of God or the category scheme
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds by changing the standard from omniscient certainty to disciplined warrant, which answers the Cārvāka's conclusion while conceding his logical premise
Non-negotiables	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> ; positive and negative correlation; elimination of the <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> ; <i>hypothetical reasoning (tarka)</i> ; <i>parāmarśa</i> ; the self-refutation counter-charge; one honest limitation

Independent model answer

The objection to be met. FACT: The Cārvāka holds that inference (*anumāna*) is not an independent means of valid knowledge because its indispensable universal, *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, cannot be established: not by perception, which surveys only finite cases; not by inference, which would need a further *vyāpti* and so runs into circularity or regress; and not by testimony, whose own validity is unproved. The *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* sharpens this, since what looked like a bare universal may all along have been conditioned - fire yields smoke only with wet fuel.

The Nyāya response. FACT: The Naiyāyika abandons the demand for an omniscient survey and builds *vyāpti* instead from **agreement in presence (anvaya)**, **agreement in absence (vyatireka)**, the systematic **elimination of suspected upādhis**, and **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)**, which shows that denying the relation makes experience incoherent. Later Nyāya adds *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**, so the relation is grasped between class-characters rather than tallied instance by instance.

Why inference is then independent. ANALYSIS: Independence rests on *parāmarśa*, the mark cognised as **qualified by** the concomitance. That composite cognition is neither a fresh perception of fire nor a speaker's report, so inference is irreducible to perception or testimony.

Critical assessment. ANALYSIS: The reply works by redefinition rather than refutation. Nyāya concedes that finite observation cannot *entail* an unrestricted universal and denies only the epistemological conclusion, since warrant does not require entailment. Three residues remain: *tarka* is not itself a means of valid knowledge; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* presupposes Nyāya realism about universals; and elimination removes only *suspected* conditions.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict:** the Naiyāyika defeats the strong thesis, since a universal denial of inference cannot itself be perceived and other minds are never perceived either. He does not restore certainty; he substitutes disciplined, defeasible warrant - the fallibilist position a refined Cārvāka could accept.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - 2022 Q7(c): the answer must be visibly two-sided. State the Cārvāka objection in its three-door form before replying, name each Nyāya device separately, and prove independence through *parāmarśa* rather than by asserting it.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: objection in three lines; four named devices in one dense paragraph; independence in two lines; one paragraph of honest residue; a one-sentence verdict that distinguishes warrant from certainty.

- **Structure:** objection -> four devices -> the independence argument -> three residues -> graded verdict.
- **Doctrine:** *vyāpti*, *anvaya*, *vyatireka*, *upādhi*, *tarka*, *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa*, *parāmarśa*.
- **Argument:** the independence limb is the one most candidates omit; without *parāmarśa* the answer only defends reliability, not independence.

- **Distinction:** entailment versus warrant - say it explicitly, because it identifies the true locus of the dispute.
- **Criticism:** at least two of the three residues must appear, or the answer reads as partisan.
- **Cross-link:** this is the mirror image of the 2018 and 2025 Cārvāka questions; the same material answers all three from different sides.

These six questions are original practice prompts, not UPSC PYQs. Each model is written independently for learner use.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Explain why the Cārvāka rejects *verbal testimony* (*śabda*) as an independent *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*), and assess whether the rejection is consistent with his acceptance of perception. **(10 marks, about 150 to 200 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Explain</i> then <i>assess</i> - exposition plus a consistency verdict
Core issue	Whether admitting words-as-sounds while refusing words-as-evidence is coherent
Ideal thesis	The rejection is internally consistent, since the perceived item is the sound and the disputed item is the content

Full independent model answer

FACT: The Cārvāka argument runs in steps. Words heard through the ears are **perceived**, so knowledge of words is perceptual and valid. But insofar as words "suggest or mean things not within our perception", they "are not free from error and doubt". Acceptance of an authority proceeds through a suppressed inference - "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" - and, being based on inference, testimony is "as precarious as inference". In the special case of the Veda, claims of authority cannot be perceptually certified, and Chatterjee and Datta report the Cārvāka's charge that the texts are "the works of some cunning priests".

ANALYSIS: Assessment. The rejection is consistent, because the Cārvāka carefully separates two objects: the **sound**, which is perceived, and the **content**, which is not. He therefore denies testimony independent *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*)-status without denying communication. The residual cost is that a life without testimonial knowledge is unliveable - but that is a charge of impracticality, not of inconsistency.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 1: the consistency verdict depends on one distinction - the perceived sound against the unperceived content. State it explicitly, or the assessment collapses into assertion.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: the five-step argument compressed to four lines; the sound-content distinction; the suppressed reliability premise; a verdict separating inconsistency from impracticality.

- The five-step argument reproduced, not merely summarised.
- The sound/content distinction stated explicitly - this is what secures consistency.
- The suppressed reliability premise identified as an **inference**.
- One line on the Veda, framed epistemically rather than as abuse.
- A verdict that distinguishes **inconsistency** from **impracticality**.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish *explanation through natural properties* (*svabhāvavāda*) from *yadr̥cchāvāda* in Cārvāka metaphysics and examine whether they are consistent. **(10 marks, about 150 to 200 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Distinguish</i> then <i>examine</i> consistency - a conceptual distinction put to critical work
Core issue	Whether fixed natures and fortuitous combination can both be asserted
Ideal thesis	They are compatible only if <i>svabhāva</i> governs the behaviour of elements while <i>yadṛcchā</i> governs their initial concurrence ; otherwise there is tension

Full independent model answer

FACT: Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) is naturalism: "the material elements themselves have got each its fixed nature (*svabhāva*)", and it is by these inherent natures and laws that they combine, so "there is thus no necessity for God"; fire is hot and water cool by their own natures. **FACT: Yadṛcchāvāda** is mechanism or accidentalism: it "denies the existence of conscious purpose behind the world" and explains it "as a mere mechanical or **fortuitous** combination of elements".

ANALYSIS: Examination. There is a real tension. If the elements combine **by their fixed natures**, the resulting world is lawful and not fortuitous; if the combination is **fortuitous**, natures cannot be doing the explanatory work. The most charitable reconstruction assigns them different roles: *svabhāva* explains how each element **behaves** once in combination, while *yadṛcchā* denies that any **purpose** governs which combinations occur. On that reading they are consistent, and their joint target is teleology rather than regularity. **ANALYSIS:** The Cārvāka's own caution supports this: he grants that there is "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future".

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 2: the marks lie in refusing to merge the two doctrines. Own-nature explanation preserves regularity; accidentalism destroys it, and its attribution to the school must be flagged as contested.

Exam-length execution - 10 marks, about 150 to 200 words: define both; one named illustration each; the consistency verdict; one line on why the contested attribution matters for what may safely be written.

- Both terms defined with the textbook's own glosses.
- The tension named explicitly rather than glossed over.
- A charitable reconstruction offered, with its division of labour.
- The "no guarantee of future uniformity" line used as evidence for the deflationary reading.
- A verdict that identifies **teleology**, not regularity, as the common target.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine the Cārvāka doctrine that consciousness is an emergent by-product of the four elements, with the objections it faces. **(15 marks, about 250 to 300 words)**

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Examine ... with the objections</i> - exposition plus a serious objection set and replies
Core issue	Whether the emergence analogies establish emergence of the right logical type
Ideal thesis	The analogies establish that novel public qualities emerge; consciousness is private and first-personal, so the explanatory gap remains - though dualism does not close it either

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The doctrine.** *Kiṇvāḍibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam*: consciousness arises from matter as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents. The objection it answers is stated by Chatterjee and Datta: "we do not perceive consciousness in any of the four material elements. How can it then come to qualify their product, the body?" The reply uses two analogies with distinct functions. **Betel** - leaf, lime and nut, "none of which is originally red", yielding a reddish tinge when chewed together - establishes **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** - molasses, "originally non-intoxicant", becoming intoxicant when allowed to ferment - establishes **transformational** emergence. Consciousness is accordingly "an **epiphenomenon** or by-product of matter".

ANALYSIS: **Objections.** (i) The analogies concern **public, third-person** qualities; consciousness is **private** - Sharma notes it "is neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard", and "consciousness of an individual cannot be shared by others". (ii) In swoon, epilepsy and dreamless sleep the living body persists **without** consciousness, so the property is not inseparable. (iii) Constant co-occurrence is not causation: "the eye cannot see in darkness ... yet light cannot be regarded as the cause of sight", and the two horns of a bull are conjoined without being causally related - so the body may be the **instrument** of consciousness rather than its cause.

ANALYSIS: **Replies and verdict.** The Cārvāka may answer that the property is essential to a specific **organisation** rather than to bare bodily existence, and that positing an immaterial soul merely **renames** the gap. The honest verdict: the evidence establishes **dependence**, not production; both sides face the gap, and only one claims to have crossed it.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 3: state the emergence claim precisely before objecting to it, and keep the two analogies doing different work - one compositional, one transformational - rather than treating them as interchangeable.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: the claim in three lines; both analogies with their distinct roles; the bearer objection and the explanatory-gap objection; a verdict that concedes what emergence does not explain.

- The transmitted *sūtra* quoted or paraphrased.
- Both analogies, with their **distinct** functions named.
- The word *epiphenomenon* used precisely.
- At least three objections, at least two of them from the standard battery.
- The Cārvāka's replies given before the verdict.
- A verdict distinguishing **dependence** from **production**.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "The Cārvāka's *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) objection is a stronger argument than his objection from incomplete enumeration." Critically discuss. (15 marks, about 250 to 300 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically discuss</i> an evaluative comparison between two of the Cārvāka's own arguments
Core issue	Sample size versus identification of the relevant variable
Ideal thesis	The claim is correct: enumeration is curable in principle by more observation, whereas <i>hidden limiting condition</i> (<i>upādhi</i>) is not

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The enumeration objection.** *Invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) requires knowledge of all cases, and "we cannot perceive even all the cases of smoke and fire existing now ... to speak nothing of those which existed in the past or will exist in the future".

FACT: **The hidden limiting condition (*upādhi*) objection.** Even where two things are repeatedly observed together, an unnoticed condition may be operating. One who has often seen fire accompanied by smoke may infer smoke from

fire and err, having failed to notice the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* of **wetness of fuel**, on whose presence alone fire is attended with smoke. Hence "so long as the relation between two phenomena is not proved to be **unconditional**, it is an uncertain ground for inference" - and unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may **always remain hidden**".

ANALYSIS: **Why the second is stronger.** Enumeration is a defect of **quantity**: more observation improves the position, even if it never completes it. *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is a defect of **identification**: it concerns whether the property picked out is the genuine ground of the relation, and no amount of further counting settles it. The proof is dialectical - Nyāya answers enumeration with *bhūyodarśana* and the joint method of co-presence and co-absence, but must bring in **hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* to address *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*, and concedes that only **suspected** conditions can be eliminated.

ANALYSIS: **Counter-consideration and verdict.** Nyāya may reply that a relation surviving systematic negative-case testing plus *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* is rationally warranted even if not indefeasible. That defends inference; it does not refute the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* point. The claim therefore stands: *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is the deeper argument, and it is the one that forces Nyāya to change the standard from certainty to warrant.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 4: the comparison is the answer. Show that incomplete enumeration is quantitative and can in principle be reduced, while the hidden condition is structural and survives any amount of observation.

Exam-length execution - 15 marks, about 250 to 300 words: define both objections; the structural-versus-quantitative contrast; the Nyāya elimination reply; the residue that elimination removes only suspected conditions; a verdict.

- Both objections stated accurately, with the *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* example running **fire → smoke**.
- The quantity/identification distinction stated as the pivot of the answer.
- The dialectical proof: Nyāya's differential response to the two objections.
- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* correctly described as an auxiliary, not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- A verdict that concedes Nyāya's warrant-based defence while upholding the comparison.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: "Cārvāka's metaphysics is nothing but its epistemology written out as a list of denials." Critically evaluate. (20 marks, about 340 to 400 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Critically evaluate</i> a strong interpretive claim - say how far it is true and where it fails
Core issue	Whether the metaphysics is wholly derivative or contains independent positive commitments
Ideal thesis	Largely true of the denials , false of the affirmations - the four elements, emergence and <i>svabhāva</i> are positive theses not entailed by the epistemology alone

Full independent model answer

FACT: **The case for the claim.** Chatterjee and Datta state that the Cārvāka theory of reality "**follows from**" the epistemological conclusion: if perception is the only reliable source of knowledge, "we can rationally assert only the reality of perceptible objects. God, soul, heaven, life before birth or after death, and any unperceived law (like *adrṣṭa*) cannot be believed in, because they are all beyond perception."

The derivation is exact. *Ākāśa* falls because it is inferred from sound. *Enduring self (ātman)* falls because no soul is perceived apart from the living body. *Lord (īśvara)* falls because he is reached only by design-inference. *Action and moral consequence (karma)*, *adrṣṭa*, rebirth, *svarga* and *liberation (mokṣa)* fall as unseen forces or post-mortem states. Vedic authority falls with *verbal testimony (śabda)*, and ritual with it. One cut, seven casualties.

ANALYSIS: **Where the claim fails.** Three points. (i) The derivation needs a **bridging principle** - that ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)* - which is a **presupposition**, not a theorem. An opponent could accept the epistemology and hold that reality exceeds knowledge; the Cārvāka's refusal

of that gap is a substantive metaphysical decision.

(ii) The metaphysics contains **positive** theses the epistemology does not yield. That there are exactly **four** elements, that they are **eternal** while their combinations perish, that consciousness **emerges** from organised matter as redness emerges from betel and intoxication from fermented molasses, and that *svabhāva* explains regularity - none of these is entailed by "only perception is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*". They are empirical and explanatory hypotheses.

(iii) There is even an internal strain among them: *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* grounds regularity in fixed natures while *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world's objects "fortuitous products". A purely derivative metaphysics could not generate such a tension.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict**. The claim is **true of the negative half and false of the positive half**. Cārvāka's denials are indeed epistemology written out as a list - which is why they stand or fall entirely with the rejection of inference. But its affirmations are a materialist research programme in miniature, and they carry explanatory burdens of their own: chiefly the explanatory gap between public emergent qualities and private consciousness, which no epistemic restriction can discharge. ANALYSIS: Criterion named: **derivational economy** supports the claim, **explanatory content** refutes it.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 5: the quotation must be tested, not illustrated. Show the derivation working, then find the point at which the metaphysics adds something the epistemology alone does not license.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the derivation in four denials; two places where the ontology outruns the criterion; the strongest objection with a reply; a graded verdict on the quotation itself.

- The derivation reproduced compactly, with connectives.
- The bridging principle named as a **presupposition**.
- At least three positive theses identified as underivable from the epistemology.
- The internal *svabhāva* / *yadṛcchā* tension used as evidence.
- A split verdict - true of the denials, false of the affirmations - with a named criterion.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: Compare the Cārvāka and Nyāya positions on *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, and assess whether Nyāya successfully answers the Cārvāka. (20 marks, about 340 to 400 words)

Demand decoding

Element	Requirement
Directive	<i>Compare</i> then <i>assess success</i> - the assessment must name a standard of success
Core issue	Whether replacing certainty with warrant answers the objection or changes the subject
Ideal thesis	Nyāya succeeds against the practical challenge and concedes the logical point; the dispute is ultimately about the concept of knowledge

Full independent model answer

FACT: **Cārvāka**. *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is required for inference to claim certainty, and it can be had from no admitted source. Not from perception: all cases past, present and future are never surveyed, and the retreat to class-characters fails, since "smokeness" itself is not perceptually known. Not from inference: *petitio principii* or regress; deduction is circular and induction unwarranted. Not from testimony: its own validity is inferred, and if inference depended on it "no one could infer anything by himself". *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* completes the case, since unconditionality cannot be certified while hidden conditions "may always remain hidden and escape notice".

FACT: **Nyāya**. *Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* is **assembled**, not intuited in one act. Repeated observation (*bhūyodarśana*) is disciplined as **agreement in presence (anvaya)** (co-presence) and **agreement in absence (vyatireka)** (co-absence), making it a structured search for counter-instances. Suspected *upādhis* are identified and the universal restated at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel, there smoke". **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** -

not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* but a *pramāṇa-anugrāhaka* - assumes the contradictory and exhibits an unacceptable consequence, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*. **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa** answers the class-character objection by presenting the universal through the particular. Finally, **parāmarśa** - the mark cognised as qualified by concomitance - shows that no "leap" occurs at all.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Nyāya succeeds on three counts. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* has real bite against Cārvāka specifically, since the Cārvāka's own acting, expecting and arguing presuppose the regularities he refuses to certify. *Parāmarśa* dissolves the "leap" picture on which the objection trades. And Sharma's counter-attack reverses the hierarchy: perception errs - the flat earth, the static earth, the small solar disc - and is corrected **by inference**, while "mere sensation cannot be regarded as a means of knowledge unless conception ... has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data".

ANALYSIS: Yet three concessions remain. Only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated. *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing alone. *Sāmānyalakṣaṇa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals.

ANALYSIS: **Verdict.** Nyāya answers the Cārvāka **by changing the standard** - from omniscient certainty to disciplined rational warrant, since "the Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice". Judged by **warrant**, Nyāya wins; judged by **entailment**, the Cārvāka's logical point survives untouched. The real disagreement is therefore about the concept of knowledge, not about the logic of induction, on which both agree.

Why this earns marks

Answer-writing focus - Original 6: the assessment limb decides the grade. Show that both sides agree finite observation cannot entail a universal, so the dispute is about the concept of knowledge, not about induction.

Exam-length execution - 20 marks, about 340 to 400 words: the Cārvāka case; four Nyāya devices; the entailment-versus-warrant diagnosis; three honest residues against Nyāya; a verdict naming its criterion.

- Both positions given their strongest form, with Sanskrit terms glossed.
- The eight-stage Nyāya construction at least summarised.
- *Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* and *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* correctly characterised, including their limits.
- Sharma's counter-attack on perception included.
- A verdict that names **two** criteria and delivers a different result under each.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Enrichment only. A competent core answer does not require this block. Use it selectively for qualification, comparison, objections/replies and a higher-quality verdict after the Basic doctrine and answer structure are secure. Every substantive legacy Layer 3 point is retained below under the same nine subtopics.

1. Historical Reconstruction and the Source Problem

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka was not marginal to Indian philosophy; it was structural.** Chatterjee and Datta make the point in their concluding section and it is worth reproducing as an evaluative sentence: "every system of Indian thought tried to meet the Cārvāka objections and made the Cārvāka a **touchstone** of its theories." They add that its value "lies directly in supplying fresh philosophical problems and indirectly in compelling other thinkers to give up dogmatism, and become critical and cautious in speculation as well as in the statement of views" - and they compare this to Kant's admission that "the scepticism of Hume roused me from my dogmatic slumber."

ANALYSIS: **Sharma's counterweight, which a balanced answer should also carry:** "Materialism in Indian Philosophy has never been a force. Born in discontent, it soon died in serious thought." The two verdicts are not contradictory: Cārvāka failed as a *positive system* while succeeding as a *critical function*. That two-sided judgement is exactly the graded verdict UPSC rewards.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The reconstruction problem here belongs to a general class: how to state fairly a position preserved only in the words of those who rejected it. The same methodological question arises in reading the Greek Sophists through Plato, or the Presocratics through Aristotle. ANALYSIS: Use this as a *methodological* remark of one sentence. It is a conceptual parallel, **not** a dated development, and it must never be written as though it were news.

2. Epistemology - Perception as the Sole Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's scepticism is selective, and Sharma turns that selectivity into an objection.** Śūnyavāda Buddhism and Advaita Vedānta also reject the *ultimate* validity of inference - but, as Sharma notes, "the Śūnyavādin and the Advaitin reject the ultimate validity of **all** means of knowledge as such **including perception**, though they insist on the empirical validity of all means of knowledge. The distinction between ultimate and empirical knowledge is **unknown to the Cārvāka**. To accept the validity of perception and, at the same time and from the same standpoint, to reject the validity of inference is a thoughtless self-contradiction."

ANALYSIS: This gives you a **three-way comparison** that very few candidates will produce:

School	Perception	Inference	Level-distinction available?
Cārvāka	FACT: Valid, full stop	WRONG: Rejected, full stop	WRONG: None - hence Sharma's charge of "same standpoint" inconsistency
Śūnyavāda	ANALYSIS: Empirically valid, ultimately not	ANALYSIS: Empirically valid, ultimately not	FACT: <i>Samvṛti</i> / <i>paramārtha</i>
Advaita	ANALYSIS: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> validity only	ANALYSIS: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> validity only	FACT: <i>Vyāvahārika</i> / <i>pāramārthika</i>

ANALYSIS: **The Cārvāka's best available repair**, and you should offer it before evaluating: *adopt the level-distinction*. If the Cārvāka says "inference has *vyāvahārika* usefulness but no *pāramārthika* validity", Sharma's charge of same-standpoint inconsistency loses its grip - at the price of conceding that the doctrine is a thesis about certainty rather than about usability. That is precisely the softened reading defended in Subtopic 3.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The Cārvāka analysis of *verbal testimony* (*śabda*) - that a hearer's acceptance of testimony always runs through a suppressed premise about the speaker's reliability - is the ancestor of the modern **reductionist** position in the epistemology of testimony, and it is the exact point at issue in contemporary debates about credibility and misinformation. ANALYSIS: Label it as a conceptual parallel in a single clause if at all; do not import modern examples into a Paper I answer in place of *perception* (*pratyakṣa*), *inference* (*anumāna*) and *verbal testimony* (*śabda*), and do not present it as a dated event.

3. The Critique of Inference - Invariable concomitance (vyāpti), Hidden limiting condition (upādhi), the Socrates Syllogism and Self-Refutation

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Distinguish two Cārvāka claims that are constantly run together in scripts:**

CLAIM A (epistemic) : inference does not GUARANTEE truth
-> defensible; almost universally granted today
CLAIM B (semantic/ ontological) : the words "wherever smoke, there fire" express
no knowable proposition at all
-> far stronger; hard to hold while doing philosophy

ANALYSIS: Most of the force of the Cārvāka critique lives in Claim A. Most of the vulnerability to self-refutation lives in Claim B. A first-class answer separates them and says which one it is defending.

ANALYSIS: **A further refinement on the target.** The Cārvāka's practical inferences are always **perceptually redeemable**: I infer fire, I climb the hill, I see fire. Transcendental inferences are **structurally unredeemable**: I infer heaven from *agnihotra*, and no perception could ever cash the claim. The Cārvāka's position becomes far more defensible when stated as: *an inference is worth something to the extent that its conclusion is in principle perceptually checkable* - which is a verificationist criterion in Indian dress, and is exactly the material needed for the 2024

"positivism" question.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The *invariable concomitance* (*vyāpti*) argument is a strikingly early and complete statement of what Western philosophy calls **the problem of induction**: that no finite set of observations entails an unrestricted universal, and that attempts to justify induction inductively are circular. The *hidden limiting condition* (*upādhi*) argument anticipates the modern problem of **confounding variables** - the possibility that an observed regularity tracks an unnoticed third factor. ANALYSIS: These are conceptual parallels for one clause of comparative colour, not dated developments, and they must never displace the Indian vocabulary in a Paper I script.

4. The Nyāya Defence of Inference - and a Critically Balanced Verdict

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **What the debate is really about, stated at the highest level.** Both sides agree that finite observation cannot logically entail an unrestricted universal. They disagree about what follows.

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CARVAKA : entailment fails => no knowledge => no pramana-status
NYAYA   : entailment fails => but WARRANT does not require entailment
                               => disciplined procedure yields knowledge
                               => pramana-status is preserved
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ANALYSIS: The disagreement is therefore about the **concept of knowledge**, not about the logic of induction, on which the two are in near-agreement. Writing that sentence identifies the true locus of the dispute and is the mark of a top script.

ANALYSIS: **The honest residue against Nyāya**, which a balanced answer must supply so as not to look partisan: (i) *hypothetical reasoning* (*tarka*) is admittedly not a *means of valid knowledge* (*pramāṇa*) and cannot by itself establish anything; (ii) *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* is defensible only inside Nyāya's realism about universals, so it is not a neutral answer; (iii) the elimination of *upādhis* is always elimination of **suspected** conditions, never a proof that none remains. Nyāya's inference is therefore highly disciplined but not indefeasible - which is precisely what a fallibilist Cārvāka wanted to hear.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: Nyāya's replacement of certainty by disciplined warrant, with negative-case testing and the systematic elimination of confounders, is conceptually parallel to modern accounts of **inference under uncertainty** - controlled comparison, elimination of alternative explanations, and degrees of confirmation rather than proof. ANALYSIS: Use at most one clause of this in an answer, explicitly as a conceptual analogy, never as a dated development or as authority.

5. Metaphysics and Materialism - Four Bhūtas, the Rejection of Ākāśa, and Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka materialism is not modern scientific materialism, and saying why is worth marks.**

Axis	Cārvāka	Modern scientific materialism
Basic entities	FACT: Four perceptible gross elements	Unobservable micro-entities: fields, particles, forces
Attitude to inference	FACT: Denies it <i>means of valid knowledge</i> (<i>pramāṇa</i>)-status	Depends on it absolutely - theory is inference from data
Attitude to unobservables	FACT: Refuses them as unwarranted	Admits them freely when they earn their explanatory keep
Method	ANALYSIS: Polemical minimalism	Experiment, prediction, controlled testing, revision
Status of laws	ANALYSIS: <i>Svabhāva</i> , with no guarantee of future uniformity	Law-like regularities, projectible and quantified

ANALYSIS: **The resulting paradox, which is the best single sentence in this subtopic:** *Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route, whereas modern materialism reaches a materialist conclusion by a thoroughly inferential route. The agreement in ontology conceals a total disagreement in method.* That sentence is the pivot of any good answer on whether Cārvāka is "scientific" or "positivistic".

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: *Emergent consciousness from material elements (bhūta-caitanya-vāda)* is an early statement of what is now called **emergent physicalism**, and the objection pressed above - that redness and intoxicating power are third-person properties whereas consciousness is first-personal - is recognisably the modern **explanatory gap** objection. ANALYSIS: This is a conceptual parallel offered for one clause of comparative framing. It is not a dated development, it carries no authority, and in a Paper I script it must never displace *bhūta*, *caitanya*, *svabhāva* and the betel and fermentation analogies.

6. Self, Body and Consciousness - Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda), and Cārvāka versus Buddhist Anātman (2024, 20 marks)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **The point almost no candidate makes, and it is decisive.** Buddhism's *anātman* is **not** a weaker version of Cārvāka's denial; it is a **wider** one. *Rūpa* - material form - is itself one of the five *skandhas*, and is expressly declared not to be self. The Buddhist analysis therefore rules out the Cārvāka's body-self *by name*. Writing this sentence demonstrates that you understand the doctrines rather than the labels: *for the Buddhist, "I am this body" is one of the very identifications that anātman is formulated to dismantle.*

ANALYSIS: **A second refinement: the Puggalavāda foil.** The authored Buddhism file records that some Buddhists, associated with the Vātsīputrīyas, posited a *pudgala* "neither the same as nor different from the *skandhas*", and that the mainstream criticised this as a relapse towards self-theory. ANALYSIS: Use this to show that the pressure to preserve a bearer of moral continuity was felt *inside* Buddhism, and was refused - which makes the contrast with Cārvāka, who simply keeps a bearer and makes it material, doubly instructive.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The Cārvāka-Buddhist-Nyāya triangle is the Indian version of the contemporary three-cornered debate between **substance dualism**, **reductive physicalism** and **bundle or process theories of the self**. ANALYSIS: Note it in a clause if it helps frame the answer; it is a conceptual parallel only, not a dated development, and the Sanskrit vocabulary must carry the answer.

7. The Rejection of Transcendent Entities - God, Soul, Action and moral consequence (karma), Rebirth, Heaven, Liberation (mokṣa), Veda and Ritual

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's atheism is structurally different from every other Indian denial of God, and this comparison is high-value in Paper I and Paper II alike.**

School	Denies a creator God because	Accepts inference (anumāna)?	Accepts scriptural authority?
Cārvāka	FACT: No <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> establishes him, and <i>svabhāva</i> suffices	WRONG: No	WRONG: No
Sāṃkhya	FACT: <i>Primordial material nature (prakṛti)</i> explains evolution; a God is superfluous and would compromise <i>conscious witness (puruṣa)</i> 's inactivity	FACT: Yes	FACT: Yes
Mīmāṃsā	FACT: The Veda is <i>apauruṣeya</i> and <i>apūrva</i> matures without a dispenser	FACT: Yes	FACT: Yes - supremely
Jainism	FACT: The world is uncreated; action and moral consequence (karma) is material and self-operating; but godhood is attained by the liberated soul	FACT: Yes	WRONG: Rejects Vedic authority
Buddhism	FACT: Dependent origination explains arising; an immutable cause cannot yield succession	FACT: Yes	WRONG: Rejects Vedic authority

ANALYSIS: **The resulting single sentence, which is worth memorising:** *Cārvāka is the only Indian school whose atheism is generated by its epistemology rather than by its cosmology or its soteriology - which is why it also rejects the action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and liberation that Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism all retain.* Non-theism is common in Indian philosophy; **this-worldliness is Cārvāka's alone.**

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: The demand that a postulate be in principle checkable, and the treatment of unfalsifiable claims as unwarranted rather than merely unproved, is conceptually parallel to modern **scientific scepticism** and to verificationist criteria of meaning. ANALYSIS: Offer this as a labelled conceptual parallel only, and be careful: the parallel is exactly what makes the 2024 "positivism" question tempting *and* what makes an unqualified "yes" to it wrong, since Cārvāka rejects the very inferential machinery on which modern science runs.

8. Ethics and the Political-Social Meaning - and Cārvāka versus Jaina Reality (2020, 15 marks)

BOOK: Advanced refinement

ANALYSIS: **Was Cārvāka a social philosophy?** Two pieces of evidence, both from Chatterjee and Datta, suggest more than pure appetite: the incorporation of *daṇḍanīti* (political philosophy, the science of governance) and *vārttā* (economics, the science of livelihood) into the philosophy of the Lokāyatikas; and the report that some Cārvākas "regard the **king as God**". ANALYSIS: The natural reading is a **secular theory of political authority**: order is guaranteed not by cosmic *dharma* or divine sanction but by the sovereign, and prosperity by the productive arts. CAUTION: The evidence is thin and doxographical, and must be presented as suggestive rather than established - but it is precisely the material that saves a Cārvāka answer from ending in caricature, and it directly supports the "secular" half of the 2024 label.

ANALYSIS: **A final ethical refinement.** Cārvāka's ethics lacks two things that every rival supplies: a **qualitative** distinction among pleasures (Sharma's "pleasure of the pig") and an account of **other-regarding** obligation. Vātsyāyana supplies a partial answer to the first through cultivation and the fine arts, and Chatterjee and Datta gesture at the second through the necessity of social discipline and the king. But neither is derived from the Cārvāka's own value theory; both are added to it. ANALYSIS: **The honest verdict:** Cārvāka's ethics is a fully coherent theory of *prudence* and an incomplete theory of *morality*.

LINK: Conceptual link (not a current-affairs item)

LINK: Cārvāka's grounding of value in embodied pleasure and pain, without supernatural sanction, is conceptually parallel to modern **secular and naturalistic ethics**; and the *dhūrta* / *suśikṣita* distinction mirrors the Western contrast between crude and refined, or quantitative and qualitative, hedonism. ANALYSIS: Conceptual parallel only, offered in a clause; not a dated development, and never a substitute for *puruṣārtha*, *pleasure (kāma)*, *material well-being (artha)* and the Sanskrit sources.

9. Comparative Synthesis and Answer-Writing Architecture

3. Five verdicts you may safely defend

ANALYSIS: Each of these is defensible, criterion-named and examiner-friendly. Choose according to the question.

1. "Cārvāka's epistemology is more successful as a **critique of certainty** than as a **theory of knowledge**."
2. "Cārvāka's ontology is impeccably derived from its epistemology; its vulnerability is therefore located entirely in that epistemology, not in its metaphysics."
3. "Cārvāka wins the argument that finite observation cannot entail an unrestricted universal, and loses the argument that this abolishes inference as a **means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)** - because Nyāya replaces the demand for omniscient certainty with a demand for disciplined warrant."
4. "Cārvāka denies the **transcendence** of the self while retaining its **substantiality**; Buddhism denies its substantiality while retaining its moral continuity. The two denials are not species of one genus."
5. "Cārvāka is a complete theory of prudence and an incomplete theory of morality; its historical value is critical rather than constructive - it was, as Chatterjee and Datta put it, the **touchstone** on which every other system tested itself."

4. Is Cārvāka positivistic? - the full treatment of the 2024 demand

ANALYSIS: The question ("Do you think Cārvāka's philosophy is positivistic in nature? Give reasons and justifications") invites a **graded** answer. A flat yes or a flat no both lose marks. Structure it as three movements.

ANALYSIS: **Movement 1 - establish that the label is not imported by the examiner.** FACT: Chatterjee and Datta apply it themselves: "The Cārvāka theory on the whole may also be called **positivism**, because it believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena." They also compare its view of inference to that of "the pragmatists and logical positivists". This is a decisive evidential point: you are not being asked to invent a comparison, you are being asked to test one already present in the tradition of exposition.

ANALYSIS: **Movement 2 - the case for the label:**

Respect	Cārvāka	Positivism
Criterion of the knowable	FACT: Only what is presented in perception	Only what is empirically verifiable
Attitude to metaphysics	FACT: Transcendent entities are rejected as unwarranted	Metaphysical statements are rejected as unverifiable
Attitude to theology	FACT: God and afterlife have no <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i>	Theological statements are cognitively empty
Attitude to authority	FACT: Scripture is not an independent source	Revelation is not evidence
Register of dismissal	ANALYSIS: Questions about rebirth and heaven become " meaningless " (Chatterjee and Datta's word)	Unverifiable statements are meaningless
Value theory	FACT: Naturalistic, this-worldly, consequential	Naturalistic and anti-transcendent

ANALYSIS: **Movement 3 - the case against, and it is the stronger half:**

Respect	Cārvāka	Positivism
Inference	FACT: Denied means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)-status - the fatal divergence	Depends utterly on inference; science <i>is</i> systematised inference
Unobservables	FACT: Refused	Freely admitted when they earn their explanatory keep
Programme	ANALYSIS: Polemical minimalism; no method of confirmation	A constructive programme: unified science, criteria of significance, logical analysis
Tools	ANALYSIS: None of formal logic, semantics or probability	Formal logic, verification and confirmation theory, language analysis
Comte's specific content	ANALYSIS: Absent	Law of three stages, sociology, a philosophy of history
Fallibilism	ANALYSIS: Demands indubitability, then finds nothing meets it	Accepts corrigible, revisable knowledge as the norm

ANALYSIS: **The verdict formula.** Cārvāka is positivistic in **spirit** - in its empiricist criterion, its anti-metaphysical temper and its suspicion of unverifiable authority, a resemblance Chatterjee and Datta themselves note. It is **not** positivistic in **method**, because positivism is built on the very inference Cārvāka refuses to certify, and possesses a constructive programme that Cārvāka wholly lacks. The safer and more accurate label is **radical empiricism** or **naturalistic materialism**; "positivism" is a useful analogy, not a historical identity. ANALYSIS: Add the paradox from Subtopic 5: Cārvāka reaches a materialist conclusion by an anti-inferential route, whereas positivism reaches its conclusions by a thoroughly inferential one.

5. India and the West - convergence and divergence

Western figure or movement	Convergence with Cārvāka ANALYSIS:	Divergence ANALYSIS:
Epicurus / Lucretius	Materialist atomism; this-worldly ethics; freedom from fear of the gods and of death	Epicurus offers <i>ataraxia</i> and a theory of prudent, qualitatively ordered pleasure; Cārvāka as transmitted offers no such refinement - though the <i>suśikṣita</i> strand approaches it
Hume	Induction cannot be rationally justified; causal relation is not perceived	Hume grounds inference in custom and treats it as psychologically indispensable, retaining it as knowledge; Cārvāka denies it <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> -status outright
Logical positivism (Ayer)	Suspicion of unverifiable metaphysics; the "meaningless" register	Ayer preserves scientific inference and analyses meaning through formal tools absent in India
Comte	Rejection of theological explanation in favour of observable phenomena	Comte's positivism is a philosophy of history and a science of society; Cārvāka has neither
Contemporary physicalism	Consciousness as arising from material organisation	Modern physicalism is inference-driven and posits unobservables freely

ANALYSIS: **Chatterjee and Datta's own comparative line, which is safe to quote in substance:** the criticism of inference put in the Cārvāka's mouth "reminds us of similar criticism made in modern times against the soundness of deductive logic", and the Cārvāka view "that no inference can yield certain knowledge is the view of many contemporary Western thinkers like the pragmatists and logical positivists." They also compare the school's fate to that of the Epicureans of Greece, who "have been more hated than understood".

Canonical cross-school and answer-depth ledgers

6A. PRESUPPOSITION LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Doctrine	Presupposition	What collapses if denied
Perception as sole means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	Immediate presentation is the only secure mark of knowledge	The entire anti-inference and anti-scripture programme loses its foundation
Invariable concomitance (vyāpti) critique	Universality must be certain, not merely probable, to ground pramāṇa-status	Inference (anumāna) can be rehabilitated as disciplined fallible knowledge
Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) problem	Hidden conditions can always qualify observed regularities	Nyāya-style upādhi-elimination can secure reliable universals
Rejection of verbal testimony (śabda)	Words require independent proof of speaker competence and truth	Veda, reliable testimony, and social knowledge regain pramāṇa-status
Four bhūtas and rejection of ākāśa	Only perceptibly grounded elements are ontologically admissible	A fifth element can be inferred from sound or spatial accommodation
Bhūta-caitanya / emergent consciousness	Consciousness can arise from organized material elements	A non-material self or consciousness-substance becomes necessary
Rejection of action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth	No unseen moral continuity is perceptually established	Dharma, rebirth, and liberation-soteriology regain metaphysical force
Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)	Observable natures are enough to explain regularity	Divine will, adṛṣṭa, action and moral consequence (karma), or teleology may be invoked as deeper explanation
Hedonist ethics	Value must be anchored in embodied this-worldly experience	Dharma and liberation (mokṣa) can override pleasure (kāma) and material well-being (artha)
Rejection of liberation (mokṣa)	Bondage and liberation require an unproved self and post-mortem destiny	The whole puruṣārtha scheme beyond worldly life becomes defensible

6B. OPPONENT'S PRIMA-FACIE POSITION (pūrvapakṣa)-ESTABLISHED CONCLUSION (siddhānta)
LEDGER ANALYSIS:

Objector	Objection	Cārvāka reply	Residual force ANALYSIS:
Nyāya	Self-refutation: rejection of inference is itself inferential. Invariable concomitance (vyāpti) is securable through upādhi-elimination, hypothetical reasoning (tarka) , and sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa . The self is proved because desire, aversion, effort, pleasure, pain, and cognition inhere in a substance.	Dogmatic wing: inference never reaches certainty because invariable concomitance (vyāpti) cannot be secured. Sceptical/Jayarāśi wing: the Naiyāyika's own definitions fail from within. ANALYSIS:	Nyāya gives the strongest systematic defence of inference; Cārvāka must either soften or face self-refutation.
Buddhism	Action and moral consequence (karma) and rebirth are accepted without eternal enduring self (ātman); momentariness does not imply materialism. Buddhists also accept inference as valid.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: rebirth and action and moral consequence (karma) still outrun perception; momentary streams are as unseen as souls when used to explain post-mortem continuity.	Buddhism avoids eternal soul while preserving moral continuity, making it a subtler opponent than theism.
Jainism	Consciousness cannot be a property of elements because elements individually lack it; an emergent property needs a bearer.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: combinations may display novel properties absent in parts; positing individual self (jīva) adds an unperceived substance.	Emergence is asserted more than explained; Jaina pluralism exposes the bearer-problem.
Advaita / Vedānta	Consciousness is self-luminous; the body is known by consciousness, so it cannot be the source of consciousness.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: "self-luminosity" is a metaphysical description of experienced awareness, not proof of a disembodied enduring self (ātman).	The subject-object problem remains hard for materialist emergence.
Mīmāṃsā	The Veda's authority is intrinsic; ridicule of ritual is not an argument against apauruṣeyatva or dharma.	Dogmatic reply: intrinsic authority is not perceived; testimony needs proof, and ritual results are unseen. ANALYSIS:	Mīmāṃsā has a sophisticated theory of language and obligation; satire alone is insufficient.
Yoga / Sāṃkhya	Conscious witness (puruṣa) is distinct from primordial material nature (prakṛti); experience, agency, and liberation require a consciousness-principle beyond matter.	ANALYSIS: Reconstructed reply: conscious witness (puruṣa) is not perceived apart from embodied awareness; liberation is a projection from metaphysical dualism.	Cārvāka struggles to explain witness-consciousness, discipline, and the felt distinction between body and awareness.

6C. INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING ANALYSIS:

A. Knowledge, self and continuity

School	Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)	Self	Consciousness	Action and moral consequence (karma)/rebirth
Cārvāka	Perception (pratyakṣa) alone in strict doctrine; lokasiddha inference only as practical habit ANALYSIS:	Body-self; no surviving enduring self (ātman)	Emergent bhūta-caitanya	Rejected
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Perception, inference, comparison, testimony	Enduring ātman-substance	Quality of self, revealed through cognition	Accepted
Buddhism	Varies; perception and inference central in epistemological schools	No enduring self (ātman)	Stream of momentary consciousness/events	Accepted without eternal self
Jainism	Multiple means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) with standpoint theory	Plural individual self (jīvas)	Intrinsic to individual self (jīva), obscured by action and moral consequence (karma)	Accepted

School	Means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)	Self	Consciousness	Action and moral consequence (karma)/rebirth
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	Perception, inference, reliable testimony	Conscious witness (puruṣa) distinct from primordial material nature (prakṛti)	Conscious witness (puruṣa) as pure consciousness	Accepted
Mīmāṃsā	Perception, inference, comparison, postulation, non-cognition, verbal testimony (śabda) in developed lists	Enduring self	Attribute/manifestation tied to self	Accepted
Advaita Vedānta	Six means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) commonly accepted, with śruti decisive for Brahman	Enduring self (ātman) identical with Brahman	Self-luminous consciousness	Empirical-level acceptance

B. Authority, value and liberation

School	Scripture	God	Puruṣārthas	Liberation
Cārvāka	Rejected as independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	Rejected	Pleasure (kāma) and material well-being (artha) emphasized; dharma/liberation (mokṣa) rejected	Rejected
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	Accepted as reliable testimony	Generally affirmed in later Nyāya	All four	Release (apavarga)
Buddhism	Buddhist teaching accepted within its framework	Creator-God denied	Path-oriented revaluation	Cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)
Jainism	Jaina teaching authoritative	Creator-God denied	Ethical-spiritual discipline	Liberation (mokṣa) of individual self (jīva)
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	Accepted	Classical Sāṃkhya non-theistic; Yoga admits Lord (Īśvara)	All four subordinated to release	Isolation (kaivalya)
Mīmāṃsā	Veda intrinsically authoritative	Creator-God not central	Dharma central	Often secondary to ritual/dharma, varies
Advaita Vedānta	Upaniṣadic śruti decisive	Lord (Īśvara) at empirical level	Liberation (mokṣa) supreme	Liberation through knowledge

Why Cārvāka matters structurally. ANALYSIS: Cārvāka is the standing **opponent's prima-facie position (pūrvapakṣa)** of Indian philosophy. Nyāya clarifies invariable concomitance (vyāpti) by answering it; Mīmāṃsā sharpens Vedic authority against it; Buddhism and Jainism defend action and moral consequence (karma) without crude eternalism; Vedānta defends self-luminosity against body-materialism. Knowing Cārvāka well therefore improves answers on means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), scripture, action and moral consequence (karma), self, and liberation across the whole Indian syllabus.

6D. CONTROLLED WESTERN COMPARISON ANALYSIS:

Western comparator	Point of contact	Decisive disanalogy
Hume	Both question whether observed conjunctions establish necessary universal connection; both are suspicious of metaphysical entities such as substance, soul, and God when they outrun impressions/perception.	Hume does not deny that we should reason inductively; he denies its rational-demonstrative foundation while treating custom as the great guide of life. Cārvāka draws the stronger normative conclusion that inference is not a means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). Hume targets necessary connexion through impressions and ideas; Cārvāka targets invariable concomitance (vyāpti) through regress and hidden limiting condition (upādhi). Hume's bundle view of self differs from Cārvāka's positive conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda), and Hume has a developed moral psychology unlike Cārvāka hedonism.
A.J. Ayer / logical positivism	Both reject metaphysics on experience-linked grounds and dismiss God, soul, and afterlife when not verifiable.	Ayer's claim is semantic: unverifiable metaphysics is meaningless, neither true nor false. Cārvāka's claim is epistemic/ontological: such entities are not known and therefore not admitted. Ayer preserves scientific theoretical statements through indirect/weak verifiability; strict Cārvāka anti-inference threatens science too. Ayer's verification principle is charged with self-refutation, paralleling the self-refutation charge against Cārvāka.
Epicurus / Lucretius	Materialism, rejection of fear-based religion, and this-worldly pleasure make the comparison tempting.	Epicurean pleasure is ascetic and calculative, aiming at ataraxia (tranquillity); Cārvāka hedonism is usually presented as straightforward embodied enjoyment, though a refined prudential reading is possible.
Pyrrhonism / Jayarāṣi	Jayarāṣi's sceptical wing and Pyrrhonism both allow ordinary life to continue after suspension or collapse of foundations.	Pyrrhonism seeks tranquillity through epochē (suspension), whereas Jayarāṣi works through pramāṇa-definition destruction within Indian debate; do not merge the traditions.
Feuerbach / Marx on religion's social function	Cārvāka's charge that ritual is the livelihood of priests anticipates a functional critique of religion as serving human/social interests.	Feuerbach and Marx build broader theories of projection, alienation, ideology, and society. Cārvāka offers sharp anti-ritual polemic without a historical-materialist theory.
Locke / general empiricism	Knowledge must be tied to experience; innate or purely speculative metaphysical claims are distrusted.	Locke and most empiricists accept abstraction, probability, testimony, and science-friendly inference. Cārvāka's strict pratyakṣa-only thesis is much narrower and more disruptive.

Rubric. ANALYSIS: Western parallels are illustrative only, never a substitute for the Indian argument, and belong in at most one or two lines **after** the Cārvāka case is complete. These are conceptual analogies, not historical influences. Writing "Cārvāka is the Indian Hume" without stating the disanalogies is a marked weakness.

6E. DIRECTIVE DECODER ANALYSIS:

Directive	What the examiner is testing	Structural move for a Cārvāka answer	Closing verdict
Discuss	Breadth and balanced presentation	State doctrine -> explain means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) basis -> show metaphysical consequences -> add one criticism	"Cārvāka is best read as radical epistemic economy, not mere denial."
Examine	Internal logic	Trace how pratyakṣa-only leads to anti-inference and anti-transcendence	"The conclusion follows if its strict perceptual premise is accepted."
Critically examine	Doctrine plus objections	Present Cārvāka argument, then Nyāya/Vedānta/Mīmāṃsā objections and replies	"Powerful as critique, unstable as complete system."
Analyse	Component-wise causal logic	Break into means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), invariable concomitance (vyāpti), hidden limiting condition (upādhi), verbal testimony (śabda), ontology, ethics	"Its metaphysics is generated by epistemology."
Evaluate	Final judgement required	Weigh strengths, weaknesses, and contested source-history	"Valuable negative philosophy; limited positive account."
Compare	Relation with another school	Use fixed axes: means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), self, consciousness, action and moral consequence (karma), liberation	"Similarity at one point must not hide doctrinal difference."
Distinguish	Sharp contrasts	Define both terms/schools first, then contrast on 4-5 axes	"The safest answer is difference plus one connecting insight."
Elucidate / Comment / Bring out	Clarity of explanation	Give thesis, one argument, one example, one implication	"This shows why the doctrine matters in the larger system."
Do you agree?	Reasoned personal verdict	State qualified agreement/disagreement after doctrinal exposition	"Agree with its critique of unwarranted transcendence, not with its total means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa) restriction."
"Cārvāka's rejection of X is self-refuting - critically examine"	Ability to handle the recurring self-refutation pattern	Show why the dogmatic wing is vulnerable; then introduce lokasiddha inference and Jayarāśi's prasaṅga-style escape route	"The charge is decisive only against an absolute denial of all reasoning; it is weaker against refined empiricism or dialectical scepticism."

6F. GRADED VERDICT ON CĀRVĀKA ANALYSIS:

Strong FACT:

- A genuine early principle of epistemic economy: do not multiply unseen entities without warrant.
- A real and still powerful problem about the warrant for universals and invariable concomitance (vyāpti).
- A valuable naturalistic check on speculative metaphysics, ritualism, and unverifiable claims.
- A functional critique of ritual religion as serving priestly livelihood rather than truth.
- In Jayarāśi, a serious dialectical scepticism that can challenge every pramāṇa-definition from within.

Weak ANALYSIS:

- The self-refutation problem is serious for the dogmatic wing.
- Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda) gives no full account of why natures are stable.
- Bhūta-caitanya asserts emergence but does not adequately explain subjectivity.
- The ethics cannot easily distinguish prudence from impulse unless reconstructed charitably.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

- What the school actually held, because no primary systematic text of the materialist wing survives.
- Whether dhūrta and suśikṣita Cārvāka name real internal schools or hostile doxographical types.
- Whether yadṛcchāvāda belongs to Cārvāka or is a distinct ahetuvāda option.
- Whether Jayarāśi is properly a Cārvāka or an allied radical sceptic.

Ready verdicts. ANALYSIS:

- **10 marks:** Cārvāka is strongest as an epistemological protest against unverifiable metaphysics, but weakest when its rejection of inference becomes absolute.
- **15 marks:** Its pratyakṣa-only principle powerfully explains the rejection of enduring self (ātman), action and moral consequence (karma), Lord (Īśvara), and liberation (mokṣa); yet Nyāya's self-refutation and invariable concomitance (vyāpti) replies show why it cannot stand as a complete theory of knowledge.
- **20 marks:** The best verdict is graded: dogmatic Cārvāka is vulnerable, refined Cārvāka is a coherent empiricist restriction on supersensible inference, and Jayarāśi's wing is a serious prasaṅga-style scepticism rather than crude materialism.

Anti-caricature warning. FACT: A strong UPSC answer presents Cārvāka as a serious epistemological position and standing opponent's prima-facie position (pūrvapakṣa), not as mere hedonism or a stock joke about pleasure.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

A. Source status

- The *Bṛhaspati-sūtra* is lost.
- Most doctrine survives through refutational doxographies.
- Convergence supports a recoverable core, but exact quotation requires caution.
- Jayarāśi is a sceptical witness associated with the stream, not a simple manual of standard doctrine.

B. Epistemic thesis

- Standard reconstruction: perception alone is an independent *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- External and internal perception ground ordinary cognition.
- Testimony depends on prior trust and is not independently self-validating.
- Practical expectation may be admitted without granting certain inference.

C. Critique of inference

- Inference requires universal *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.
- Perception cannot survey all times, places and cases.
- Inference cannot prove *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)* without circularity or regress.
- Testimony cannot rescue inference if testimony itself depends on inference.

D. Hidden limiting condition (upādhi) and self-refutation

- Hidden conditions defeat over-broad universals.
- The Socrates syllogism is formally valid but its universal premise remains epistemically contested.
- Absolute denial of inference appears self-refuting.
- A softened reading restricts secure inference, especially about supersensible entities.

E. Nyāya reply

- Repeated agreement and difference establish provisional concomitance.
- Elimination of suspected conditions and *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* strengthen *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*.
- Universal-character perception and *parāmarśa* explain inferential cognition.
- Nyāya offers disciplined warrant, not omniscient enumeration.

F. Material reality

- Four perceptible elements: earth, water, fire and air.
- Ether is rejected because it is imperceptible.
- *Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* explains natural processes without transcendent agency.
- Modern scientific materialism must not be read back into the ancient position.

G. Self and consciousness

- *Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)*: the conscious living body is the self.
- Consciousness emerges from material combination, often illustrated through fermentation or betel.
- Death ends the individual because no separable soul remains.
- The explanatory gap between matter and subjectivity remains a serious objection.

H. Transcendent denials

- No independently established enduring self (ātman), Lord (Īśvara), action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth, heaven, hell or liberation (mokṣa).
- Vedic authority and sacrificial claims fail the perceptual test.
- Withholding assent and categorical denial should be distinguished.
- The epistemology drives the metaphysical rejection.

I. Ethics

- *Material well-being (artha)* is the practical means and *pleasure (kāma)* the operative end.
- Pleasure is not automatically momentary recklessness; consequences are perceptible.
- Famous "borrow ghee" style verses require source caution.
- Cārvāka is a this-worldly ethic, not merely an invitation to vice.

J. Comparative map

Comparison	Cārvāka	Rival
Jainism	four-element materialism	many-sided realist pluralism
Buddhism	body-self materialism	no-self process theory
Nyāya	perception-only challenge	four means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas) and inference defence
Vedānta	no transcendent self	self/Brahman as fundamental

K. Labels and evaluation

- "Positivistic" is defensible only as qualified anti-metaphysical empiricism.
- "Naturalistic" fits the rejection of supernatural explanation.
- "Materialist" is central; "scientific materialist" is anachronistic.
- The strongest achievement is epistemic protest; the weakest point is absolute anti-inferentialism.

L. Final answer discipline

1. Begin with the hostile-source qualification.
2. State the perception-only thesis precisely.
3. Reconstruct the *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)/hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* argument in steps.
4. Connect epistemology to materialism and transcendent denials.
5. Present the strongest version before criticism.
6. Add the Nyāya reply or relevant comparative school.
7. End with a graded verdict: powerful critique, incomplete positive epistemology.

Final judgement: Cārvāka is best read as a disciplined empiricist and materialist challenge to unsupported transcendence. Its historical source problem demands caution, and its absolute rejection of inference remains internally unstable.

Detailed inherited nine-subtopic register

Register-last rule satisfied. The first matrix separates what is required for a core answer from what is optional enrichment. The detailed nine-register legacy revision set follows, preserving source cautions, Sanskrit terminology, argument spines, comparisons, PYQ routes and rapid recall.

CORE BASIC versus OPTIONAL ADVANCED - nine-subtopic recall matrix

Subtopic	CORE BASIC - required for a competent answer	OPTIONAL ADVANCED - enrichment only
1. Source problem	Lost <i>Bṛhaspati-sūtra</i> ; hostile doxography; convergent core; cautious use of Jayarāṣi. Selective transmission; Cārvāka as structural <i>opponent's prima-facie position (pūrvapakṣa)</i> and critical touchstone.	
2. Sole means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)	<i>Perception (pratyakṣa)</i> alone; external/internal perception; testimony derivative; practical expectation is not certainty. Strong versus softened thesis; possible level-distinction is a repair, not secure historical doctrine.	
3. Inference critique	<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i> cannot be secured by perception, inference or testimony; <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> threatens universality. Problem of induction; perceptual redeemability; self-refutation repairs and residual pressure.	
4. Nyāya defence	<i>Anvaya-vyatireka</i> , suspected- <i>hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i> elimination, <i>hypothetical reasoning (tarka)</i> , <i>sāmānyalakṣaṇa</i> , <i>parāmarśa</i> . Knowledge as disciplined warrant rather than entailment; Nyāya remains fallible, not indefeasible.	
5. Materialism	Four <i>bhūtas</i> , no <i>ākāśa</i> ; <i>bhūta-caitanya</i> ; betel/fermentation; <i>svabhāva</i> . Emergentism and explanatory gap; anti-inferential materialism differs from modern scientific materialism.	
6. Body-self	<i>Conscious body as self (dehātmavāda)</i> ; conscious living body; first-person predicates; death ends the individual. Personal identity, privacy, instrument-versus-cause objection, Buddhist process comparison and Puggalavāda foil.	
7. Transcendent denials	No <i>enduring self (ātman)</i> , Lord (<i>Īśvara</i>), <i>action and moral consequence (karma)</i> , <i>adṛṣṭa</i> , rebirth, heaven, hell, <i>liberation (mokṣa)</i> or Vedic authority. Withholding versus denial; ritual reductio; epistemic atheism versus other Indian non-theisms.	
8. Ethics/social meaning	<i>Material well-being (artha)</i> as means, <i>pleasure (kāma)</i> as end; refined versus crude hedonism; source caution for famous verses. Prudence versus morality; <i>daṇḍanīti</i> , <i>vārtā</i> , king-as-God report;	

positivism and naturalism qualified. |

| 9. Synthesis | ONE means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa), FOUR elements, TWO operative aims, ZERO transcendent entities; reconstruct before criticising. | Cross-school positioning, controlled comparison, directive decoder and criterion-named graded verdicts. |

Rapid answer spine

SOURCE CAUTION

- > PERCEPTION (pratyakṣa) ALONE
- > INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti) / HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (upādhi) CRITIQUE
- > NYAYA REPLY
- > FOUR-ELEMENT MATERIALISM
- > BODY-SELF AND EMERGENT CONSCIOUSNESS
- > NO TRANSCENDENT ENTITIES
- > MATERIAL WELL-BEING (artha) AS MEANS, PLEASURE (kāma) AS END
- > COMPARISON + CRITERION-NAMED VERDICT

Rapid recall: ONE *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* · FOUR *bhūtas* · TWO operative aims · ZERO transcendent entities.

PYQ routes at a glance

Route	Verified primary-owned questions
Inference and consistency	2018 Q8(b); 2019 Q5(c); 2019 Q6(c); 2025 Q5(a)
Materialism and transcendence	2020 Q6(b); 2021 Q5(e)
Comparisons	2020 Q7(c), Cārvāka-Jainism; 2024 Q6(a), Cārvāka-Buddhism
Comparative label	2024 Q5(a), positivistic nature

KEYWORD & STATEMENT BANK

Term	Rapid meaning
<i>Pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda</i>	Perception alone is an independent <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i>
<i>Invariable concomitance (vyāpti)</i>	Exceptionless relation required by inference
<i>Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)</i>	Hidden qualifying condition that defeats an over-broad universal
<i>Lokasiddha inference (anumāna)</i>	Practical, perception-redeemable expectation; not secure proof of transcendence
<i>Conscious body as self (dehātmanvāda)</i>	The conscious living body is the self
<i>Emergent consciousness from material elements (bhūta-caitanya-vāda)</i>	Consciousness emerges from organised elements
<i>Explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)</i>	Natural own-natures replace divine or unseen governance
<i>Yadṛcchāvāda</i>	Accidentalism; association with Cārvāka is contested
<i>Dhūrta / suśikṣita</i>	Opponent-preserved crude/refined differentiation; use cautiously
Answer sentence	Cārvāka's ontology is the consequence of restricting valid knowledge to perception

Detailed legacy consolidated register - preserved

Placement note: These register notes come **after** all teaching and practice, and cover **every one of the nine subtopics** taught in this session. They are the last-mile revision layer, not a substitute for the session above.

Register 1 - Sources, names and historical setting

Item	Register entry
Syllabus wording	FACT: "Carvaka : Theory of Knowledge; Rejection of Transcendent Entities" (printed wording retained)
Names	FACT: Cārvāka (<i>carv</i> , to chew / <i>cāru-vāk</i> , sweet-worded) · Lokāyata (<i>lokāyata-mata</i> , view of common people) · Bārhaspatya (of Bṛhaspati)
Traditional founder	FACT: Bṛhaspati; his <i>Sūtra</i> is lost; about a dozen <i>sūtras</i> survive as quotations
Transmission	FACT: Known "chiefly" from works that state the views in order to refute them
Sharma's verdict on sources	FACT: "The weak points ... are exaggerated and the strong points are omitted. So we get only a faint caricature and not a true picture"
Key doxographies	FACT: <i>Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha</i> (Mādhava) · <i>Ṣaḍ-darśana-samuccaya</i> (Haribhadra) · <i>Prabodhacandrodaya</i> (a play, Kṛṣṇamiśra) · <i>Tattvasaṅgraha</i> (Śāntarakṣita) · <i>Vedāntasāra</i> (Sadānanda)
Only surviving text	FACT: <i>Tattvapaplavasiṃha</i> , Jayarāsi Bhaṭṭa , c. 8th century CE, published Baroda 1940 - but he attacks perception too and admits not even the elements
Six transmitted <i>sūtras</i>	FACT: four elements · bodies-senses-objects from combination · consciousness as intoxicating power · <i>caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ</i> · <i>pleasure (kāma) evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ</i> · <i>marāṇam eva apavargaḥ</i>
<i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> - exact sense	FACT: Rejects the authority of the Veda (primary sense); also denies life after death (secondary sense); <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> in both
Historical anchors	FACT: Ajita Kesakambalī (<i>Majjhima Nikāya</i> ; believed only in perception and four elements) · Pūraṇa Kassapa · Makkhali Gosāla · Sañjaya Belaṭṭhiputta (<i>Sāmaññaphala-sutta</i>)
Causes of its rise (Sharma)	FACT: Protest against monism and ritual externals; Upaniṣadic idealism unsuited to commoners; exploitation and social crisis
Two standing verdicts	ANALYSIS: Chatterjee-Datta: the school was the touchstone of every system · Sharma: "Born in discontent, it soon died in serious thought"
Mnemonic	MEMORY: ONE, FOUR, TWO, ZERO - one <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> , four elements, two <i>puruṣārthas</i> , zero transcendent entities

Register 2 - Epistemology

- FACT: **Thesis:** *pratyakṣaika-pramāṇavāda* - perception alone is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*.
- FACT: "The entire philosophy of the Cārvākas may be said to depend **logically** on their epistemology" (Chatterjee and Datta).
- FACT: **The standard demanded:** knowledge "about which we can have no doubt" and "which must be true to reality".
- FACT: **Both** external (*bāhya*) and internal (*mānasa*) perception are admitted.
- FACT: Consciousness **is** established by perception; what is denied is the inference from consciousness to an immaterial bearer.

- FACT: **The concession:** "in life we very often act unsuspectingly on inference" - but "truth is not an unfailing character of all inferences; it is only an **accident**, and a **separable** one."
- ANALYSIS: **Laukika / vyāvahārika** inference (corrigible, perceptually redeemable) versus **alaukika / pāramārthika** inference (structurally uncheckable). The second is the real target.
- FACT: **Verbal testimony (śabda) in five steps:** words are heard, hence perceived -> what they *mean* is unperceived -> acceptance runs through "this authority is reliable; all reliable authority should be accepted" -> that is inference -> hence testimony is "as precarious as inference".
- FACT: **The Veda:** "the works of some cunning priests who earned their living by duping the ignorant and the credulous".
- FACT: Sharma's reductio: if testimony proved *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*, "none would be able to infer anything by himself".
- ANALYSIS: **One template kills the rest:** *comparison (upamāna)*, *postulation (arthāpatti)* and *non-cognition (anupalabधि)* each require an unperceived universal.
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's same-standpoint charge:** Śūnyavāda and Advaita reject the *ultimate* validity of **all means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)** including perception while retaining empirical validity; the *vyāvahārika / pāramārthika* distinction is "unknown to the Cārvāka", so accepting perception and rejecting inference at one level is "a thoughtless self-contradiction".
- MEMORY: **Ledger to reproduce:** Cārvāka 1 · Vaiśeṣika and Buddhism 2 · Sāṃkhya-Yoga 3 · Nyāya 4 · Prābhākara 5 · Bhāṭṭa and Advaita 6.

Register 3 - The critique of inference

- FACT: Inference is "a leap in the dark"; some inferences are true only "accidentally".
- FACT: The attack targets the **major premise (vyāpti)**, never syllogistic form.
- FACT: **Door 1 - perception:** all cases past, present and future can never be surveyed.
- FACT: **The class-character (sāmānya) exchange:** even *dhūmatva* cannot be perceptually known, since not all smokes are perceived; and a universal-to-universal relation does not license a particular-to-particular inference. "The difficulty of passing from particulars to the universal ... remains here as before."
- FACT: **Door 2 - inference:** *petitio principii* or regress. Sharma: "Induction is uncertain and deduction is argument in a circle. The logicians, therefore, find themselves stuck up in the mud of inference."
- FACT: A **causal** relation is only a species of invariable relation and inherits the same defect.
- FACT: **Door 3 - testimony:** its own validity is inferred; and if inference depended on testimony, no one could infer by himself.
- FACT: **Hidden limiting condition (upādhi):** the wet-fuel condition - one who infers **smoke from fire** errs, because fire is attended with smoke only where fuel is wet. Unconditionality "cannot be established beyond doubt by perception, as some conditions may always remain hidden".
- ANALYSIS: *Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)* is a problem of the **right variable**, not of sample size - which is why more observation alone cannot answer it, and why Nyāya must bring in *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)*.
- FACT: **2019 Socrates syllogism:** the form is granted; "All men are mortal" is the *invariable concomitance (vyāpti)*; it fails the three doors; the deduction merely re-states an unestablished universal.
- FACT: **Self-refutation (Sharma):** the denial is itself a universal; thoughts, ideas and other minds are never perceived; "the self-refuted Cārvāka position is called sheer nonsense and no system of philosophy".
- ANALYSIS: **Three replies:** *vitaṇḍā* / no-thesis · softened certainty-thesis (strongest) · level-distinction (a repair, not a historical doctrine).
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's tu quoque:** flat earth, static earth, small solar disc - perception errs and is corrected by *inference*; and mere sensation is not knowledge "unless conception or thought has arranged into order ... the loose threads of sense-data" (*Tattvasaṅgraha*).
- MEMORY: **Verdict formula:** the Cārvāka may be **consistent** or **radical**, but not both.

Register 4 - The Nyāya defence

- FACT: **The eight-stage ladder:** *bhūyodarśana* -> *hidden limiting condition (upādhi)*-elimination -> *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* -> *sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa* -> *vyāptigraha* -> *liṅga-darśana* -> *parāmarśa* -> *anumiti*.
- FACT: **Agreement in presence (anvaya)** (wherever *hetu*, there *sādhya*) and **agreement in absence (vyatireka)** (where no *sādhya*, no *hetu*) - the joint method; systematic search for negative cases, not mere counting.
- FACT: **Hidden limiting condition (upādhi)** is a condition that pervades the *sādhya* but not the *hetu*; a defective universal is **restated** at the correct level - "fire joined with wet fuel".
- FACT: **Hypothetical reasoning (tarka)** is *pramāṇa-anugrahaka*, not a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)*: it assumes the contradictory and exhibits *aniṣṭa-prasaṅga*, removing the doubt that blocks *vyāptigraha*.
- FACT: **Sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa**: the universal is presented through the particular - Nyāya's direct answer to the class-character objection.
- FACT: **Parāmarśa**: the cognition of the mark as qualified by concomitance is the *karaṇa* of *anumiti* - hence, for Nyāya, no "leap" occurs at all.
- FACT: **Nirvikalpaka / savikalpaka**: determinate perception is already conceptually qualified, so the Cārvāka's "pure given" is either pre-cognitive or not pure.
- ANALYSIS: **The decisive move**: replace **omniscient certainty** with **disciplined rational warrant**. "The Nyāya point is not infallibilism but disciplined justificatory practice."
- ANALYSIS: **Honest residue**: *hypothetical reasoning (tarka)* proves nothing alone; *sāmānyalakṣaṇa* presupposes realism about universals; only **suspected upādhis** can be eliminated.
- FACT: **Cross-school survey (2018 Q8(b))**: Nyāya, Sāṃkhya-Yoga, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism all retain inference; Advaita retains it *vyāvahārikaally* while denying ultimate validity to all *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)*.
- MEMORY: **Verdict**: Cārvāka loses the war and wins a battle - inference survives as **warranted**, not as **indubitable**.

Register 5 - Metaphysics and materialism

- FACT: **Bridging principle**: ontological commitment must not outrun the accepted *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇas)*. Name it as a **presupposition**.
- FACT: *prthivyāptejovāyuriti tattvāni* - four *bhūtas*; *tatsamudāye śarīrendriya-viśaya-saṃjñā* - bodies, senses and objects from their combination.
- FACT: Living organisms too are elemental combinations, "reduced on death" to the elements.
- FACT: **The elements are eternal; only their combinations arise and perish** (Sharma). Hence Cārvāka is a **realist** materialism, not a flux doctrine.
- FACT: **Ākāśa rejected** "because it is not perceived but inferred" - the Vaiśeṣika inference from sound to an imperceptible substrate is refused.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka's most defensible line on sound: naturalise it into the perceptible air, rather than abandon the substance-quality scheme he uses for the four elements.
- FACT: *kiṇvātibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam* - consciousness arises as intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents.
- FACT: **Betel** (leaf, lime, nut -> red): **compositional** emergence. **Fermentation** (*guḍa* -> intoxicant): **transformational** emergence. Two analogies, two distinct objections answered.
- FACT: Consciousness is an **"epiphenomenon or bye-product of matter"**; "matter secretes mind as liver secretes bile".
- ANALYSIS: **Explanatory gap**: redness and intoxication are public, third-person qualities; consciousness is private and first-personal. Best Cārvāka reply: the soul-hypothesis **renames** the gap rather than closing it.
- FACT: **Pot and potter**: clay is the material cause and the potter the efficient cause; the Cārvāka answers with *svabhāva* - "there is no proof that the objects of the world are the products of any design".
- FACT: **Three labels from the textbook**: naturalism (*svabhāvavāda*) · mechanism (*yadr̥cchāvāda*) · **positivism** ("believes only in positive facts or observable phenomena").

- ANALYSIS: **Two uses of svabhāva**: deflationary (regularity, with "neither any guarantee that uniformity perceived in the past would continue in future") and substantive (nature in place of God). The "empty label" objection bites only on the second.
- FACT: **Sadānanda's Vedāntasāra**: four materialist schools identify the self with the gross body, the senses, the vital breaths, or *sensory mind (manas)*. Śāntarākṣita reports *Kambalāśvatara* holding that consciousness arises from the body **associated with vital breaths**.
- ANALYSIS: Cārvāka reaches materialism by an **anti-inferential** route; modern materialism by a thoroughly **inferential** one.

Register 6 - Self, body and consciousness

- FACT: *caitanya-viśiṣṭaḥ kāyaḥ puruṣaḥ / caitanya-viśiṣṭa deha eva ātmā* - the person is the **living** body qualified by consciousness. Not the corpse; not "no self at all"; not identity with any single element.
- FACT: **Negative argument**: "the non-material soul is **never perceived**".
- FACT: **Positive argument**: "I am fat", "I am lame", "I am blind" - if the "I" were different from the body these would be **meaningless**.
- FACT: **Covariation**: injury, intoxication, ageing, sleep and disease visibly alter awareness.
- FACT: **Consequence**: "death of the body means the end of the individual"; questions of previous life, after-life, rebirth, heaven and hell "become meaningless".
- FACT: **Sharma's objection battery**: self-consciousness versus animal life · swoon, fits, epilepsy and dreamless sleep = body without consciousness · dreams = consciousness "without the living body", and the waking dreamer disowns the dream-body but **owns** the dream-consciousness · subject cannot be reduced to object · **co-existence is not causation** (light and sight; the two horns of a bull) · consciousness is "neither smelt nor tasted nor seen nor touched nor heard" · consciousness is **private** · the self-manifestation regress · the non-existence of a surviving soul is equally undemonstrable.
- ANALYSIS: **Best evaluative line**: the evidence establishes **dependence**; dependence is compatible with the body being the **instrument** rather than the cause.
- FACT: **Memory**: Nyāya/Vedānta invoke *enduring self (ātman)* · Cārvāka invokes bodily-psychological continuity of one organism · Buddhism invokes *santāna*, *pratisandhāna* and (Yogācāra) *ālaya-vijñāna* carrying *bījas*.
- FACT: **2024 core contrast**: Cārvāka **relocates** the self into matter; Buddhism **dissolves** the self into process. Substance retained versus substance abolished.
- FACT: **Grounds**: Cārvāka's is epistemic (never perceived); Buddhism's is ontological (*pratītyasamutpāda*, *kṣaṇikavāda*) and soteriological (self-belief breeds *trṣṇā*).
- FACT: **Aftermaths**: Cārvāka ends the moral narrative at death; Buddhism preserves action and moral consequence (karma), rebirth and *cessation of conditioned suffering (nirvāṇa)* without an owner.
- ANALYSIS: **The decisive refinement**: *rūpa* is itself one of the five *skandhas*, so Buddhist *anātman* rules out the Cārvāka body-self **by name**.
- ANALYSIS: **Foils**: *Puggalavāda* (Vātsīputrīya) inside Buddhism; **Sadānanda's four materialisms** inside Cārvāka.

Register 7 - Rejection of transcendent entities

- FACT: **The template**: X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is a *means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)* -> X is unwarranted -> X is rejected.
- ANALYSIS: Note the gap between **withholding assent** and **denying**; the doxographies attribute denial ("the Cārvākas, therefore, prefer atheism"), the argument licenses only the weaker conclusion.
- FACT: **God falls twice**: epistemically (no *pramāṇa*) and explanatorily (*svabhāva* suffices; the world's objects are "fortuitous products of the elements").
- FACT: **Adṛṣṭa** is named among the casualties - "any unperceived law (like *adṛṣṭa*)". Its very name means "the unseen", making it the perfect test case.
- FACT: **Transmigration requires** a separable self, its survival, a carrier of desert, and knowledge of all three. Cārvāka cuts every one.

- FACT: **Heaven and hell** are "the inventions of the priests"; *svarga* rests on "the unproved existence of a life after death".
- FACT: **The liberation dilemma**: freedom of a soul (absurd - there is no soul) · freedom from all pain in this life (impossible - embodiment mixes pleasure and pain) · residue: *maraṇam eva apavargaḥ*, which "no wise man would willingly work for".
- ANALYSIS: *Maraṇam eva apavargaḥ* is a **reductio of the concept of liberation (mokṣa)**, not a recommendation of death.
- FACT: **Three ritual reductions**: *śrāddha* and the traveller's food · food downstairs feeding a person upstairs · *jyotiṣṭoma* - "why do they not rather sacrifice their own old parents?" The last is an argument from **revealed preference**.
- FACT: *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*: the Agnihotra, the three Vedas, the three staves and ashes were "made by Nature as the livelihood of those destitute of knowledge and manliness"; "the three authors of the Vedas were buffoons, knaves and demons". CAUTION: Quote with a source-caution.
- ANALYSIS: **Cārvāka's uniqueness**: Sāṃkhya, Mīmāṃsā, Jainism and Buddhism are also non-theistic. Cārvāka alone derives its atheism from its **epistemology**, and alone discards *action and moral consequence (karma)*, rebirth and liberation as well.
- ANALYSIS: Internal tension worth flagging: *explanation through natural properties (svabhāvavāda)* grounds regularity in fixed natures; *yadṛcchāvāda* calls the world "fortuitous".

Register 8 - Ethics and social meaning

- FACT: *pleasure (kāma) evaikaḥ puruṣārthaḥ* - enjoyment is the only end; **material well-being (artha) is its means**; *dharma* and *liberation (mokṣa)* are rejected.
- FACT: *Dharma* falls on **epistemic** grounds: "virtue and vice are distinctions made by the scriptures, whose authority cannot be rationally accepted".
- FACT: **Criterion**: a good action yields a balance of pleasure; a bad one brings more pain than pleasure. Hence hedonism.
- FACT: **Dhūrta** (cunning / crude) versus **suśikṣita** (cultured / refined) Cārvākas - "the Cārvākas were not all of the same gross, uncultured type".
- FACT: **Evidence for refinement**: sixty-four fine arts (*catuḥ-ṣaṣṭi-kalāḥ*) · *daṇḍanīti* and *vārttā* incorporated into Lokāyata · some Cārvākas "regard the **king as God**", implying faith in society and its head.
- FACT: **Vātsyāyana** is "the best positive evidence of refined hedonism", but he "believes in God and in life after death" and is a materialist only "according to a wider sense of the term" - one who explains higher phenomena by lower.
- FACT: **Vātsyāyana's regulation**: *brahmacarya*, urbanity (*nāgarika-vṛtti*), education of the senses through the arts; and the prudential argument that refusing to defer "would prevent a man even from the toil of cultivation and sowing seeds".
- FACT: Chatterjee and Datta: "Egoistic hedonism in its gross form is **not compatible with social discipline**."
- ANALYSIS: **Sharma's counterweight**: "crude individual hedonism"; the school's downfall lay in "the denial of all human values"; **"the pleasure of the pig is certainly not the same as the pleasure of the philosopher."**
- CAUTION: **The "debt and ghee" verse** - "let him feed on ghee even though he runs in debt" - is preserved in the *Sarva-darśana-saṃgraha*, an opponent's compendium. Use with an explicit source-caution; its buried argument concerns the rationality of deferral under a finite horizon, and Vātsyāyana himself answers it.
- ANALYSIS: **Verdict**: Cārvāka's ethics is a coherent theory of **prudence** and an incomplete theory of **morality** - it supplies no qualitative ordering of pleasures and no independent account of other-regarding obligation.

Register 9 - Comparative synthesis and answer craft

Item	Register entry
2020 Jainism axes	FACT: 1 <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> vs fivefold knowledge · 4 <i>bhūtas</i> vs 6 <i>dravyas</i> · <i>ākāśa</i> rejected vs accepted · no soul vs infinite <i>individual self (jīvas)</i> with consciousness as inseparable essence · no <i>constituent quality (guṇa)-paryāya</i> vs <i>utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya</i> · single standpoint vs <i>anekānta, naya, syādvāda</i> · no action and moral consequence (karma) vs material action and moral consequence (karma), split into <i>bhāvabandha</i> and <i>dravyabandha</i> · no liberation vs <i>liberation (mokṣa)</i> and <i>kevala-jñāna</i>
Shared ground with Jainism	FACT: Both <i>Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)</i> ; both realists about the perceptible world; both reject a creator God
2024 positivism verdict	ANALYSIS: Positivistic in spirit (empiricist criterion, anti-metaphysics, "meaningless" register - and the textbook itself applies the word), not in method (positivism runs on inference and has a constructive programme). Safer labels: radical empiricism, naturalistic materialism
The paradox to quote	ANALYSIS: Cārvāka reaches materialism by an anti-inferential route; modern materialism by an inferential one
Western convergences	ANALYSIS: Epicurus and Lucretius (materialism, this-worldliness) · Hume (induction unjustifiable) · Ayer (unverifiable metaphysics) · Comte (observable phenomena). Chatterjee and Datta themselves compare the Cārvāka view of inference to "the pragmatists and logical positivists" and the school's reputation to that of "the Epicureans of Greece"
10-mark spine	Thesis -> three doors -> one sharp addition (<i>upādhi</i> or self-refutation) -> verdict linking epistemology to the denial asked about
15-mark spine	Frame with the source caution -> full anti-inference argument -> the rival's positive case -> Cārvāka's best reply and its cost -> graded verdict with a named criterion
20-mark spine	Classify (epistemology generating metaphysics) -> theory of knowledge in full -> ontological consequences -> the demanded comparison on named axes -> two objections with replies and residual pressure -> criterion-named verdict
PYQ centre of gravity	FACT: 5 of 9 owned parts concern inference ; 2 the self and transcendent entities; 1 the Jaina comparison; 1 the positivism label
Criteria to name in verdicts	ANALYSIS: Evidential economy · explanatory adequacy · internal consistency · perceptual redeemability · moral sufficiency · historiographical reliability
The five safe verdicts	ANALYSIS: Critique of certainty, not a theory of knowledge · ontology impeccably derived, so vulnerability lies in the epistemology · wins on entailment, loses on <i>means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa)</i> -status · relocation versus dissolution of the self · complete prudence, incomplete morality
Final memory spine	MEMORY: ONE, FOUR, TWO, ZERO · three doors · wet fuel · betel and fermentation · "I am fat, I am lame, I am blind" · <i>maraṇam eva apavargaḥ</i> · <i>dhūrta</i> and <i>suśikṣita</i> · touchstone

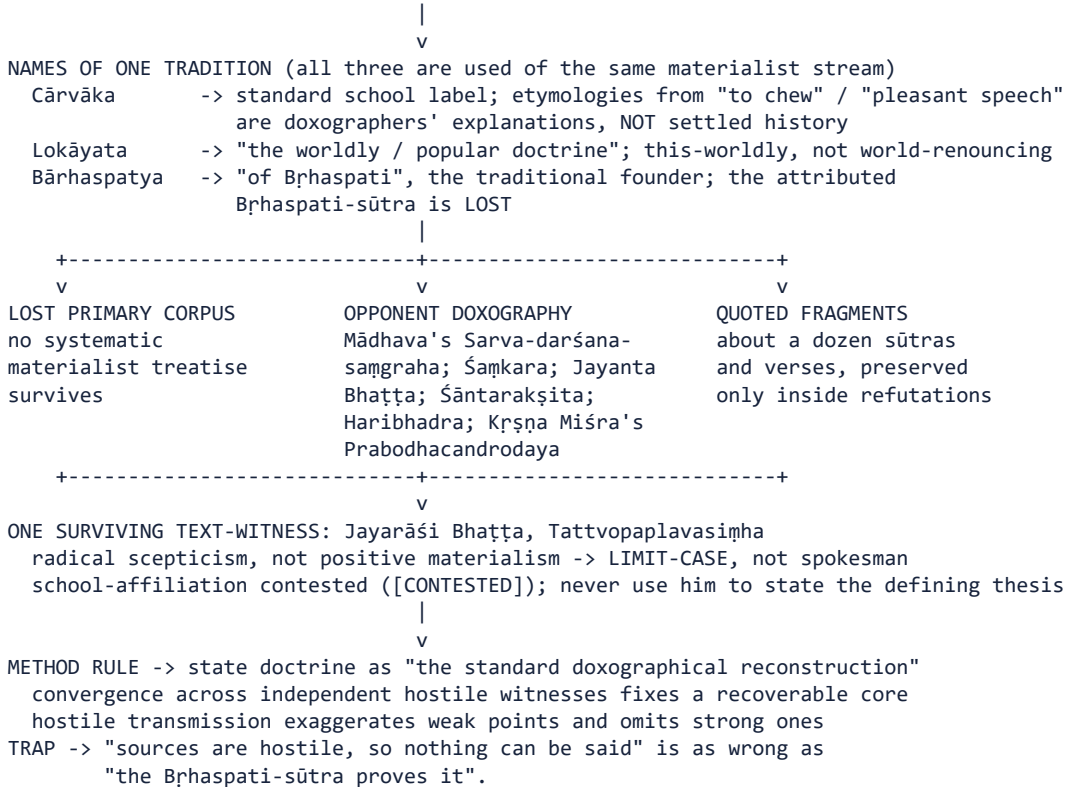
End of the complete learning session.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Identity, names and the source problem

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Identity, names and the source problem

CENTRAL QUESTION: what may be affirmed about a school whose own books are lost?



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: Classification, location and evidence grading

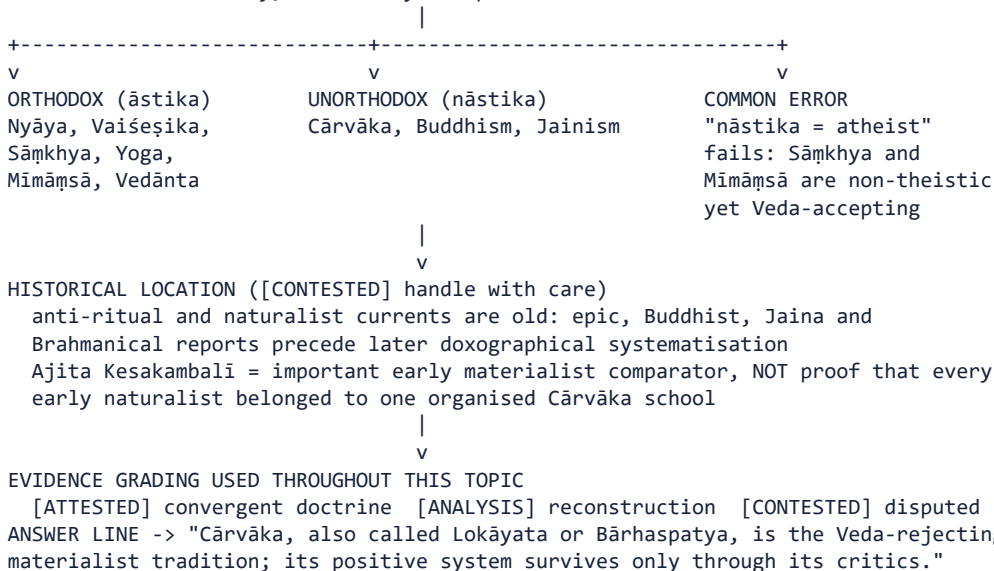
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: Classification, location and evidence grading

WHY IS CĀRVĀKA CALLED VEDA-REJECTING (nāstika)?

PRIMARY criterion -> rejects the authority of the Veda

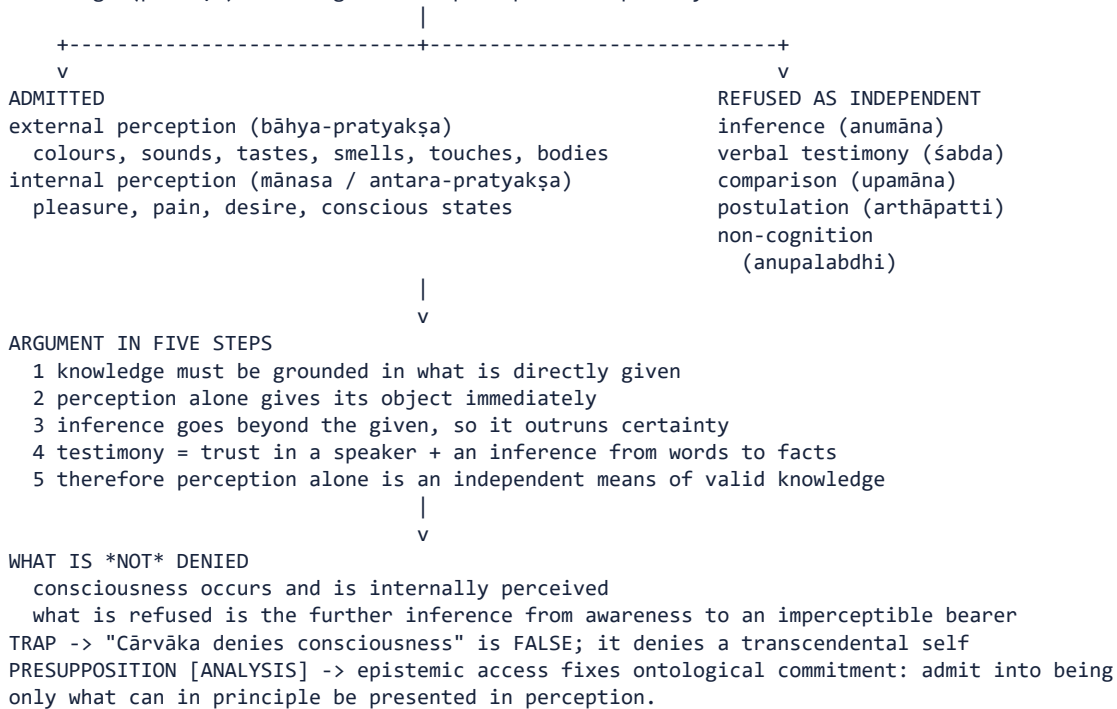
SECONDARY sense -> denies existence after death

Cārvāka is nāstika in BOTH senses; Jaina and Bauddha schools are nāstika on the first criterion only, since they accept life after death



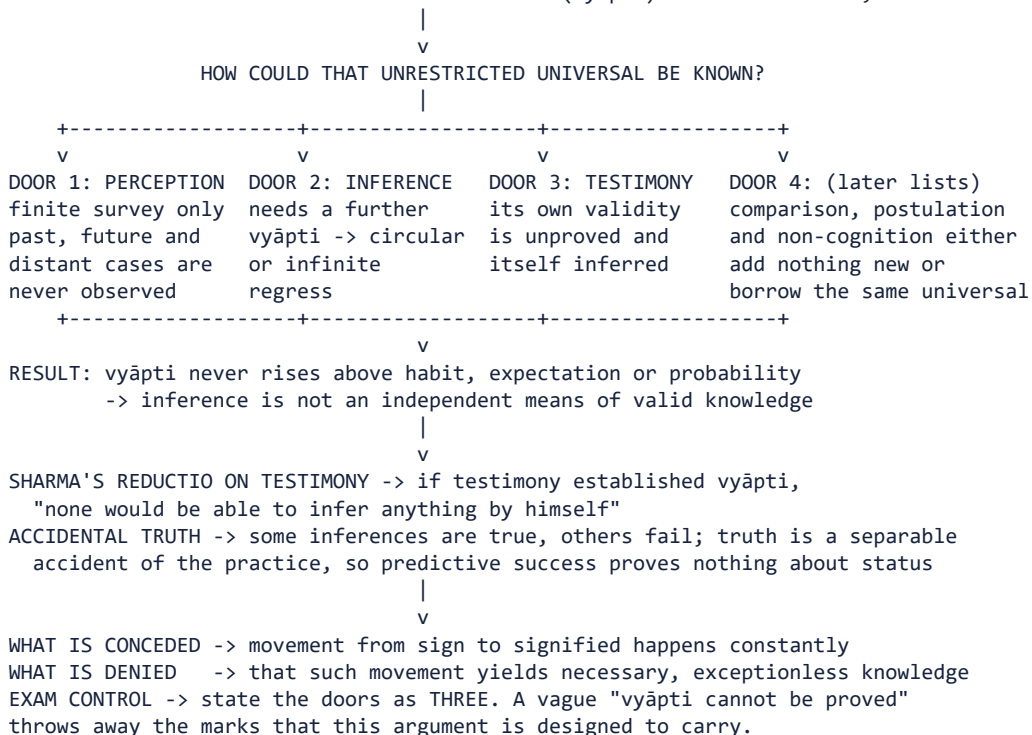
ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: The epistemic gate - perception alone

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: The epistemic gate – perception alone
 DEFINING THESIS: perception (pratyakṣa) is the ONLY independent means of valid knowledge (pramāṇa). Stronger than "perception is primary".



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: The attack on inference - three closed doors

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The attack on inference – three closed doors
 EVERY INFERENCE NEEDS INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE (vyāpti): "wherever smoke, there fire"



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Hidden limiting condition and self-refutation

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Hidden limiting condition and self-refutation

HIDDEN LIMITING CONDITION (upādhi)

observed: smoke with fire, many times -> hasty universal: smoke proves fire
but what was constant may have been fire-PLUS-WET-FUEL, or combustion under an
unnoticed qualifier -> the supposed universal was too broad all along
STRUCTURAL, not quantitative: it survives however many cases are collected

TRAP -> upādhi is NOT the same as "too few instances observed"

|
v

THE SOCRATES SYLLOGISM (2019, 15 marks) – where the objection lands

"All men are mortal / Socrates is a man / therefore Socrates is mortal"

FORM is conceded valid. The target is the MAJOR PREMISE, which is a vyāpti:
no one has perceived all men; relocating the relation to man-ness and mortality
does not help, because class-characters are not perceived either

VERDICT -> valid but epistemically empty: it transmits a certainty never acquired

|
v

SELF-REFUTATION CHARGE (2019, 2025)

- 1 "no inference is a means of valid knowledge" quantifies over all inferences
- 2 no single perception delivers a universal
- 3 so the thesis is inferred (self-defeating) or undefended (unassertable)
- 4 Sharma presses further: thoughts and other minds are never perceived, so the Cārvāka "can understand others only through inference"

|

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v

REPLY A: vitaṇḍā
assert nothing, only
destroy the opponent –
but four elements and a
body-self ARE asserted

v

REPLY B: softened thesis
deny apodictic certainty,
especially about the
transcendent – a weaker
but defensible doctrine

v

REPLY C: level-distinction
concede practical
validity, deny ultimate –
but that distinction is
"unknown to the Cārvāka"

|
v

VERDICT [ANALYSIS] -> radical or consistent, but not both.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: The Nyāya defence and a balanced verdict

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: The Nyāya defence and a balanced verdict

NYĀYA REBUILDS INVARIABLE CONCOMITANCE WITHOUT OMNISCIENT SURVEY

agreement in presence (anvaya) -> repeated positive co-observation
agreement in absence (vyatireka) -> no counter-instance where the probandum
is absent

elimination of suspected upādhis -> known qualifiers identified and excluded
hypothetical reasoning (tarka) -> denial of the relation makes experience
incoherent; tarka removes doubt but is
NOT itself a means of valid knowledge

perception of the universal -> sāmānyalakṣaṇa-pratyakṣa in later Nyāya
the mark as qualified (parāmarśa) -> no "leap" occurs; the sign is cognised
together with the concomitance

|
v

THE REAL LOCUS OF THE DISPUTE

BOTH sides agree finite observation cannot ENTAIL an unrestricted universal
Cārvāka: entailment fails -> no knowledge -> no means-of-valid-knowledge status
Nyāya : entailment fails -> warrant does not require entailment -> status stands
So the quarrel is about the CONCEPT OF KNOWLEDGE, not about the logic of induction

|

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v

WHY NYĀYA WINS AGAINST THE STRONG THESIS
universal denial is itself a universal;
other minds and ideas are never perceived;
the school still asserts elements and a self

v

HONEST RESIDUE AGAINST NYĀYA [ANALYSIS]
tarka establishes nothing alone;
sāmānyalakṣaṇa works only inside
Nyāya realism about universals;
elimination removes only SUSPECTED
conditions, never proves that none
remains

|
v

GRADED VERDICT -> justified against the strong thesis, but Nyāya answers by
replacing omniscient certainty with disciplined, defeasible warrant – which
concedes the Cārvāka's logical point while refusing his epistemological conclusion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Testimony, the wider list, and the school ledger

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Testimony, the wider list, and the school ledger

WHY VERBAL TESTIMONY (śabda) IS REFUSED

- 1 testimony reports only that someone uttered something
- 2 the step from utterance to truth assumes competence and honesty
- 3 that assumption is not in the words; it is inferred
- 4 inference is already denied independent status -> testimony collapses
- 5 Vedic authorlessness and infallibility are not perceptually available

NOT DENIED -> ordinary communication; language may guide action until perception checks it. Usefulness is separated from means-of-valid-knowledge status.

|
v

THE SAME CRITERION APPLIED TO THE LATER LIST [ANALYSIS] (systematic reconstruction)

- comparison (upamāna) -> resemblance is perceived; the stable word-kind relation needs generalisation
- postulation (arthāpatti) -> the postulated fact is unperceived and needs a universal rule excluding alternatives
- non-cognition (anupalabdhi) -> "if it existed here it would be perceived" is a universal conditional, not one perception

|
v

LEDGER OF ADMITTED MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE – CĀRVĀKA FIXES THE LOWER BOUND

- 1 Cārvāka perception
- 2 Vaiśeṣika, Buddhism + inference
- 3 Sāṃkhya-Yoga + testimony
- 4 Nyāya + comparison
- 5 Prābhākara Mīmāṃsā + postulation
- 6 Bhāṭṭa Mīmāṃsā, Advaita + non-apprehension

STRUCTURAL POINT -> every richer epistemology must justify its additions against Cārvāka; that is why he is the standing pūrvapakṣa of Indian philosophy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Material ontology - four elements and own-nature

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Material ontology – four elements and own-nature

ONTOLOGICAL MINIMALISM: admit only what perception can present

|
v

FOUR ELEMENTS (bhūtas): EARTH + WATER + FIRE + AIR

eternal material bases; their combination and dissolution produce bodies, sense organs, objects and living organisms

ĀKĀŚA IS REJECTED -> it is not perceived; the Nyāya inference from sound to an imperceptible substratum inherits the disputed vyāpti problem

TRAP -> writing "five elements" is the single most punished factual slip here

PYQ ANCHOR -> 2020 Q6(b), 15 marks: rejection of ākāśa + criticism of transmigration

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OWN NATURE (svabhāvavāda) [ATTESTED]

fire burns, water flows down, thorns are sharp, the peacock is variegated, stone is hard
REGULARITY IS REAL; only TRANSCENDENT causation is denied – no karma, no adṛṣṭa, no divine will
explanation stops at an OBSERVABLE nature

v

ACCIDENTALISM (yadṛcchāvāda) [CONTESTED]

events occur by chance, with no determining cause at all
DETERMINATE CAUSATION IS DENIED; listed by doxographers among ahetuvāda positions and attacked by Buddhists, Jains and Naiyāyikas alike;
the Cārvāka link is CONTESTED

v

OBJECTION -> "burns by its own nature" is a refusal to explain, not an explanation

REPLY [ANALYSIS] -> every explanatory chain terminates somewhere; "God willed it" is also terminal and far less observable. RESIDUAL FORCE [ANALYSIS] -> the school still gives no account of WHY natures stay stable, which is precisely what vyāpti-theory supplies.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Self, body and emergent consciousness

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Self, body and emergent consciousness

THE LIVING BODY IS THE SELF (dehātma-vāda)

- 1 conscious life is only ever met with as embodied
- 2 no self is perceived apart from bodily states
- 3 so an extra substance called ātman is an unwarranted addition
- 4 explain awareness instead as a property of the bodily complex

IDENTITY-LANGUAGE ARGUMENT -> "I am stout", "I am thin" predicate bodily properties directly of the person. Opponent: "my body" separates possessor from possessed.

Reply: possessive grammar alone does not prove a separable substance.

EVIDENCE -> injury, intoxication, age, sleep and disease visibly alter awareness

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v

CONSCIOUSNESS FROM THE ELEMENTS (bhūta-caitanya)

betel analogy -> leaf + lime + areca nut give a RED not present in any part

fermentation -> kiṇvādibhyo madaśaktivad vijñānam: intoxicating power arises from fermenting agents that lack it separately

CLAIM -> an organised whole can display a NOVEL property absent from ingredients

NOT the claim that consciousness is identical with any one element

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FOUR MATERIALIST SELF-MODELS [CONTESTED] (Sadānanda, Vedāntasāra) OBJECTIONS AND REPLIES

gross body (sthūla-śarīra) / senses (indriya) /

Jaina: an emergent

vital processes (prāṇa) / mental organ (manas)

property needs a bearer

SHARED CORE -> none survives bodily dissolution

Advaita: consciousness is

BOUNDARY -> this is NOT the crude/refined contrast

self-luminous; the body

is known BY it

Reply [ANALYSIS] -> positing an

immaterial soul renames

rather than explains

v

HONEST LIMIT [ANALYSIS] -> emergence is asserted, not explained: redness and intoxicating power are third-personal, whereas awareness is first-personal.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 10/12: The rejection of transcendent entities

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: The rejection of transcendent entities

ONE TEMPLATE, APPLIED REPEATEDLY

X is imperceptible -> only inference or testimony could reach X -> neither is an independent means of valid knowledge -> X is not admitted

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immortal soul	rebirth and trans- migration	karma as unseen moral force, adṛṣṭa	heaven and hell (unseen ritual result)	creator God (world needs no planner)	Vedic infallibility and priestly authority
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LIBERATION (mokṣa) IS CANCELLED, NOT REDESCRIBED

opponent-preserved formula [CONTESTED] "death itself is liberation"

(maraṇam eva apavargaḥ) -> dissolution ends the person and so ends suffering;

it describes no positive post-mortem state

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v

RITUAL CRITIQUE -> sacrifice and ancestral offerings promise unseen results that cannot be verified; the satire that ritual sustains priestly livelihood is

SUPPLEMENTARY to the epistemological argument, never a substitute for it

e.g. the mocking challenge that if the sacrificial victim goes to heaven, the sacrificer should offer his own father – a polemical fragment, not a treatise

|
v

OBJECTION -> without karma and rebirth the moral order collapses

REPLY [ANALYSIS] -> morality need not be underwritten by cosmic bookkeeping; pleasure, pain, prudence and social consequence are enough for conduct

STRUCTURAL VERDICT -> Cārvāka is the only Indian school whose atheism follows from its EPISTEMOLOGY rather than from cosmology or soteriology; non-theism is common in India, but this-worldliness is Cārvāka's alone. PYQ ANCHOR -> 2021 Q5(e).

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: Ethics, society and anti-caricature control

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: Ethics, society and anti-caricature control

THE FOUR HUMAN ENDS, FILTERED

dharmā -> rejected where it rests on scriptural command or unseen reward
 mokṣa -> rejected: it presupposes a separable self and a post-mortem destiny
 artha -> ADMITTED as the INSTRUMENT
 kāma -> ADMITTED as the END

HIERARCHY MATTERS -> pleasure is the end, wealth its means; they are not co-equal

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v

PRUDENTIAL STRUCTURE, NOT RECKLESS APPETITE

husk-and-grain image -> do not discard grain because it carries a husk;
 secure pleasure while limiting foreseeable pain
 traditional verse [ANALYSIS] "as long as one lives, let one live happily"
 (yāvat jīvet sukhaṃ jīvet) -> cite as a DOXOGRAPHICAL verse associated with the
 school's image, never as a line from an extant primary text

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SOCIAL AND POLITICAL SIDE [CONTESTED] (thin evidence)

statecraft (daṇḍanīti) and livelihood (vārttā)

reported inside the Lokāyata curriculum;

some Cārvākas "regard the king as God"

READING [ANALYSIS] -> a secular theory of authority:

order comes from the sovereign, not from cosmic

dharmā; prosperity from the productive arts

CRUDE vs REFINED [CONTESTED]

dhūrta -> the caricatured,

everything-is-body version

suśikṣita -> allows practical

inference (lokasiddha), and is

the strongest reply to the

self-refutation charge

BOUNDARY -> doxographical and

indirect; NOT two documented

schools with surviving texts

v

EVALUATION [ANALYSIS] -> two things the rivals supply are missing: a QUALITATIVE ranking of
 pleasures and an account of OTHER-REGARDING obligation. Honest verdict: a coherent
 theory of PRUDENCE and an incomplete theory of MORALITY.

CONTROL -> call it naturalistic hedonism or this-worldliness; do not reduce a
 serious epistemological school to a slogan about eating and drinking.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Comparative map, PYQ rail and answer spine

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Comparative map, PYQ rail and answer spine

COMPARATIVE AXES – USE THESE FIVE, NEVER A VAGUE "MATTER vs SPIRIT"

AXIS	CĀRVĀKA	NYĀYA	BUDDHISM	JAINISM
knowledge	perception only	four means	perception + inference	many means + standpoints
self	living body	enduring ātman	no substantial	plural jīvas
causation	observed nature	real relation	dependent orig.	persisting
transcendent	all denied	God, soul, karma	karma, no creator	karma as matter
liberation	death ends person	apavarga	nirvāṇa	mokṣa of jīva

KEY DISTINCTIONS -> Cārvāka denies TRANSCENDENCE but keeps a MATERIAL BEARER;

Buddhism denies SUBSTANTIALITY but keeps MORAL CONTINUITY, and rules out the

body-self by name, since material form is itself an aggregate declared not-self.

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DIRECTLY OWNED PYQ RAIL (Paper I, Section B)

2018 Q8(b) 15 cross-school acceptability of the rejection of inference
 2019 Q5(c) 10 consistency of the rejection of inference
 2019 Q6(c) 15 what is wrong with the Socrates syllogism
 2020 Q6(b) 15 rejection of ākāśa + criticism of transmigration
 2020 Q7(c) 15 Cārvāka and Jaina conceptions of reality
 2021 Q5(e) 10 bearing of epistemology on the rejection of transcendent entities
 2024 Q5(a) 10 is the philosophy positivistic?
 2024 Q6(a) 20 Cārvāka refutation of self vs Buddhist rejection of ātman
 2025 Q5(a) 10 grounds for rejecting inference
 SUPPORTING 2022 Q7(c) 15 (Nyāya-owned): the Naiyāyika reply to these objections

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v

ANSWER SPINE -> define + flag reconstruction -> perception-only thesis ->
 three doors + upādhi -> Nyāya reply -> derive ontology (four elements, body-self,
 emergent awareness) -> transcendent denials -> ethics -> ONE comparison ->
 QUALIFIED VERDICT: a rigorous empiricist protest and a decisive standing
 pūrvapakṣa, but not a complete theory of knowledge, since the exclusive perceptual
 criterion is narrower than the reasoning needed to defend it.